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SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Judy Hinchey (shown with Clover) said she hopes to establish a miniature horse therapy practice.

A little problem — or a big one

Newton woman fights to keep her mini horse but neighbors smell trouble

By Camilo Fonseca
GLOBE STAFF

Newton has its fair share of neighborhood spats — headaches over leaf blowers, over-night parking bans, and tricolored street lines, to name a few. But its latest flare-up is a bit smaller.

To be precise, miniature-horse-sized. A longtime resident is fighting for the right to keep her mini horse in the backyard of her Auburndale home. Judy Hinchey hopes city officials will allow her to keep Clover, slightly larger than her black Labrador, in her yard, despite zoning questions and neighbors' complaints about manure odor. "I don't want it to be in a boarding place

that's 45 minutes away," Hinchey said. "We have to bond. We're a therapy team . . . that's why I want her here with me."

Newton officials originally denied her request for a license to keep Clover, as her property wasn't large enough to meet requirements that her facilities have to be a certain distance from neighbors. She appealed, and on Wednesday the Newton public health board heard her request.

The board said it would issue a ruling at a later date.

Clover has plenty of fans. Dozens of people have left messages on a local Auburndale Facebook group, urging the city to reconsider its initial decision to deny

Hinchey's application.

"When people have the opportunity to meet Clover, they're pretty much smitten," said Newton resident Nancy Horwitz.

Bruce Kwartler, another resident, said Hinchey had been "trying to do things the right way from the very beginning."

"That should be taken into account," he said.

Several residents appeared at the hearing in City Hall Wednesday, but the board declined to open the proceeding to public comment.

City officials said neighbors have complained about the smell of manure, as well as

CLOVER, Page A10

Healey, team at odds on ballot question

She hails conservation measure but booklet says it would cost

By Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF

As she stood at Chestnut Hill's Hammond Pond Trailhead in late August, Governor Maura Healey wondered what she could do "to make the world a better place."

In her estimation, endorsing a ballot question this November to dedicate a portion of state sales taxes to natural resource conservation was one answer.

"We can make sure that we are using taxpayer dollars wisely," Healey said at the campaign event for

the ballot measure, "in a way that makes sense."

But to hear it from Healey's own bean-counters, it may not be so simple.

The governor's budget office warned in voter booklets the state started sending to residents last week that the measure, listed as Question 6 on the ballot, could have a significant impact on state and local finances by automatically diverting tens of millions of dollars that currently help fund the state's annual budget into a new conservation

fund.

If passed, the measure could also carry "substantial," if not yet totally clear, costs to implement it.

The Healey administration's own assessment of the ballot question lands amid a wave of financial uncertainty on Beacon Hill, fueled in part by an ongoing fight over the Trump administration's attempts to carve away billions of dollars in funding from Massachusetts.

The apparent split between Healey and her budget office — which is

HEALEY, Page A7

Gaining elsewhere, democratic socialists struggle to capitalize here

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

Democratic socialists are having a moment, racking up primary wins in competitive states and fueling dreams that one of their own could ascend to the presidency.

It's a train democratic socialists in Massachusetts, regarded as a bastion of left-leaning politics, were happy to hop on. "For decades, socialists were irrelevant," the Boston DSA chapter proclaimed in a June Instagram post. "Then, we started winning."

But winning isn't exactly what they've been

doing here.

The Boston DSA, which, at more than 3,100 members, is among the country's largest chapters, endorsed just one candidate this primary cycle: Evan MacKay, a Cambridge labor organizer who lost their state legislative bid. The group opted not to back three other democratic socialists it had previously endorsed — all of whom ultimately won their primaries.

All the while, the chapter collected more than 5,000 signatures to put a rent control proposal on the ballot — only for the state's highest court

DEMOCRATIC SOCIALISTS, Page A6



CARLIN STIEHL FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE/FILE 2022

Rep. Erika Uytendaele won a crowded Democratic primary for a state Senate seat. She wasn't endorsed by the DSA.

Police use of AI social media tool questioned

Boston councilors see potential for misuse, say they should have been told

By Yogev Toby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Meet the Instagram follower that may never stop looking at your feed: the Boston Police Department.

The department this summer started using new artificial intelligence software that combs through social media looking for possible threats and information helpful to investigations, a city report revealed this week.

The software, dubbed LifeRaft, offers tools to scrape troves of data from public social media posts. Officers can query the data using keywords and geography-based searches, such as people's names, phone numbers, and social media handles. The department gained access to the software in June, according to the city's 2025 Surveillance Technology Report released Monday.

Such technologies are common among law enforcement agencies in the country, as violent threats and hate groups increasingly find a home in online chatrooms and hidden corners of the dark web. But critics of these tools say they can also be used to target individuals based on speech or political ideologies.

LIFERAFT, Page A10

Despite Trump, Fed raises rates 1st time in years

President's choice for chair says inflation is 'too high'

By Colby Smith
NEW YORK TIMES

The Federal Reserve raised interest rates by a quarter of a percentage point on Wednesday, the first increase in more than three years and a significant step by Kevin Warsh, the central bank's chair, to combat elevated inflation.

The decision, which lifts rates to a new range of 3.75 percent to 4 percent, was supported by all 12 members of the Federal Open Market Committee.

"The plain fact is that inflation is too high and has been for too long," Warsh said at a news conference after the decision was announced. He added that the US economy remained strong and unemployment was low, justifying the Fed removing

FED, Page A7

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The Nation

Copter crash leaves industry on edge

Underscores risks of aerial news culture

By Shawn Hubler
NEW YORK TIMES

LOS ANGELES — The collision of the bus and the SUV had been big, even by Los Angeles eye-in-the-sky standards. Desmond Shaw was stunned by its force.

Shaw, a veteran helicopter reporter, had gazed at the wreck from above, transfixed. His aircraft was one in a swarm hovering high over the San Fernando Valley on Tuesday. The transit vehicle had been bashed like a toy, the SUV gutting its midsection. Authorities were saying that people were dead.

Shaw had been back at work less than a week after taking a leave prompted by the deaths of both parents, and he had been thinking lately about mortality. The crash was eerie for him, and he was glad to be done with the story.

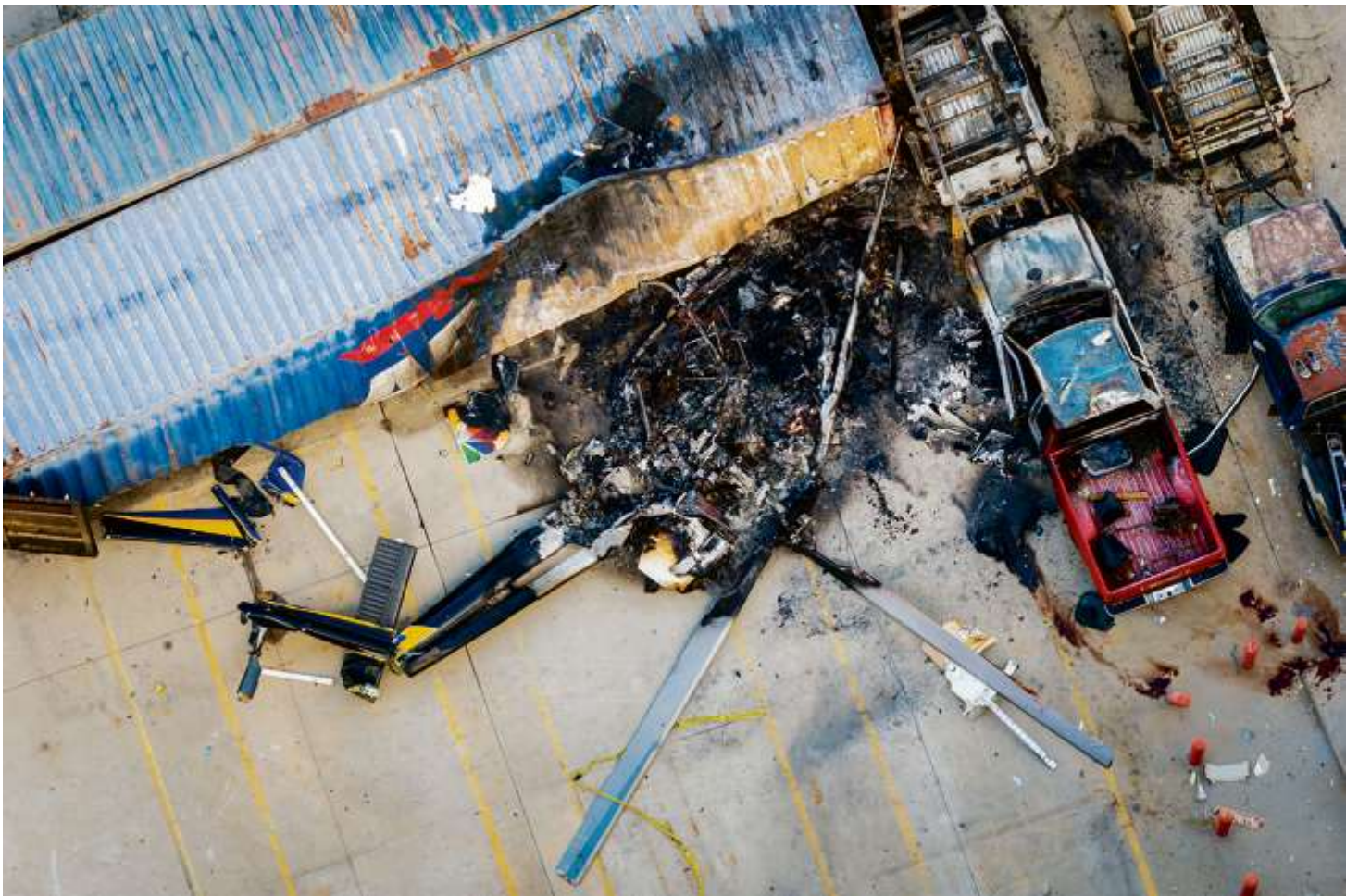
But shortly after he and his pilot flew away, the newsroom called back: An aircraft appeared to have gone down near the scene of the bus crash.

Shaw, 45, who works for a CBS affiliate, thought of his fellow reporters aloft — colleagues for whom the air was their office.

“As soon as we got there and saw the fireball and the rotor blades, we knew what it was,” he said, speaking in an interview from his car early Wednesday. “It was the day we all dread.”

The back-to-back bus and helicopter crashes killed at least five people and strewn blackened wreckage in the Chatsworth neighborhood of Los Angeles, starting shortly after 5 p.m. Tuesday.

First, the SUV broadsided a Los Angeles Metro bus, killing at least two people and critically injuring others. The driver has been charged with murder, police said.



ETHAN SWOPE/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A helicopter reporting for a Los Angeles NBC affiliate plummeted to the ground near the scene of a bus crash Tuesday.

Then, around 7 p.m., a helicopter reporting for a local NBC affiliate plummeted to the ground and burst into flames, a disaster whose cause is under federal investigation. The reporter, Eliana Moreno, and the pilot, George Marciniw, were killed, along with a person on the ground.

The helicopter was just one of a fleet that zips over Southern California’s vastness, tracking events like car chases and wildfires. Most of them are supplied by contractors who provide aircraft and reporters to news stations. The choppers, swashbuckling and loud, are a signature of the region, indispensable in a metropolis encompassing thousands of square miles.

In 1992, they carried the news during the Los Angeles riots as crowds at the intersection

of Florence and Normandie avenues attacked trucker Reginald Denny. Two years later, they filled the sky when O.J. Simpson led police on a riveting two-hour chase through Southern California freeways. Come flames or floods, Rose Parades or immigration enforcement protests, they are as ubiquitous as seabirds, watching and swooping in from above.

But the crash of an aircraft trying to cover a spectacular collision underscored another aspect of Los Angeles’ aerial news culture: the risks.

Helicopter crews across the United States say they must remain on constant lookout for hazards such as drones and bird strikes, as well as pilot error and mechanical failure.

Although driving on freeways is statistically more dan-

gerous than air travel, the crash of a tourist chopper in the Hudson River in New York last year and the 2020 accident that killed NBA legend Kobe Bryant, his 13-year-old daughter, and seven others have highlighted the long odds of surviving a helicopter accident.

Since 2000, there have been at least eight fatal crashes involving news helicopters in the United States, killing 16 people, federal accident records and news accounts show.

In the interview Wednesday, Shaw said that helicopter journalists have to put aside their fears.

“You have to push it to the back of your brain or you can’t do the job,” he said. “I had a fear of heights when I was a kid. Now I’m sometimes up 10,000 feet high.”

Shaw has worked in broadcasting since his college days at California State University, Northridge, and later became that most specific of Los Angeles media figures: a radio traffic reporter. For more than a decade, he flew above the freeways, keeping motorists apprised of hazards, from “gawker’s block” to jackknifed big rigs, as well as the occasional disaster or wildfire.

He joined CBS Los Angeles in 2015, and has been a full-time reporter and cameraperson there for six years. He said he was well acquainted with Moreno and Marciniw.

“We knew pretty quickly who it was,” he said. “It’s a pretty tight-knit community. There are probably a dozen of us, or maybe less, who report on air and run the camera.”

DAILY BRIEFING

Body of last Tenn. victim of Helene found

The remains of the final missing Tennessee victim from Hurricane Helene were found two years after the storm devastated Appalachian mountain towns with floods that wiped away whole communities.

Nancy Tucker, 76, disappeared along with her husband Jimmy Tucker when flooding from the Noli-chucky River took their home in rural Washington County in the northeastern corner of Tennessee on Sept. 27, 2024. His body was recovered within a couple of days, but hers had been missing until Saturday, said Susan Saylor, spokesperson for the Washington County Sheriff’s Department. Their son lived in the home as well but was at work when the flood hit, Saylor said.

Helene killed more than 250 people and caused nearly \$80 billion in damage from Florida to the Carolinas. In the mountains on the North Carolina-Tennessee border, rains of up to 30 inches turned usually gentle streams into torrents that moved trees, boulders, homes, and vehicles, and shattered century-old flood records. Many of those killed were swept away in the flooding. In North Carolina, the body of Alena Ayers has never been recovered. Her case prompted the North Carolina legislature last year to establish Alena’s Law, making it easier to declare a person dead if they disappear during a natural disaster.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



RAHMAT GUL/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A tarp covered portions of the sign at the John F. Kennedy Center for the Performing Arts, Wednesday in Washington. An oversight board has voted to close most of the performing arts center for repairs.

Fencing goes up around main Kennedy Center building after board vote

WASHINGTON — Fencing went up Wednesday around the main Kennedy Center building, a day after the Trump-aligned board voted to close most of the performing arts center for repairs. A Democratic congresswoman who is a trustee quickly sought an emergency court hearing to prevent what she

called the “unlawful closing.”

That vote came after a federal judge blocked the institution from returning President Trump’s name to the building.

The Republican president had said in a social media post that the closure was needed for safety repairs. But he said the repairs, which Congress has al-

located \$257 million to cover, would only happen if the board was permitted to move forward with plans to add his name to the building.

Activists who have opposed the closure said there has been no vehicle or pedestrian access to the building Wednesday. An Associated Press reporter who

approached the main building was told by a security guard that it was closed.

Representative Joyce Beatty, an Ohio Democrat and an ex officio member of the Kennedy Center board, requested an emergency court hearing Wednesday.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Bear euthanized at national park

A black bear at Grand Teton National Park in Wyoming was euthanized Friday after it began to show a “concerning pattern of behavior,” authorities said Tuesday.

The bear, which had been fed repeatedly by park visitors, had become an “unacceptable safety risk,” the National Park Service said in a news release. The bear was used to accepting people’s food, and that drew it closer to tourists near Delta Lake, the release said.

“We need to be clear — this bear was lethally removed because of poor decisions made by park visitors,” the park service said.

Grand Teton employees had received reports earlier this year that a black bear was approaching visitors near Delta Lake, a turquoise pool at the foot of soaring peaks. The number of recreationists hiking to the waters has sharply increased, and the lake is one of the park’s most popular destinations, officials said in June.

But the park’s staff could not determine whether the bear was becoming conditioned to being fed by people or if the close encounters were an “isolated occurrence,” the park service said. “That changed last week,” it said.

NEW YORK TIMES

Son pleads in D.C. for Lai’s release

WASHINGTON — The son of imprisoned former Hong Kong media mogul Jimmy Lai appealed for his father’s release at a congressional hearing in Washington on Wednesday, one week before Chinese President Xi Jinping is expected to visit the United States.

Sebastien Lai urged his father’s release on humanitarian grounds at a hearing of the Congressional-Executive Commission on China. A Hong Kong court sentenced Lai to 20

years in prison in February following his conviction under a Beijing-imposed national security law.

Lai’s daughter, Claire, did not appear at the hearing after being diagnosed with cancer.

“Let Jimmy Lai come home to his family and let him sit beside his daughter in her hardest moment,” he said, describing his father as “a 78-year-old man who has already suffered enough.”

ASSOCIATED PRESS



Jimmy Lai was sentenced to 20 years in prison.

Kirk family files legal notice

Accuses college of security failures

By Jack Healy
NEW YORK TIMES

The family of slain conservative activist Charlie Kirk has accused the Utah university where he was killed last year of “stunning” security failures that made him an easy target for a rooftop assassin.

In a legal notice filed this month, lawyers for Kirk’s wife, parents, and children said Utah Valley University did not have a written security plan or hold a security briefing before Kirk arrived for an open-air debate last September that drew a crowd of thousands.

They also said the university’s police chief had failed to address concerns raised by Turning Point USA, the conservative activist group founded by Kirk, about how easily people could climb onto the rooftops that overlook the sunken plaza where he was shot.

The accusations came in a “notice of claim” that lawyers for the Kirk family sent to the state of Utah earlier this month and made public Wednesday. Kirk’s family has not yet sued, but the notice is a potential precursor to a wrongful death lawsuit against the public university or the state.

“His murder was entirely preventable,” Brett Parkinson, a lawyer for the Kirk family, said in a statement.

In a statement Tuesday, Utah Valley University said its “focus remains on supporting our campus community” but declined to comment further on the notice. It is conducting its own review of security surrounding the shooting.

Kirk, one of the country’s most influential and visible conservative activists, made Utah Valley University in Orem the first stop of his “American Comeback” tour of college campuses. About 3,000 people showed up on Sept. 10, 2025, to see him debate political opponents on a sunny afternoon.

He was just minutes into the event and answering an audience member’s question when he was shot in the neck by a gunman perched on a rooftop about 400 feet away.

In the legal notice, lawyers for Kirk’s family said the university’s security decisions “ultimately rendered Mr. Kirk helpless to the rooftop shooter in an assassination that could have been avoided.”

According to the notice, a Turning Point USA official texted Jeff Long, the university police chief, before the event to relay concerns from a Turning Point campus chapter about students’ ability to take staircases to building rooftops.

“It would be nice to either have it controlled access or allow one of my guys to be there as well. If possible,” a Turning Point official texted Long, according to the legal notice.

Kirk’s lawyers say Long responded, “I got you covered.”

Lawyers for the Kirk family argued in the legal notice that the university should have been on alert for a rooftop sniper after a would-be assassin fired at President Trump in 2024 from a roof outside a rally in Butler, Pa.

Surveillance videos and testimony from investigators suggest that Tyler J. Robinson, the 23-year-old man charged with aggravated murder in Kirk’s killing, encountered virtually no obstacles or resistance on his way to the roof. Robinson, who could face the death penalty, has pleaded not guilty.

Surveillance videos from the morning of the shooting captured the gunman as he walked to a railing on the roof of a campus building and then left. When he returned later, he “crawled to a sniper perch” along the edge of the roof, took aim at Kirk and fired, according to a legal filing by prosecutors.

The World

Trump approves \$2.8 billion arms sale to Israel

Proposed deal includes 40,000 one-ton bombs

By Michael Crowley and Edward Wong
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration has approved a \$2.8 billion sale of heavy bombs to Israel, according to a US official, in what would be among the largest deliveries of US munitions there even as American public support for the country declines.

The proposed sale would include 40,000 one-ton bombs whose use by Israel in the Gaza Strip and Lebanon has drawn international anger because of the civilian harm caused by their wide blast radius.

Human rights groups and some foreign governments have condemned Israel for dropping the giant munitions in densely populated areas, sometimes kill-

ing dozens of civilians in strikes targeting just one individual.

The package would include 20,000 each of America's 2,000-pound MK-84 and BLU-117 bombs. It would also provide Israel with 20,000 bunker-busting I-2000 penetrator warheads, which explode on delay after smashing through an outer surface like soil, rock, or concrete. The plan was reported earlier by The Washington Post.

The blast from a 2,000-pound bomb can be lethal at more than 1,000 feet and leave a crater as deep as 50 feet. Israel provoked a fierce outcry after it dropped hundreds of the heavy bombs on Gaza.

The State Department recently sent the proposed deal to two congressional committees to get informal approval, the US official said.

Production and delivery of the munitions usually takes months or years, but there are ways to expedite the process.

In mid-2024, the Biden ad-

ministration paused a shipment of 2,000-pound bombs to Israel because of concern about their use in crowded civilian areas. President Trump allowed the shipment to proceed days after taking office in January 2025.

Then in February, the Trump administration agreed to sell roughly \$2.7 billion in munitions to Israel, a package that included 35,000 of the one-ton MK-84 and BLU-117 bombs.

While congressional leaders can tell the Trump administration that they oppose the deal, Secretary of State Marco Rubio can exercise emergency powers to proceed with the sale regardless, as he has done repeatedly, or just say he is moving forward with it. The administration would then bypass getting informal approval from Congress and formally announce the sale is happening.

In those cases, both the House and Senate would need to pass a resolution to block the deal. Such a resolution would



MENAHEM KAHANA/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

The blast from a 2,000-pound bomb can be lethal at more than 1,000 feet and leave a crater as deep as 50 feet.

require the support of two-thirds of each body to guarantee it can overcome a presidential veto.

The Biden administration also declared an emergency in the region to bypass congressional approval and expedite ship-

ments of arms to Israel twice during the Israel-Hamas war. One of those packages included 13,000 rounds of tank ammunition, and the second included artillery munitions.

The State Department's approval of such a large package of

devastating munitions reflects Trump's continued strong support for Israel despite his recent disputes with its prime minister, Benjamin Netanyahu, over the country's military operations in Gaza, Lebanon, and Iran. Netanyahu is expected to be in New York next week to address the annual gathering of world leaders at the United Nations General Assembly.

The State Department said in a statement that as a matter of policy it would not confirm or comment on a proposed arms sale that has not been formally notified to Congress.

The proposed drew strong opposition among Democrats in Congress.

Representative Gregory Meeks, the top Democrat on the House Foreign Affairs Committee, said he plans to block the proposed sale over "grave, unresolved concerns" about how these munitions could be used in densely populated areas of Gaza and Lebanon.

DAILY BRIEFING



YURI CORTEZ/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

EL GRITO — Members of the Mexican armed forces took part in the Independence Day military parade at Mexico City's Zócalo square on Wednesday.

Businessman deported from Myanmar after months in jail, state media says

BANGKOK — Myanmar's military-run government has deported Adam Castillo, a US businessman and former president of the American Chamber of Commerce in Myanmar, after three months in jail on what supporters say were trumped-up charges, state media reported Wednesday.

State-run MRTV television

said Castillo was flown out of the capital, Naypyitaw, earlier in the day, in consideration of the friendly and cordial relations between Myanmar and the US.

"Members of the Trump administration have been working quietly behind the scenes to secure Adam's release," said Mickey Bergman, CEO of Global Reach, a Washington-based non-

profit that seeks to bring home Americans who are being wrongly held abroad. The group was engaged by Castillo's family to help in the case.

The former US Marine, who was a founder and owner of the security risk management firm AGS Myanmar, was detained at Yangon International Airport on June 11 after returning from

Malaysia to Myanmar.

His detention came after the American Chamber of Commerce accused him of financial impropriety, which he denies.

At the time, Myanmar authorities would only say he had been arrested because "there was a crime and a lawsuit," but did not provide further details.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Japan has over 100,000 centenarians

There are now more than 100,000 centenarians in Japan, a record for a country famous for its longevity.

Japan's Health Ministry released data Tuesday showing that there are now 107,677 people who are at least 100 years old, an increase of nearly 8,000 since last year. The oldest woman, Fuyo Kishimoto from Kyoto, is 114, and the oldest man, Hikaru Kato from Kumamoto, is 112. Women make up the vast majority of the group, at 88 percent.

Japan's health minister, Ken-ichiro Ueno, welcomed the news Tuesday, and pledged to build a strong social security system that supports the elderly

in living long and healthy lives.

Stuart Gietel-Basten, a professor of social science at the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, said the long lives of many Japanese could be attributed to healthy diets, active daily routines, and an affordable health system with regular checkups.

Women are overrepresented as centenarians because many men of that generation died in World War II, and those who survived smoked and drank more than women, he said. Men are also more likely to be involved in industrial work, which could have long-term health effects.

NEW YORK TIMES

EU proposes social media age limits

BRUSSELS — The European Union's top official proposed on Wednesday banning children under 13 across the 27-nation bloc from using social media sites and imposing limits for older teens on accessing the platforms.

The plan outlined by European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen adds to global efforts to protect young people using platforms such as Instagram and TikTok from online harm.

"I am aware that many perceive the power of Big Tech as overwhelming and impossible to roll back. I disagree," von der Leyen said in her annual State of the

European Union speech in Strasbourg.

"We do not have to accept addictive features. We do not have to accept children being drawn into ever more extreme content. We do not have to accept that girls have their photos used for AI-generated sexualized images," she said.

Von der Leyen said that under her proposal, "mini accounts" chaperoned by guardians would be granted to kids aged 13-15, with limits on features and the amount of time they can be accessed.

For 15-to-18-year-olds, platforms will need to provide a "safe design," she said.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Hague court convicts Kosovo's ex-president of war crimes

THE HAGUE, Netherlands — Kosovo's former president Hashim Thaci was sentenced to 25 years in prison on Wednesday after being found guilty of war crimes committed during the war for independence from Serbia in 1998-99.

Thaci resigned from office nearly six years ago to face the charges at the European Union-backed Kosovo Specialist Chambers in The Hague. He

was convicted of four counts of war crimes, including murder, torture, cruel treatment, and arbitrary detention.

Both he and the prosecutors, who had asked for a stricter sentence, can appeal.

The judgment sparked anger among Thaci's supporters and was a crushing blow for a man who was once embraced by the West, invited to the 1999 peace talks in France, and

seen as the leader who could guide Kosovo to independence.

Presiding Judge Charles Smith said Thaci actively participated in and encouraged crimes, including by promoting individuals involved in crimes, and "showed a ruthless ability to remove and eliminate political impediments" to his and other commanders' leadership.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Hashim Thaci sat before a war crimes court in The Hague in 2020.

Houthis escalate their fighting with Saudi Arabia

Group claims jet downed; drone near Mecca cited

By Ismaeel Naar, Hari Raj, Sanjana Varghese, and Aric Toler
NEW YORK TIMES

The Iran-backed Houthi militia in Yemen and Saudi authorities on Wednesday accused each other of sharply escalating their attacks, adding to fears that their recent return to war could further destabilize the Middle East.

The Houthis claimed to have downed a Saudi fighter jet, while Saudi Arabia accused the group of firing a drone near Mecca, the holiest site for Muslims.

A spokesperson for the Houthi military, Yahya Saree, said on social media that the group had shot down a Saudi F-15 fighter jet over Yemeni territory using a locally made missile. The Houthis released footage and photographs late Wednesday of what they said was the crash site. The wreckage of the downed jet seems to be consistent with that of the F-15 jets in the Royal Saudi Air Force, a review of the images by The New York Times found. However, the exact location of the wreckage could not be confirmed.

Saudi authorities did not respond to a request for comment.

Saree made the claim hours after Saudi Arabia said its military had shot down a Houthi drone outside Mecca. The drone was intercepted and destroyed south of Mecca on Tuesday as it headed toward prohibited airspace over the city, Major General Turki al-Maliki, the spokesperson for the Saudi-led military coalition in Yemen, said in a statement on social media.

Saree denied that the Houthis had targeted Mecca, dismissing the allegation as "fabrication and lies."

Amid the back-and-forth claims, two regional officials said Saudi Arabia is running low on missile interceptors and has turned to regional and Western allies for assistance as its standoff with Houthi rebels in Yemen drags on, the Associated Press reported. The officials said the Saudis have asked France, Britain, Pakistan, and Egypt to deploy air-defense support to the region to help defend against missiles and drones fired by Houthis and other Iran-backed groups.

The outreach was initiated because Saudi Arabia's main ally and arms supplier, the United States, has seen its own stock of interceptors dwindle

over the course of a six-month war with Iran, one official said. Both officials spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to brief the media.

Saudi officials did not immediately respond to a request seeking comment.

The conflict between the Houthis and the internationally recognized government, which is supported by Saudi Arabia, has spiraled back into war in recent days, adding further uncertainty to global oil markets already dealing with the US-Iran war.

The clashes have spurred a sharp rise in energy prices, with investors worried about the long-term impact on global supplies. The Houthi attacks threaten oil shipments from Saudi Arabia, which was the world's largest exporter before the Iran war knocked it down in the rankings.

Saree said that the Saudis had launched more than 450 strikes this week, and that the Houthis had responded with attacks on an oil refinery operated by Aramco, the Saudi state-owned energy company, and a military air base.

The resumption of war has plunged Saudi Arabia into a state of strategic shock. Last week, Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman of Saudi Arabia, the kingdom's de facto ruler, urged President Trump to take military action against the Houthis and was rebuffed.

Any attempted drone strike on Mecca, the birthplace of the Prophet Muhammad, would spark outrage in the Muslim world. More than 1.7 million pilgrims, most of them from overseas, visited the city this year for the annual pilgrimage known as the Hajj, according to Saudi government data.

The Houthi drone was "an attempt to terrorize the pilgrims visiting the Holy Mosque and to harm citizens and residents," al-Maliki said, adding that the security of the pilgrims and mosques was a "red line."

The Organization of Islamic Cooperation, a 57-member coalition that considers itself the collective voice of the Muslim world, condemned the alleged attack as well as the Houthis' wider strikes against Saudi Arabia.

"These attacks instill fear in innocent civilians, violate the sanctity of holy sites and mosques, and provoke the sentiments of Muslims around the world," the group said on social media Wednesday.

The Houthis and a Saudi-backed military coalition in Yemen have been fighting since the Iranian-backed group seized control of Sanaa, the capital, in 2014.

At least 21 dead in Gaza after building collapse

Many more remain trapped in the rubble

By Natan Odenheimer, Adam Rasgon, and Abu Bakr Bashir
NEW YORK TIMES

TEL AVIV — A war-damaged building in the Gaza Strip collapsed Wednesday, killing at least 21 people and trapping many more beneath the wreckage, according to local officials.

The incident shines a light on the perilous conditions in Gaza after the devastating war that followed the Hamas-led attacks on Israel on Oct. 7, 2023. Officials have warned that many more buildings damaged in Israeli strikes are at risk of collapse. The lack of progress on reconstruction has forced residents to choose between living in seriously compromised buildings or in tents.

Dozens of people were living in the Saada residential building in Gaza City when it caved in around 2 a.m. local time, according to the Civil Defense rescue service, which is part of the Hamas-run Interior Ministry in Gaza.

The building was previously hit by an Israeli strike, the officials added, though it was unclear when. The Israeli military said in a statement Wednesday that it “did not strike the building in question during the war,” but did not immediately respond to questions about whether any strikes on nearby targets could have caused the damage.

Search-and-rescue teams



JEHAD ALSHRAFI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Palestinian civil defense crews carried a body from the rubble of a collapsed building in the Gaza Strip on Wednesday.

pulled survivors from the wreckage Wednesday morning as they searched for missing residents.

“We can see people still trapped under the rubble,” said Raed al-Dahshan, director of Civil Defense in the Gaza City area. “We’re doing everything we can to extract them.”

Al-Dahshan said authorities in Gaza had warned residents that the building was unstable, but that many did not leave because they did not want to be

displaced and potentially end up in worse conditions. He added that there were roughly 70 buildings in the Gaza City area at risk of collapse.

One woman who was pulled from the rubble described the harrowing feeling of being in the building as it collapsed.

“I felt there was something that fell from below,” said Hayat al-Jabari, 37. “The building then fell all at once on us.”

Humanitarian groups

warned that there could be more deaths in the coming months.

“With the heavy rains and winds of winter approaching, the risk of damaged buildings collapsing will only increase, putting more lives in danger,” Pat Griffiths, a spokesperson for the International Committee of the Red Cross, said by telephone from Gaza.

“Choosing between life in a tent — with little privacy or space and exposed to harsh

weather — or a building that is damaged and at risk of collapse, just to have a roof over one’s head, is not a choice any family should have to make.”

The deadly collapse underscores the devastation across Gaza after years of war, with Israeli strikes, and street fights between Israeli forces and Hamas having left entire neighborhoods in ruins. Much of Gaza’s population was displaced by the conflict, and many are now liv-

ing in damaged buildings.

After a US-brokered ceasefire agreement was reached in October 2025, Palestinians had hoped that Israel would allow a significant amount of heavy machinery and construction materials into Gaza to begin the long process of removing rubble and rebuilding the territory. Thousands of bodies from the war are still beneath the rubble across Gaza, according to local officials. On Tuesday, the United Nations human rights chief called for international investigators to be allowed into the enclave to recover the remains of Palestinians from beneath damaged buildings.

Efforts by President Trump’s Board of Peace and regional mediators to advance the ceasefire and pave the way for reconstruction have stalled. Israel has continued to target the territory, despite international pressure to halt its attacks there.

On Tuesday, an Israeli strike killed a Civil Defense worker and a teenager, according to an official in the rescue service. The Israeli military said that it had been targeting Hamas militants, and that the attack was under review.

The International Committee of the Red Cross and Egyptian-backed rescue teams assisted local emergency crews Wednesday in their search for survivors of the building collapse.

In a statement, Ramiz Alakbarov, the UN humanitarian coordinator for the occupied Palestinian territory, urged international authorities to allow heavy equipment into Gaza to assist in search-and-rescue operations, along with humanitarian aid.

T. rex was nearly as warm as humans

Study uses teeth to pinpoint body temperature

By Adithi Ramakrishnan
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — Using fossilized teeth, scientists have finally taken the T. rex’s temperature — and it wasn’t too different from our own.

Researchers once thought that dinosaurs were sluggish, cold-blooded creatures. Later findings challenged that, suggesting that older dinosaurs were warm-blooded and could control their body temperature.

Most scientists agree that Tyrannosaurus rex was warm-blooded, but pinning down the exact core temperature of an extinct creature is difficult.

“We can’t just use a thermometer to do that,” said Jasmina Wiemann, a paleobiologist at Johns Hopkins University who had no role in the latest work.

Scientists tried other methods like studying how T. rex grew or searching for clues in its bones, but a firm number eluded them.

In a new study, researchers hunted for chemical clues in



UCLA VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

Researchers analyzed patterns in the predator’s tooth enamel to determine the extinct creature’s temperature.

the fearsome predator’s teeth. It turns out that atoms within the enamel clump together in different patterns based on an animal’s body temperature.

“We figured out how warm the most famous animal of all, a T. rex, was,” said coauthor Aradhna Tripathi, a geochemist at the University of California Los Angeles.

Readings from three teeth revealed an average body temperature of about 97 degrees Fahrenheit (36 degrees Celsius). That’s similar to modern elephants and not too far from the average body temperature of humans, which ranges from 97 to 99 degrees Fahrenheit (36 to 37 degrees Celsius).

The findings were published Wednesday in the journal Science Advances.

“I almost would have expected a higher body temperature,” Wiemann said. Based on her prior work, she thought the predator could have run a few degrees hotter — similar to

modern birds, dinosaurs’ warm-blooded descendants.

Knowing how hot or cold the T. rex was can help scientists piece together how the dinosaur might have lived.

At 97 degrees (36 degrees Celsius), T. rex could have lived across most of prehistoric North America, Tripathi said, maintaining a stable internal thermometer across both cooler and hotter regions. The findings could also shed light on the kinds of prey the dinosaur had to hunt in order to keep its energy up.

Scientists say it’ll be important to test these methods on other dinosaurs to see how warm or cold they ran.

It’s possible T. rex’s temperature could have been one of the keys to its dominance as one of the dinosaur age’s top predators.

“There’s lots of interesting, charismatic species that could be explored using this,” said study coauthor Robert Eagle, a geobiologist at UCLA.

Europe and Canada cozy up

As US ties fray, they talk of more formalized links

By Jeanna Smialek and Matina Stevis-Gridneff
NEW YORK TIMES

STRASBOURG, France — The European Union has invited Canada to work toward becoming its first “associate member,” a title meant to underscore the nation’s growing closeness to the 27-country bloc as both face deteriorating relationships with the United States.

President Trump has waged a relentless trade war with Canada, challenging its economy. The United States has pulled back support for NATO and Ukraine, leaving the EU scrambling to shore up its defenses. That vacuum has left both the bloc and the nation looking for new partners as the alliances established after World War II shift.

“We must urgently reimagine our partnerships,” Ursula von der Leyen, the president of the EU’s executive arm, said Wednesday during a major annual speech in Strasbourg, France. Mark Carney, the prime minister of Canada, was seated directly to von der Leyen’s left as she made her address.

“I would like to work with you on opening the door for Canada to be the first associate member of the European Union,” she told him.

The invitation may be more of a symbolic gesture than a meaningful step toward closer integration. It is not yet clear

how associate membership would reshape an already close relationship when it comes to trade, technology, or travel. Still, the announcement Wednesday was met with a standing ovation from the room of lawmakers.

Von der Leyen said the proposal was “not a partnership against anyone else, but for our common strength.” But it is clear that Europe and Canada see themselves caught between a competitive China and a sometimes hostile Trump administration.

“It’s a big swing, politically and rhetorically,” said Jörn Fleck, a senior director focused on Europe at the Atlantic Council in Washington. “This is obviously signaling toward the US” and “it’s also signaling to potential allies that the EU is willing to get more creative.”

Carney gave a headline-grabbing speech at the World Economic Forum meeting in Davos, Switzerland, this year during which he argued that the world order that emerged from the Cold War was facing a “rupture, not a transition,” and that “middle powers must act together because if we’re not at the table, we’re on the menu.”

Wednesday’s announcement was a vivid demonstration of that strategy.

Mujtaba Rahman, managing director for Europe at the Eurasia Group, said that talking of an associate member label sent an “interesting signal” to Canada, but one that for now is likely more symbolic than practical.

Von der Leyen did not lay out in detail what associate mem-

bership to the EU might entail. But she noted that Canada and Europe had plans to work more closely together on the Arctic, their defense industrial bases, and critical minerals. Canada and the EU will meet for a summit at the end of October, when they are expected to lay out more concrete ideas.

Von der Leyen called for a European equivalent to a NATO provision that allows for the convening of defense-related meetings when a nation is threatened, known as Article 4. The EU already has a little-known collective defense guarantee, but von der Leyen pitched “Europe’s own Article 4” and said that when it was “triggered by one member state, all member states would convene.”

She also called for a new leaders’ group, the European Security Council, that would include non-EU partners in Europe such as Britain, Norway, and Ukraine, and also Canada.

If it proves to be meaningful, the push to bring Canada closer could encounter roadblocks. EU member states have warned that offering too many benefits to a would-be associate would diminish the value of full membership, for instance. It is not clear what exactly the legal pathway would look like, though experts said it would likely require member state approval. As Carney navigates a historic low in his country’s relationship with the United States, the destination for three-quarters of Canadian exports, he has been focused on bringing his country closer to the bloc.

NASA spacecraft discovers huge new crater on the moon

By Marcia Dunn
ASSOCIATED PRESS

CAPE CANAVERAL, Fla. — Scientists have discovered a crater on the moon that’s bigger than the Roman Colosseum and is the result of a powerful impact two years ago that initially went undetected.

The steep-sided hole — about 728 feet across and up to 141 feet deep — is the solar system’s biggest known impact crater carved out in recent times.

Such a large-scale event is estimated to occur only once every 132 years, researchers said, making this a treasure trove of information as NASA prepares to build a base for as-

tronauts on the moon.

“This event constitutes a statistically rare, effectively once-in-a-lifetime observation,” the scientists wrote in one of two studies appearing on the subject Wednesday in the journal Science Advances.

NASA’s Lunar Reconnaissance Orbiter spotted the crater on the moon’s near side in May 2024 soon after it was formed by an incoming fragment of an asteroid or comet. The moon strike escaped real-time detection by telescopes on Earth and in space.

LRO’s wide-angle images were not identified in the crush of data until August 2025. The spacecraft gathered more de-

tailed pictures last fall, followed by confirmation of the discovery early this year.

The crater — named for the late Thomas McGetchin, a former director of Houston’s Lunar and Planetary Institute — is three times bigger than the previous record-holder found by the LRO a decade ago.

Pockmarked since ancient times, the moon bears some of the solar system’s largest impact craters, including one that stretches more than 1,500 miles across.

This latest impact churned the lunar surface for more than 66 miles. Dust and rocky soil were hurled away at a higher angle than expected, according to Mark Robinson,

chief scientist for the LRO’s cameras who works at Intuitive Machines. Robinson was the lead author for one of the studies.

A separate study identified a 4-mile-wide cold spot around the new crater, consistent with a loosening of the moon’s top soil.

Coauthor David Paige of the University of California Los Angeles likens it to gardening.

“We’re now thinking of impacts as a way to garden the regolith — churning the sediments and putting stuff above that’s usually below the surface,” Paige said in a statement.

The LRO’s numerous crater discoveries since its launch in

2009 show that the moon’s top inch of soil is being overturned by ejected material every 80,000 years, faster than previously thought, according to Robinson.

Contrary to the popular belief that the Apollo moonwalkers’ dusty lunar footprints will last forever, they will “definitely be long gone in that time frame,” Robinson said in an email.

The next step is to calculate the risk of ejected crater material striking NASA’s planned moon base, he added.

“That information will help engineers harden structures so one won’t have to worry about damage, or maybe worry less.”

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DSA struggling to capitalize in Mass.

►DEMOCRATIC SOCIALISTS
Continued from Page A1

to toss it. DSA chapters are now backing a slew of other proposals, albeit with little fund-raising power.

Massachusetts' democratic socialists say they've often focused on organizing around issues and building community, rather than just putting candidates into office. But while they insist that supporting workers and left-leaning policies is vital, they also acknowledge a need to compete more aggressively on the ballot to gain the visibility and actual power their counterparts are seeing elsewhere.

"This is a moment to build," said state Representative Erika Uytterhoeven, a Somerville democratic socialist who won a crowded Democratic primary for a state Senate seat.

"We need to make sure that our movement is equipped to have a voice and a seat at the table," she added.

Uytterhoeven's victory, indeed, planted a DSA flag in the 40-member chamber, but without DSA's help. Its leaders, after the group narrowly voted not to endorse her, questioned whether it could score a win in one of the state's most progressive districts.

It's been a far different story nationally, where democratic socialists are capitalizing on broader dissatisfaction with Democrats in blue and purple places alike, propelled by New York City Mayor Zohran Mamdani's win last year.

Several DSA-affiliated elected officials won primaries for congressional seats in New York City in June. Angie Nixon, a Florida state representative, became her state's US Senate Democratic nominee in August after joining the DSA in June. And this month, David Morales, a Rhode Island state representative and democratic socialist, unseated Providence Mayor Brett Smiley, making him the first incumbent mayor to lose a primary in the city's history.

It's starting to turn DSA members into more than just fringe Democrats. A UMass Amherst poll released last Thursday found that while the DSA label is unpopular among Americans overall, about 54 percent of



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

The Boston DSA endorsed one candidate this primary cycle: Evan MacKay, a Cambridge labor organizer who lost a state legislative bid. The New York DSA pitched in last month.

Democrats said they identified "at least somewhat with the movement." Support was larger for progressive policies backed by DSA, such as government-run health care and increasing taxes on the country's wealthiest.

Those ideas have resonated with some in Massachusetts. But Tatishe Nteta, the UMass Amherst Poll director, said voters here also "are very well aware of the benefits of seniority," complicating challengers' paths.

Still, democratic socialists here have seen an uptick in interest: Since January, Boston DSA's membership grew by nearly 1,000 people, helping it wield a large field operation for MacKay this year, in which organizers said the group knocked on more than 54,000 doors.

It leaned on help from New York DSA, which has for years played a larger role in its city's political infrastructure, and whose members canvassed for MacKay in August, featuring Claire Valdez, a New York lawmaker who became a congressional Democratic nominee in June.

It's progress, yes, but not on the ballot. MacKay lost their repeat bid to unseat incumbent state Representative Marjorie

Decker, who got a late surge in help from a super PAC.

Electoral wins in Massachusetts have been limited largely to local races in progressive hubs like Cambridge, where two Boston DSA members are city councilors. In 2021, Boston DSA backed four Somerville City Council candidates who won — including Ben Ewen-Campen, who is now poised to succeed Uytterhoeven as state representative, but also wasn't endorsed by the chapter.

"What we're facing is this really entrenched, really well-connected, and really wealthy political establishment, and sometimes that money is just very difficult to overcome," said Joshua Sisman, a spokesperson for Boston DSA, who noted the chapter's growth may help in future elections.

Massachusetts DSA chapters elsewhere have often organized around issue-based movements, such as opposing the war in Israel and Gaza, and not putting candidates up against incumbents.

"We are a little bit behind in development," said Sasha Morsmith, cochair of River Valley DSA. "There's a huge incumbency advantage in Massachusetts that makes it harder to launch any sort of campaign."

It's nevertheless seen major growth. That chapter, which includes Hampshire, Hampden, and Franklin counties, has added more than 200 members since the beginning of 2025, Morsmith said.

The chapters here have also faced internal struggles. In 2023, the Boston DSA chapter moved to expel state Representative Mike Connolly for reasons including endorsing Maura Healey for governor and supporting House Speaker Ron Mariano. Both are Democrats.

Connolly later left the local chapter but said he remains a member of the national organization. Lawmakers, he said, should "build broad coalitions" and "maintain a balance between our participation in a political organization and our obligation to represent an entire community."

He, too, believes getting more like-minded voices on Beacon Hill would help.

"Certainly, there's a benefit to being more broadly involved," he said.

Even in deep-blue Massachusetts, the DSA label remains a cudgel for some. Some moderate incumbent Democrats have used socialism as a boogeyman as they faced progressive challenges.

Representative Stephen Lynch spoke in cautious terms about democratic socialism, though his more left-leaning primary opponent, Patrick Roath, didn't identify as a democratic socialist.

"There is a certain appeal in some parts of the country for the democratic socialists, no doubt," Lynch told GBH in August. "I don't think that plays in huge swaths of the country. I think it frightens people."

A spokesperson for Representative Jake Auchincloss, too, referred to his primary opponent Jason Poulos, an AI researcher, as a "DSA opponent." Poulos is indeed a DSA member but wasn't backed by the organization and saw that description as a "fund-raising appeal."

This fall, Massachusetts' DSA chapters plan to canvass to boost, or oppose, eight of the nine questions slated to appear on the November ballot.

There's little money behind their efforts so far, though. The three committees' latest fund-raising reports show two — "Democratic Socialists For a Fair Massachusetts" and "Democratic Socialists Against Reactionary Rollbacks" — raised just \$50 apiece. Another, dubbed Democratic Socialists Against Austerity, is opposing proposed changes to Massachusetts' tax revenue cap, but raised less than \$900 this year.

Other left-leaning groups set up shops of their own with an explicit goal of electing ideologically aligned candidates. The Working Families Party, a left-leaning force in New York, launched a chapter in Massachusetts last fall to build "long-term governing power." This year, it endorsed 10 candidates, six of whom won.

"If there's a progressive wave that swept the country, Massachusetts has really high flood walls," said Josh Wolfsun, the group's Massachusetts state director.

But, Wolfsun added, "That energy has come to Massachusetts. There's just a lot of work we all need to do together to translate that into consistent victories."

Anjali Huynh can be reached at anjali.huynh@globe.com.

House approves Russia sanctions bill; sends to Trump

WASHINGTON — The House on Wednesday passed a broad package of sanctions targeting Russian officials and key pillars of its economy as lawmakers look to deprive President Vladimir Putin of the financial resources needed to wage the war against Ukraine.

The bill is named after the late Senator Lindsey Graham of South Carolina, who spent more than a year negotiating it. The measure was approved in a 262-159 vote and now heads to President Trump to be signed into law.

The legislation represents the most ambitious effort to support Ukraine since Trump's return to the White House and would break nearly two years of relative gridlock on the issue following a 2024 emergency aid package. Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky has been pushing for the bill's passage and made a direct appeal to senators shortly before they passed it last month.

The measure sanctions Russian officials, banks and a shadow fleet of tankers that keeps Russian energy moving. It also directs Trump to impose up to 100 percent tariffs on the top five importers of Russian oil or natural gas, with an exception for countries that import less than 15 percent of Russia's natural gas exports and have taken significant steps to reduce those imports.

"These countries have a choice to make about whether they will continue to sustain Putin's aggression," said Representative Michael McCaul, Republican of Texas.

Supporters said the provision is aimed at deterring China and India from purchasing Russian energy, but critics of the bill said they fear Trump will use it to target allies in the European Union and elsewhere. Americans, they warned, would pay the price for



CHIP SOMODEVILLA/GETTY IMAGES

AT ATTENTION — Members of the United States Armed Forces rehearsed for Chinese President Xi Jinping's official visit to the White House on Wednesday in Washington, DC. President Trump is expected to welcome Xi next Thursday.

such tariffs through higher prices at the cash register.

"This president has always said he loves tariffs," said Representative Gregory Meeks, Democrat of New York. "And we know the history of what he's done with reference to tariffs to our ... allies everywhere."

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Trump's third surgeon general pick faces Senate questions

WASHINGTON — Dr. Nicole Saphier, President Trump's third surgeon general nominee, was grilled at her Senate confirmation hearing Wednesday about her stance on childhood vaccines, voicing support for immunization as she seeks to serve in an administration that has moved to make sweeping changes

to vaccine guidance.

Saphier, a radiologist and former Fox News Channel contributor, faced tough questioning about her views on the safety of childhood vaccines by Republican Senator Bill Cassidy, who pressed her to declare whether she believed there was a link between vaccines and autism — which widespread scientific consensus has concluded doesn't exist, yet which the Trump administration has repeatedly pushed to revisit.

"I do not believe childhood vaccines cause autism," Saphier said. She also said "the MMR vaccine is our greatest tool for combating measles," in response to a question by Cassidy over whether parents should give children that shot. MMR stands

for measles, mumps and rubella, and the president recently called for the shots to be spaced out.

She suggested support for vaccines as a critical tool to prevent infection.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Kamala Harris to campaign in Mich. with Abdul El-Sayed

LANSING, Mich. — Former vice president Kamala Harris plans to campaign with Democratic Senate nominee Abdul El-Sayed in Michigan next week in the party's latest push to unify voters in a key battleground state that will help determine control of the Senate.

Harris and El-Sayed have spoken multiple times since she endorsed the progressive Democrat after his primary victory,

but this is the first time they'll appear publicly together.

Harris and El-Sayed will attend a roundtable focused on Black maternal health on Tuesday, according to his campaign spokesperson. El-Sayed is a doctor and the former head of health departments in Detroit and Wayne County.

"Vice President Harris looks forward to returning to Michigan to help turn out the vote in this critical state," Eduardo Negrón, Harris' spokesperson, said in a statement. "It is critical we flip the Senate so we can bring down prices and stand up to Donald Trump's corruption."

El-Sayed faces Republican Mike Rogers, a former US representative, in November.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Staffing issues mar Indian Affairs unit

Stall cases for killed, missing Native people

By Sarah Raza and Savannah Peters
ASSOCIATED PRESS

SIoux FALLS, S.D. — Peter Martin went missing two years ago from the Fond du Lac reservation in Minnesota. His family hasn't stopped looking, but they say the US Bureau of Indian Affairs investigation into Martin's disappearance has stalled since the agent assigned to the case left the role in early 2025.

"They've never had a person take his space for this region and yeah, we haven't heard from them since," said family friend Kayla Jackson.

The bureau's Missing and Murdered Unit was created in 2021 to address the crisis of violence against Native Americans and put new resources toward solving cold cases. But a recent federal audit by the Interior Department's internal watchdog found staffing issues have plagued the unit since its formation during President Joe Biden's administration, creating a backlog of cases and leaving families without required victim services.

Federal spending on the initiative grew from \$12 million to \$17 million between 2021 and 2024. During the same period, the audit found that 39 percent of money for the Missing and Murdered Unit was redirected toward other Bureau of Indian Affairs law enforcement costs, including upgrading vehicles. Nearly half the unit's posts remained unfilled as of last year, even as the bureau overall has lost a third of its workforce due to staffing cuts under President Trump.

The bureau says it has adopted many of the report's recommendations, from streamlining its case referral pipeline to training staff on victim services requirements. But federal auditors say weaknesses in its hiring process remain. And some families are still in the dark about their loved ones' cases.

"It is nothing but heartbreaking just to see how inadequate the response has already been for so many of these situations," said David Adams, an Albuquerque-based attorney, former federal prosecutor, and member of the Sault Ste. Marie Tribe of Chippewa Indians.

The Missing and Murdered Unit had 83 open cases and nearly 400 pending referrals as of November 2024, according to the audit released Sept. 9 by Interior's Office of Inspector General. The unit did not have a time frame for assessing referrals.

The audit also found agents had unmanageable caseloads, with some assigned administrative duties, like conducting research on referrals, on top of their active investigations.

Relatives of Kaysera Stops Pretty Places were hopeful when, in 2022, a Bureau of Indian Affairs agent was assigned to her case. Stops Pretty Places had just turned 18 when her body was found in a town bordering the Crow Reservation in 2019.

Her aunt, Grace Bulltail, said the agent was difficult to reach and provided few updates. Last year, Bulltail learned the agent never had full access to the files of local investigators before the agent was reassigned to other duties.

In 8 of 13 cases reviewed by the Inspector General's Office, the assigned agent did not contact bureau staff who specialize in helping victims' families. One staff member said they referred families to outside programs because the unit had only two victim specialists nationwide.

Tribal police departments, which are often the first to respond to cases involving Native people, remain underresourced with limited capacity to investigate complex crimes, said Sarah Deer, a professor at the University of Kansas School of Law.

"What I always come back to is whether or not this money could be better utilized by tribes themselves," Deer said.

‘It’s probably going to not be extremely popular in the Legislature, and it does have implications — \$100 million worth of implications — for the state budget.’

BRUCE BERMAN, *a longtime environmental advocate*

Healey, budget team at odds on ballot question

► **HEALEY**
Continued from Page A1

required to assess the “fiscal consequences” of all ballot questions — is just one aspect of the debate around one of the lesser-watched ballot measures this year.

A record-tying nine proposals are slated to go before Massachusetts voters in November, offering everything from drastic changes to primary elections to a measure that, if passed, would make Massachusetts the first state to dismantle its recreational weed market.

But Healey has only expressly endorsed the conservation question, arguing that clean air and water “aren’t luxury items for the elite.”

Question 6, if passed by voters, would divert state taxes collected on the sale and use of sporting goods, recreational vehicles, and golf courses into a fund dedicated to natural resource conservation.

Supporters say the measure could ultimately set aside roughly \$100 million each year for conservation efforts. The new fund would be overseen by a 15-member board, but the Legislature would ultimately need to appropriate the cash.

“This is a winner for Massachusetts,” Healey said at the Hammond Pond Trailhead. “It’s a winner for all of our people. It’s a winner in so, so many ways. And you know what? This is a battle we can and must win.”

Healey’s Executive Office of Administration and Finance, the agency tasked with crafting the governor’s budget proposal every year, struck a more cautious tone in describing its fiscal impact in the statement included in the 88-page voter booklet.

The office said a “full” analysis was not feasible, but noted that it would have “significant impact on state and local budgets” by pushing millions of tax dollars into the new fund. “This proposed law would also have substantial implementation costs,” the agency said.

State officials could not accurately estimate the exact revenue impact of the question because of what a spokesperson



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF/FILE 2023

Governor Maura Healey had a moment with Ms. G, the state’s official groundhog, at Drumlin Farm in 2023.

chalked up to a lack of data.

Still, Sam Anderson, the chair of the ballot question campaign and senior director of government affairs at Mass Audubon, said he was “surprised” by the statement in the voter booklet. He said it was “written without consulting us,” and questioned how diverting the sales tax revenue could directly hit local budgets.

“And I don’t really understand where the implementation cost is coming from,” he said, later adding: “I don’t know who wrote it, and I haven’t talked to them, and I didn’t see it until the voter guide came out.”

The state Department of Revenue and merchants do not track sales taxes by product types, such as sporting goods. In order to implement the ballot

law, the state would have to create new systems for businesses and the department to track the sale of relevant products, according to the governor’s budget office.

Bruce Berman, a longtime environmental advocate from Boston, said Healey’s endorsement of the measure is not surprising because it is a “highly visible initiative and, in broad strokes, it supports things that are important to both the governor, Lieutenant Governor [Kim Driscoll], and the Commonwealth.”

“But the devil’s in the details,” he said. “It’s probably going to not be extremely popular in the Legislature, and it does have implications — \$100 million worth of implications — for the state budget, which is al-

ready under enormous pressure.”

Kerry Lyons, a spokesperson for Healey’s campaign, did not address the difference between the governor’s stance on the ballot question and her own agency’s fiscal assessment.

Instead, Lyons said the ballot question would dedicate money to protecting land and water resources, “all without raising taxes.”

“If we wait, it will only get more expensive and more difficult to protect our communities,” he said in a statement.

An analysis performed by the Center for State Policy Analysis at Tufts University pegged the proposal’s fiscal impact at a smaller amount, projecting it would create a \$65 million earmark, once fully phased in, for

conservation efforts.

The center called the figure “relatively small,” noting that the state currently spends around \$400 million each year on recreation and conservation efforts.

State lawmakers who were tasked with reviewing ballot questions earlier this year raised their own concerns that the measure could require budget writers to reduce funding for other “state initiatives,” including those overseen by the Department of Conservation and Recreation.

“This raises questions of opportunity costs and the potential displacement of existing infrastructure and environmental funding priorities,” the lawmakers said in a May report.

Anderson said the idea that

the ballot question could result in cuts to DCR was “confusing.”

“They’re obviously related expenditures, but they’re really two different things,” he said of conservation and funding for DCR, which oversees nearly half a million acres of state land.

The ballot question campaign has raised more than \$2.6 million since last year, largely from wealthy donors — Belmont’s Kirsten Waerstad, who Mass Audubon honored last year, alone gave \$800,000 — and a handful of the state’s major environmental groups, including Mass Audubon, the Conservation Law Foundation, and The Trustees of Reservations.

But there are notable absences among the groups that have signed onto the coalition behind the ballot question. Well-known environmental organizations, including the Sierra Club’s Massachusetts chapter and the Environmental League of Massachusetts, have not officially endorsed the measure, for which they gave varying reasons.

Casey Bowers, the executive director of the Environmental League of Massachusetts’ political arm, said the group decided not to involve itself directly in the ballot question because it had “limited bandwidth” this election cycle.

“We generally support the idea,” Bowers said. “We don’t want to put out that there’s any, like, real dissension here.”

Vick Mohanka, director of the Sierra Club’s Massachusetts chapter, said the organization’s local board has not yet taken a stance on the ballot question, but hopes to do so next month. That’s in part because it had put more of a focus on candidate endorsements for the state’s Sept. 1 primary.

“Sierra Club is still working Question 6 through our process, consulting with our members and experts over whether we want to take a stance on it,” Mohanka said. “Or not.”

Chris Van Buskirk can be reached at chris.vanb@globe.com. Follow him on X @byChrisVan

Despite Trump, Fed raises interest rates for first time in years

► **FED**
Continued from Page A1

what he described as a “dose of accommodation.”

In a statement accompanying the rate decision, the Fed said Wednesday’s increase “will support a timelier return to the committee’s 2 percent goal.”

Warsh steered clear of providing any guidance about the path forward for rates after Wednesday’s move, however, saying that he did not want to “prejudge any future decisions we make.”

But in new forecasts, policy makers indicated that there would likely be additional increases. According to the latest “dot plot,” which tracks what officials think will happen to borrowing costs over the coming years, the vast majority of policy makers who submitted projections expect at least one more quarter-point move by the end of the year. Four officials thought rates would need to rise half a percentage point from here this year.

Stocks closed lower for the day, with the S&P 500 off 0.4 percent, the Nasdaq composite inching lower, and the Dow Jones Industrial Average down more than 1 percent.

Investors now anticipate three additional quarter-point interest rate increases through 2027. The two-year Treasury yield, which is sensitive to changes in interest rates, rose 0.6 percentage points. The 10-year Treasury yield steadied around 5 percent, while the 30-year Treasury yield nudged lower to 5.35 percent.

Wednesday’s decision is a momentous one for Warsh, who was selected by President Trump to lead the Fed and took over the top job just four months ago. During the selection process, Trump said he would only

choose someone who supported lower borrowing costs, although he vowed during the swearing-in ceremony that he would respect Warsh’s independence.

Later Wednesday, Trump reiterated that US rates should be 1 percent or less, “because we are the Best Credit in the World — BY FAR.” He alluded to his early threat to cut off a broad swath of US trade if the Fed did not soon reduce borrowing costs.

“LOWER THE INTEREST RATES FOR THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA, AND FAST!” he said.

However, he did not publicly castigate Warsh for the decision to raise rates, a notable change from his approach to the previous chair, Jerome Powell, whom he repeatedly attacked for not complying with his demands.

Trump later suggested to reporters that he had spoken to Warsh, casting the blame on the other six members of the Board of Governors, some of whom were appointed by Trump in his first term.

The president said he told Warsh that he “might as well vote with the board because it’s just not going to matter. The board is very hostile. They’re very political. They’re doing the wrong thing.”

Asked repeatedly about Trump’s demand for lower rates, Warsh said the Fed’s job was to “stay in our lane.”

“Independence is a two-way street,” he added. “We let people that do trade policy and fiscal policy stay in their lane, too.”

The case for cutting rates evaporated long before Warsh took the helm of the Fed in May, however. Trump’s war with Iran, which began in February and immediately sparked a surge in energy prices, upended the outlook for inflation and forced a re-



HAIYUN JIANG/NEW YORK TIMES

Kevin Warsh, shown with President Trump in May, said the Fed’s job is to “stay in our lane.” “Independence is a two-way street,” he said.

think among officials at the central bank about their policy settings.

In the months since then, growth has held up well, the unemployment rate has stayed low and consumers have continued to spend, suggesting that rates are not inflicting that much restraint on the economy and in turn, inflation. Financial markets have also undergone a rapid reset, with yields on longer dated US government bonds now trading at multiyear highs, raising borrowing costs across the economy.

That shift prompted Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent over the past month to embark on a series of interventions to force down borrowing costs. So far,

those efforts have proved futile, with 10-year Treasury yields now trading around 5 percent.

Warsh ascribed the rise in longer-term borrowing costs to three factors. The first was higher growth prospects; the second, competition for capital as technology companies borrow heavily to finance the expansion of their artificial intelligence capabilities; and the third was geopolitics, or higher oil prices caused by the Iran war.

Importantly, he did not convey that concerns about the Fed’s credibility in fighting inflation or about the long-term fiscal sustainability of the US government were behind the recent moves.

This backdrop, coupled with

minimal signs that inflation was progressing steadily to the 2 percent target, gave the Fed limited latitude to do anything but raise rates Wednesday.

Warsh’s decision to stake his reputation as chair on getting inflation down also bolstered the case. Warsh reinforced his commitment as recently as last month, stating in a closely watched speech at the central bank’s annual conference in Jackson, Wyo., that the Fed “must be confident that underlying inflation is moving to our objective, clearly and at sufficient speed. Otherwise, we have work to do.”

Warsh said Wednesday that he was most focused on the trends in inflation rather than

specific data points, which he described as “noisy.”

“Data point dependence is a dangerous preoccupation,” he added. “It’s not something that concerns me. Markets over time will come to understand how this Fed makes its decisions, what’s relevant and not.”

Most officials see inflation, as measured by the personal consumption expenditures price index, ending the year at 3.7 percent, slightly higher than officials thought just three months ago. They also revised up their estimates for “core” inflation, which strips out volatile food and energy items, to 3.4 percent.

As of the latest data in July, overall inflation stood at 3.7 percent compared with the same time last year. Core inflation was up 3.3 percent from a year earlier. The 2 percent target is not expected to be reached until 2029.

In 2027, the median estimate for rates stood at 4 percent to 4.25 percent, although there was a range of views. Eight policy makers forecast that rates would end the year a quarter of a percentage point higher than that, while four expected rates to be no higher than 3.5% to 3.75%.

Policymakers remained upbeat about the trajectory for growth and the labor market over this time period, projecting that the economy would expand 2.3 percent in 2026 and 2.4 percent in 2027. They see the unemployment rate slightly lower at 4.1 percent compared with three months ago, in line with today’s level.

The dot plot once again had fewer entries, with not all 19 policy makers submitting projections. Warsh in June declined to do so, reflecting his opposition to providing forecasts that he argues box the Fed in. One official submitted forecasts, but only through 2027.

EDITORIAL

Students shouldn’t fear speaking up on campus

Whatever happened to the notion of college campuses as vibrant centers for the free exchange of ideas? The motto of the American Academy of Arts and Sciences, founded in Massachusetts in 1780, is a Latin phrase meaning “They flourish in freedom,” reflecting the ideal of universities as places for students and scholars to freely discuss and debate the day’s controversies.

Yet, a new report by the Foundation for Individual Rights and Expression, based on its online survey of nearly 63,000 students at 262 four-year colleges nationwide, indicates how far students’ views of the university have strayed.

One theme that emerged is students don’t feel comfortable expressing their beliefs on campus. And the Globe’s reporting suggests that changing that may require active work by colleges.

Nearly half of students (48 percent) say they would feel uncomfortable expressing their views on a controversial political topic during an in-class discussion. A similar number feel uncomfortable disagreeing with a professor in a written assignment. A majority of students report self-censoring themselves at least once or twice a month during conversations with other students (57 percent) and professors (60 percent) and during class discussions (62 percent).

The hardest topics for students to have open and honest conversations about are the Israeli-Palestinian conflict, President Trump, slain conservative activist Charlie Kirk, and abortion.

Students also don’t want controversial speakers visiting campus.

FIRE asked whether a speaker who previously expressed one of six controversial statements — three conservative and three liberal — should be allowed to speak on campus, and in each case, a majority of students said no. That suggests some students don’t want controversial views on campus, regardless of ideological persuasion. For example, 75 percent said someone who believes transgender people have a mental disorder should not be allowed to speak, while 53 percent said a speaker who thinks children should be allowed to transition genders without parental consent should be barred.

Shockingly, 30 percent of students said the use of violence would be, at least rarely, acceptable to protest a disfavored speaker — which may be, perhaps, one reason why some students don’t want to speak up. The number of students who consider it acceptable to shout down a speaker (69 percent) or block students from attending a speech (50 percent) has risen significantly since 2020, when those numbers were at 61 percent and 37 percent respectively, the report found. FIRE’s chief researcher Sean Stevens told the edi-

The hardest topics for students to have open and honest conversations about are the Israeli-Palestinian conflict, President Trump, slain conservative activist Charlie Kirk, and abortion.

torial board the data suggest some students don’t want to engage with opposing voices, but some also have a “general aversion to controversy.” Many fear blowback from peers and professors. Stevens said he worries that a “presumption of certainty” among people on both sides of the political spectrum undermines colleges’ ability to be places where students can openly explore ideas.

Harvard University psychology professor Steven Pinker told the editorial board he’s seen a shift as colleges increasingly view themselves as instruments for advancing political and moral ideals, rather than institutions for discovering and transmitting knowledge. “If you have a vision of a university where people try to discover what works and what’s true, then since no one’s infallible or omniscient, free speech becomes a cardinal virtue even for people who disagree with you,” Pinker said.

So how can schools restore a spirit of open inquiry?

One model is Tufts University’s new Center for Expanding Viewpoints in Higher Education, which has created a space for challenging conversations through

workshops, public lectures, reading groups, and other forums. “One thing I’m trying to do with the center is give a real kickstart to opening up lots of conversations on topics that are interesting and popular,” inaugural director Eitan Hersh told the editorial board.

In its first year, the center had 2,270 attendees across 52 events. Upcoming events include discussions about whether it should be legal to mail abortion pills across state lines, the politics of settler colonialism, and the goal of settling Mars.

Hersh said it takes an intentional effort by faculty to get students of differing viewpoints and backgrounds in a room together, and that needs to be combined with strategies like banning technology and recording devices in class to encourage open dialogue.

Hersh said he’s also seen a tension between encouraging students to have open discussions — which many are willing to do — and their desire to fit in with students who often share one worldview. “I find that if you ask students to put on the right hat, the intellectually serious hat where they’re going to be asked to be in deep conversation about hard things, they really like that,” Hersh said. “But they have a push and pull when they’re also asked to wear other hats, like being cool.”

FIRE ranks colleges on their free speech policies, and four of five top-ranked schools this year — the University of Chicago, Claremont McKenna College, the Georgia Institute of Technology, and Vanderbilt University — have committed to institutional neutrality, meaning the university won’t make political statements.

But remaining neutral isn’t sufficient; schools must actively encourage free speech. A recent Globe story on FIRE’s rankings compared Northeastern University, which has taken a largely hands-off approach to speech, to Harvard, which made a concerted effort to encourage students to bridge ideological divides. The Globe found the Northeastern approach resulted in students feeling hesitant to speak out while Harvard students are feeling more comfortable.

There’s nothing wrong with students wanting to get a college education without engaging in politics. The problem comes when students feel they can’t speak honestly for fear of social or academic consequences.

KIMBERLY ATKINS STOHR

Trump lost ballot battle, but war on elections continues

There is no reason to believe that this week’s Supreme Court order dealing defeat to President Trump’s plan to limit mail-in balloting for this year’s midterms will curb the president’s desire to put his thumb on the scale of elections in November and beyond. In fact, it’s the Supreme Court that fortified Trump’s belief that he has king-like authority over elections.

“TOTAL EXONERATION,” is what Trump posted on Truth Social in 2024, after the justices ruled 6-3 that a president is immune from criminal prosecution for actions carried out in his official capacity.

Of course, what Trump posted wasn’t true. He was not exonerated for the actions he took in the effort to overturn the results of the 2020 presidential election, including sending supporters from his Washington, D.C., rally to the Capitol on Jan. 6, 2021, leading to a deadly siege as lawmakers were certifying the election results.

The justices did not find that Trump was innocent of crimes that special counsel Jack Smith charged him with, including conspiracy to defraud the United States, obstructing an official proceeding, and violating Americans’ right to have their votes counted.

Smith dropped the charges after Trump’s 2024 election victory, based on Justice Department policy that presidents cannot be criminally charged while in office. Smith’s charges were dismissed without prejudice, meaning they can be brought again after Trump leaves office if prosecutors can make the case that

Trump’s second term paused the statute of limitations on Trump’s alleged crimes.

Trump wasn’t exonerated, but no single act has empowered him to behave more like a king than the Supreme Court’s immunity ruling.

In his second term, he has acted as if his

tions wages on.

It is important to underscore that the court’s order, which left in place an injunction barring Trump’s efforts to use the US Postal Service to limit mail-in ballot access, is an important one. A cross-ideological majority of the court held that the Trump administration is likely to lose its argument that the president is empowered to order mail carriers to refuse to deliver ballots to voters who are not on a voter list compiled by the administration. In other words, mail carriers are empowered to move the mail, not implement the president’s voter suppression strategy.

But there are likely more challenges on the horizon.

Attorney General Todd Blanche told CBS News that the Justice Department is pressing ahead with criminal investigations into election practices in a number of states.

Blanche claimed, without giving specifics, that “there’s a lot of evidence” of state voter fraud, and advanced a debunked myth: “If you’re using mail-in voting, the potential for fraud is greater than in-person voting with ID.”

That isn’t true, but it hasn’t stopped the Justice Department from pressuring state election officials with the prospect of criminal charges. This summer, the Justice Department

sent letters to election officials in all 50 states and the District of Columbia warning them that they could be prosecuted for noncitizen voting.

It seems that Blanche is less concerned about keeping elections safe than he is in pleasing a president who has a long history of spreading lies about voter fraud and rigged elections.

Aside from weaponizing the Justice Department against state election officials, the administration is pressing legal challenges over other voter suppression tactics. Last week the Department of Homeland Security asked the Supreme Court to allow it to access Americans’ Social Security data to compile a federal list of eligible voters.

Under the Constitution, administering elections is the job of state officials, who are responsible for determining voter eligibility. While Congress has limited election regulation authority, the executive branch, which includes DHS, has none.

Yet it’s hard to know how the Supreme Court might rule if the justices take it up. Even Justice Brett Kavanaugh, who sided with the court’s majority in stopping mail carriers from acting as voter registration checkers, did so only because he thought it was too close to the midterms to change the rules. As for the executive branch’s authority to wade into voter registration rules, Kavanaugh wrote: “there is at least a fair prospect that the final rule falls within the Postal Service’s statutory authority.”

That would turn the Constitution on its head. But then again, so did the court’s immunity ruling, which is the foundation upon which all of Trump’s efforts to impact and discredit election results rests. I’m not a gambler, but if I were, wouldn’t bet on this court to always stand in his way.

Kimberly Atkins Stohr is a columnist for the Globe. She may be reached at kimberly.atkinsstohr@globe.com.



ROBERTO SCHMIDT/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Demonstrators outside the Capitol protested on Sept. 15 against Trump’s executive order that aimed to change mail-in voting.

power to undermine past and future election results is limitless. His executive order that attempted to restrict mail-in ballot access to some voters, which remains indefinitely blocked under the Monday’s Supreme Court order, was just one part of it. Trump may have lost that battle, at least as it applies to this year’s midterms. But his war on American elec-

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INBOX

How long do we have to wait for a solution to overcrowded emergency rooms?

Elective hospital admissions block patient flow — we’ve known this

Drs. Jonathan Olshaker and Scott Weiner correctly identify boarding as the principal cause of emergency department overcrowding (“Emergency room waits are too long. Here’s how Massachusetts can fix it,” Opinion, Sept. 8). They also recognize that elective admissions contribute to the problem. Yet their proposed remedies omit a demonstrated way of addressing that source of congestion.

Massachusetts has already tested it. As the Globe itself reported in a 2004 front-page article, rescheduling elective surgeries at Boston Medical Center helped prevent scheduled patients from occupying beds needed by emergency patients. I was directly involved in this effort. The hospital treated more patients while reducing waiting and ambulance diversion. This was not an isolated experiment. KFF Health News recently examined the approach and its results elsewhere.

I’ve been developing this approach since the 1990s. Later I served on the Institute of Medicine committee (now a part of the National Academy of Medicine), whose 2007 national report, “Hospital-Based Emergency Care: At the Breaking Point,” recommended smoothing elective admissions and spreading them evenly throughout the week as a way to reduce emergency department crowding.

Massachusetts may need more beds and staff. But before adding scarce resources, why not determine how much existing capacity could be recovered by taking a closer look at patient flow?

The elephant in the room has been overlooked.
EUGENE LITVAK
Lexington

The writer is president and CEO of the nonprofit Institute for Healthcare Optimization and an adjunct professor of operations management at the Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health.

A problem with many causes calls for many stakeholders to work together

Drs. Jonathan Olshaker and Scott Weiner diagnose an issue afflicting every Massachusetts hospital. A series of under-the-surface pressures are adding up to what patients now see: overburdened health care facilities with strained wait times.

Massachusetts hospitals have rallied around a comprehensive approach to tracking capacity issues since the COVID-19 pandemic, knowing the symptoms of this issue will never go away without solving the underlying causes.

An average of 2,000 patients a day are “stuck” in Massachusetts hospitals because they cannot access their next level of care. That leaves 2,000 beds unavailable to other patients walking through hospital doors.

This is a reality clinicians and hospital leaders alike are fighting to change. They have invested in a series of patient flow initiatives, behavioral health supports, regional transfer solutions, and innovative care models. We are grateful that the state has followed suit, sharpening its focus around discharge delays, workforce investments, and better cross-system coordination while also addressing insurance and guardianship obstacles.

But as the numbers show, more must be done for patients at their greatest time of need. We agree that a problem with many causes requires a solution with many partners, including provider organizations, clinicians, policy makers, insurers, and advocates.

ADAM DELMOLINO
*Senior director, virtual care and clinical affairs
Massachusetts Health and Hospital Association
Burlington*

BSO is expecting its next music director to be some kind of rock star

The op-ed by Chad Smith, president and CEO of the Boston Symphony Orchestra, reflects his and board members’ misguided attempt to popularize what is not a popular art form (“BSO’s next chapter begins with its musicians,” Opinion, Sept. 16). Smith’s “pipe dream,” as one online commenter put it, of a music director who is “present throughout the city, not just on the podium,” is like asking the director of the Museum of Fine Arts to be out in the schools and communities promoting Rembrandt and Picasso.

Being a director of world-class institutions such as the BSO and the MFA is a full-time job. This doesn’t mean expanding the audience for Mahler, Stravinsky, or Carlos Simon is an unworthy goal. I spent more than 30 years insisting that my students of all backgrounds could appreciate great literature. I had, however, no illusions about how many would read serious literature as adults.

Efforts such as free BSO concerts in public spaces and working with schools to advance the appreciation of classical music are fine. Expecting the music director to do management’s job or to build an audience like that of Taylor Swift or the Red Sox is not.

The core of what makes a great orchestra successful is what Smith and the board have in Andris Nelsons — a great conductor.

WILLIAM RAY
Boxborough

Carney’s pitch to world’s money managers is sound strategy for Canada

I read the article “Carney touts Canada as haven for investors” (Page A4, Sept. 16) with enthusiasm, trust, and faith. Prime Minister Mark Carney’s overture to a group of money managers from about 25 countries, including the United States, is a strategy that has to be successful. It is essential to the long term strength of our ally to the north. The United States can only gain from Canada’s growth when the 48th president heals the relationship our current president has fractured.

Canada will always be our neighbor. May we be strong allies, business partners, and friends again.

RICHARD K. PETERSON JR.
Lowell

JOAN VENNOCHI

Tom Menino knew when to bury a grudge. Will Michelle Wu?

As Boston prepared to host the 2004 Democratic National Convention, John Kerry, the party’s presumptive presidential nominee, and Mayor Tom Menino settled tensions between them during a 20-minute meeting in a campaign SUV.

Afterward, declaring their feud over, Menino told the Globe, “That’s yesterday. I can’t hold grudges.” It was more important, he said, for Kerry to win the White House.

Kerry didn’t win, and Menino famously held onto plenty of grudges against other people. But in that moment — greatly motivated by his self-interest in presiding over a political convention that united Democrats and looked good on national TV — Menino took the high road.

Surely there’s a lesson in that for Mayor Michelle Wu, who calls Menino her mentor and shares his zeal for feuds and grudge-holding.

That zeal was on full display this past primary season, when Wu tried but failed to oust two state senators who

Wu’s fight with Beacon Hill is a familiar one — Boston versus the rest of the state, which has always resented the attention and resources given to the capitol city.

opposed her legislative proposal to shift more of the city’s tax burden to the commercial sector. Although she has a new package of proposals that need legislative approval, Wu is still not in a bridge-building mood. As she told the Globe editorial board, she doesn’t have “the time or the capacity” to put her own effort into winning over the Senate.

Talk about poking the bear — in this case, Senate President Karen Spilka, who controls the Senate agenda and whose support Wu needs for her own agenda.

Wu’s fight with Beacon Hill is a familiar one — Boston versus the rest of the state, which has always resented the attention and resources given to the capitol city. “Same feud, same frustration,” said Jeffrey Sánchez, who was Menino’s Latino adviser, went on to serve in the House, and now works as a consultant at lobbying and public relations firm Rasky Partners on issues that include the effort to reach common ground on Wu’s tax proposal.

Of Wu and Spilka, he said in an interview, “They are not at that point of getting to the table,” but added, “I know they will get there.” Sanchez, who told me he misses “my grumpy uncle” — Menino — also sees a difference in the reaction to Wu’s resistance to launching any charm offensive. “We accepted it from Menino. It’s different now,

she’s a woman,” he said.

It’s true that over his 20 years as mayor, the media embraced Menino’s thin skin as an amusing feature of his leadership style and gleefully celebrated alleged acts of vengeance, such as running one mayoral challenger out of town. When Menino poked fun at his long-running battle with developer Don Chiofaro with a satirical video in which he acted like Vito Corleone in “The Godfather,” just about everyone laughed along with him. It was and still is pretty funny.

Wu’s efforts at humor have not gone over as well. When she tried joking at a St. Patrick’s Day breakfast in 2022 about an outdoor dining controversy in the North End by saying, “I’m getting used to dealing with problems that are expensive, disruptive, and white — I’m talking about snowflakes, snowflakes, snowstorms ... snowflakes” — critics blasted her for stoking racial and political divisions.

So yes, a double standard could be in play. But at this point in her second term as mayor, Wu has to figure out how to get past that. When dealing with Spilka, another strong-willed female leader, more of the same approach does not seem to be the answer.

If humor is not Wu’s strong suit, neither is admitting mistakes. When she recalculates her stance on policies, from taxes to bike and bus lanes, she won’t acknowledge the obvious politics at work. The city’s refusal to grant the Emerald Necklace Conservancy a permit needed for an annual fund-raiser was an example of extreme pettiness in the face of the group’s ultimately unsuccessful effort to stop her plan to redevelop White Stadium. The fight with North End restaurant owners over outdoor dining was nastier than it had to be.

She sailed to reelection last November, running unopposed after challenger Josh Kraft dropped out. Emboldened by that victory, she backed candidates who ran against Senators Will Brownsberger of Belmont and Nick Collins of South Boston because they crossed her. While Brownsberger won by only 35 votes, Collins handily won reelection.

Now Wu has to contend with a Senate that has little incentive to help her.

What advice would Menino give her? When I put that question to Sánchez, he said, “I’m all about seeking peace in the city.” He said Menino would say, “Stick to it, kid.”

Sticking to the mission of trying to get Beacon Hill to back Wu’s tax and housing agenda is fine.

But for any chance for that to happen, how Wu goes about it has to change.

Remember, Menino got into that SUV with Kerry when he wanted something badly enough to put his grudges behind him.

Joan Vennoch is a *Globe* columnist. She can be reached at joan.vennoch@globe.com. Follow her @joan_vennoch.

The missing safeguard for Flock cameras

By Tom Keane

Tom Keane is a freelance writer.

Flock Safety has been having a bad few weeks. The company that makes the omnipresent license plate readers says it’s making “better tools for safer communities,” but a lot of people aren’t so sure. To their minds, it’s George Orwell’s “1984” coming true 42 years later; Big Brother, they fear, is among us.

They’re right. But it’s also a problem that can be fixed.

LPRs are cameras, usually solar powered, mounted on things like telephone poles that scan traffic, reading license plates and entering that information into a vast database. Install enough of the LPRs and the police — and anyone else with access — can track a vehicle as it moves from place to place.

The crime-solving possibilities are striking. For example, say a child is kidnapped. Someone writes down the license plate of the car speeding away, and the police enter that into Flock’s system and track the vehicle. Using that information, they can narrow down its location and move to rescue that child.

Who, you might wonder, could oppose such a life-saving technology?

But Flock has been hit by a storm of controversy and opposition fueled by outrageous cases of abuse by police, fears that Flock is being used by Immigration and Customs Enforcement to track down immigrants, and a sense that the expansion of Flock’s network is creating a surveillance society that is eating away at our basic right to privacy.

A police officer in New Bedford allegedly used Flock to track a former girlfriend. An officer in Texas supposedly searched 83,000 cameras to find a woman who had an abortion. The controls on its use are weak; until recently, a simple say-so from an officer was usually enough to initiate a search. And there’s more to come: Flock has introduced new software called Freeform that, although not yet using facial recognition, employs video features to identify where people are traveling, what they are wearing, unique aspects of their vehicles, and the like.

All of that is why more than 25 Massachusetts communities — including Boston, Wellesley, Salem, and Framingham — have



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

A Flock camera in Revere.

severed their relationships with Flock. The town of Barnstable is one of the latest. (Disclosure: I’m a Barnstable town councilor and voted with the majority.)

There’s been pushback. Some argue Flock is nothing new: We can already be tracked through our cell phones, Ring cameras, Apple AirTags, and E-ZPasses. All of that is true. But the question is not whether communities *can* track people, but rather, *should* they track them? What is needed are guardrails.

Some are now being put in place. Prompted by mounting public criticism, Flock has rolled out new features such as reducing to seven the number of days data are retained, tying any search (except for emergencies) to an active criminal case, and allowing local police departments to turn off data-sharing with other departments and the federal government. Some police departments are tightening up their own controls; the Lynn Police Department, for example, now requires a supervisor to approve any search. And internal audit systems can flag in real time when there are multiple searches of the same vehicle or other signs of abuse.

All of these measures are good. But there’s one key guardrail that’s missing. The real solution to preventing abuse of LPRs, as

well as other devices of mass surveillance, is a tool that dates back to 17th century England, was eventually enshrined in the Fourth Amendment of the US Constitution, and has been used for 235 years for other forms of evidence gathering: a search warrant. The idea is simple: If police want to conduct a search, they need to go to a neutral third party — a judge — and make a sworn statement that they have “probable cause” that justifies a specific search for a specific reason.

In 2020, the Massachusetts Supreme Judicial Court ruled that LPRs did not require a warrant. But it did suggest that more ubiquitous use of the devices might cause the justices to change their minds: A person’s “constitutionally protected expectation of privacy in the whole of his public movements ... could be implicated by the widespread use of ALPRs [Automated License Plate Readers].”

Six years later, that ubiquity has arrived. Massachusetts — either through the courts or the Legislature — should impose a warrant requirement for Flock searches. Law enforcement is correct that LPRs can be a valuable tool. And should the right safeguards be put in place, communities like Barnstable might well reconsider. But until then, Flock cameras should be banned.

Police use of AI social media tool questioned

► **LIFERAFT**
Continued from Page A1

The disclosure of the department’s expanding digital investigative capabilities comes nearly a decade after a backlash by civil rights and religious groups concerned about racial profiling prompted BPD to abandon its plan to spend \$1.4 million on a social media monitoring tool.

Now, two Boston councilors said the department should have asked, or at least told, the council about its new tools — pointing to an ordinance that requires disclosure of new surveillance measures.

“We have yet to see sufficient evidence that [social media analysis tools] actually deliver greater public safety for all of our communities,” said Councilor Julia Mejia. “If we are going to ask residents to trust how their government uses these powerful technologies, then we have to start modeling what it looks like to lead with real accountability and transparency.”

A spokesperson in Mayor Michelle Wu’s office said the technology helps officers identify threats in a timely manner.

“We will continue working with city councilors as they review the use of surveillance technology, including transparency and safeguards for our residents,” the spokesperson said.

According to the city report, use of the social media surveil-

lance tool is limited to a small group in the Bureau of Intelligence and Analysis. That bureau oversees the Boston Regional Intelligence Center, which coordinates information among local, state, and federal law enforcement agencies. The center, also known as BRIC, is partially funded by the Department of Homeland Security.

Alongside LifeRaft, Boston police has been using two other similar social media monitoring tools, SITE Intelligence Group’s SourceFeed, and Chorus Intelligence Suite.

In 2025, the BPD spent roughly \$130,000 on social media monitoring tools.

These tools have helped the department in more than 30 sexual assault investigations and in the arrest of a suspect who made violent threats against elected officials last year, according to the report.

Still, the city’s report offers little insight into how the technology is used, or what specific features the monitoring tools offer.

Mariellen Burns, a Boston police spokesperson, said 10 “specially trained members” of the department use LifeRaft several times each week.

“Increasing aspects of criminal or threatening behavior occur online,” she said in a statement. “Useful technology is essential to the Department’s

ability to identify potential criminal threats to public safety.”

She added the software “must be used in a way that preserves public trust and fulfills our mission of Community and Constitutional Policing.”

Social media has long been used by investigators, but software tools that can conduct a kind of digital dragnet have prompted alarm among civil liberties groups. Such advocates worry about issues around free speech, data privacy, and possible misuse of the technology.

“Just because something is publicly available doesn’t mean that it should be accessible with no constraints to law enforcement agencies,” said Rachel Levinson-Waldman, national security program director at the Brennan Center for Justice, a nonprofit public policy institute in New York.

Levinson-Waldman said that while Boston police has used social media monitoring for years, LifeRaft appears to offer much broader scraping and analysis capabilities, including using AI for “sentiment analysis” — a feature that claims to measure public perception and spot early signs of hostility and aggression in online forums.

“Social media is so contextual. It is so easy to misinterpret,” she said. “I think [sentiment analysis] can shade really easily into targeting on the basis of ide-

ology.”

Local advocacy groups, such as the Muslim Justice League, have been outspoken against BRIC, the fusion center, and its mass surveillance capabilities.

Over a decade ago, Boston police used tools including Geofeedia to scour social media posts for Arabic phrases and, later, posts related to the Black Lives Matter movement, said Fatema Ahmad, executive director of the Muslim Justice League.

“These tools can . . . categorize your politics and predict who is potentially dangerous or violent based on their politics and their free speech,” she said.

This is not the first time Boston police and BRIC have faced scrutiny over social media surveillance. During a 2024 criminal case, the department refused to turn over information of its undercover Snapchat accounts and cartoon profile images, leading critics to question whether it racially profiled Black people in covert social media operations. And in May of this year, the Brennan Center published an investigation concluding that BRIC’s social media monitoring has been conducted informally, without specific reasons, and with little oversight.

According to the city’s surveillance report, the department cannot track people solely on the basis of their religion, political views, race, age, or ethnicity, un-

less directly related to criminal activity. The tools, according to the city’s report, can only be used in investigations of criminal activity and to gather information for crime analysis, situational assessments, and event planning for maintaining public safety.

“LifeRaft is a threat intelligence platform. Security teams use it to identify publicly disclosed risks to the people, sites, and events they are responsible for protecting,” a LifeRaft spokesperson said in a statement. “It provides no covert access to private accounts, private messages, devices, or location data. It is neither built nor licensed for persistent observation of individuals.”

Boston police has experimented with social media monitoring for over a decade. In 2017, it backed down from a decision to spend \$1.4 million on social media surveillance expansion following local pushback. It then adopted SITE and Chorus in 2023 and 2024 under “exigent circumstances,” which allowed it to bypass City Council approval, and acknowledged delays in notifying the council under the surveillance ordinance.

According to the city’s surveillance ordinance, exigent circumstances can only be used when it’s reasonable to believe that an emergency could result in death, serious injuries, or damage to property. For SITE

and Chorus, it cited “heightened threats nationally and locally” ahead of the 2024 elections.

But the BPD’s frequent use of exigent circumstances raised alarm among council members. The council voted against the use of SITE and Chorus in August 2025, according to meeting minutes, although the department continues to use them.

Now, city councilors question why the department has continued to use the tools, and added LifeRaft without informing the council.

In a related technology controversy, Boston police earlier this year switched vendors of automatic license plate readers without seeking the council’s approval, prompting some city councilors to allege the mayor’s office should have sought their permission first. The mayor’s office said it was permitted to move forward with the vendor change without needing the council’s blessing.

“It appears that BPD failed to notify the council before acquiring the technology,” said Councilor Ben Weber, who serves on the city’s Surveillance Oversight Advisory Board. “Going forward, we should probably amend the surveillance ordinance to provide better oversight of these decisions.”

Yogev Toby can be reached at yogev.toby@globe.com.

In Newton, mini horse could be a little problem — or a big one

► **CLOVER**
Continued from Page A1

the flies attracted by it. Some neighbors also said Clover had “repeatedly” gotten out of the backyard enclosure and onto neighbors’ properties.

The smell, Hinchey said, was because Clover had been “over-eating” grass in the yard. That issue has been solved by keeping her in a dirt lot, she said. Hinchey said she picks up the manure several times a day and keeps it in a sealed barrel with an odor-killing chemical.

“Everyone that comes over here says they can’t smell manure,” Hinchey said. “I don’t smell it . . . they don’t smell it. Do the neighbors still think they smell it? I don’t have an answer to that.”

One neighbor, Oksana Maiorova, said Wednesday that the smell isn’t constant but sometimes wafts over the property line.

“Now I don’t go to the balcony, because I cannot sit,” Maiorova said. “I don’t like this smell.”

Maiorova said she has no problem with the horse staying, as long as the smell is controlled. She questioned, though, whether it could be eliminated entirely.

“It is a horse,” she said. City officials told Maiorova the property would be inspected for its odor that same week. But that inspection never came, according to Hinchey’s attorney, Michael Ross.

“Could you legitimately shut down a facility like this without physically inspecting it?” Ross said at the hearing. “It’s a legal question. . . . I’m concerned the reason for [the original denial] had more to do with the complaints and less to do with the actual facts on the ground.”

Hinchey said she fell in love with miniature horses after volunteering with a group that brings therapeutic animals to schools and rehab centers. Last year, she bought Clover, a certified therapy horse, with the goal of opening her own therapeutic practice.

She said she sought and received city approval to build a stall for the horse in her yard.

But after neighbors complained about manure, the Newton Health Department got involved. When it denied Hinchey’s application for an animal license last month, the department cited regulations requiring manure for animals be kept in stables to be stored at least 100 feet from property lines and 50 feet from any dwelling unit.

Hinchey contends that she built a stall, not a stable, and that the regulations were written with full-size horses in mind.

“A mini horse is not the same



PHOTOS BY SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Judy Hinchey contends that the city’s rules are meant for full-size horses, not a small one like Clover, who weighs 165 pounds.

as a horse,” Hinchey said. “I mean, she’s 28.5 inches; a horse is like 58 to 68 inches. She weighs 165 pounds; a horse weighs 900 to 1,200 pounds. The amount of manure that’s made is dramatically smaller.”

The commissioner for Newton’s Health and Human Services department declined to comment, citing the pending appeal.

Massachusetts law formally recognizes miniature horses as livestock, but Hinchey argues Newton’s regulations fail to account for their smaller size. The city does make size-based distinctions in other cases: regular pigs are considered “animals” while smaller Vietnamese pot-bellied pigs may be kept as pets.

Ross, the attorney, argued that the department is “mis-reading . . . its own ambiguous regulations” and that its denial violated state law.

Hinchey said she has been working since 2024 to bring a mini horse to her backyard and has consistently tried to follow city rules. At one point, she said, a city health official verbally told her she could keep Clover without a permit.

“I called and [said], ‘I’m not going to build this unless you’re going to let me have a mini horse,’” she said. “I’m not an idiot. And the person said, ‘Go ahead and build it.’”

She filed an application for



an animal license anyway. More than a year later — and after getting zoning approval to build the stall — that application was denied.

The city’s apparent reversal left her “furious,” she said.

“Their process is horrific and has cost me tons of stress and tons of money,” Hinchey said.

“All it [would have taken] was for [the city] to read the application [a year ago] and make the determination that I wouldn’t qualify based on their criteria.”

Hinchey, a vascular neurologist, stepped away from her role as director of the stroke center at BMC Brighton at the beginning of September, in large part

because she hopes to establish a miniature horse therapy practice.

She said she spent “all my savings” on Clover, including redeveloping her backyard and building the stall and enclosures.

To see all that work go to waste, she said, would be “dev-

astating.”

“I’ll want to leave Newton, if this is my neighborhood,” she said.

Camilo Fonseca can be reached at camilo.fonseca@globe.com. Follow him on X @[fonseca_esq](https://twitter.com/fonseca_esq) and on Instagram @[camilo_fonseca.reports](https://www.instagram.com/camilo_fonseca.reports).

ANNIE DILLARD 1945-2026



JILL KREMENTZ

Ms. Dillard in 1974, the year “A Pilgrim at Tinker Creek” was published.

Writer, ‘seeker, mystic, explorer, philosopher’ — and a Cape lover

By Bryan Marquard
GLOBE STAFF

In an oft-invoked anecdote a few pages into Annie Dillard’s Pulitzer Prize-winning “Pilgrim at Tinker Creek,” she watches a half-submerged frog collapse and die, dispatched from life by a giant water bug.

“The spirit vanished from his eyes as if snuffed. His skin emptied and drooped; his very skull seemed to collapse and settle like a kicked tent,” Ms. Dillard wrote in what may be the most famous passage from her decades-long career writing nonfiction books, essays, novels, and poetry.

“He was shrinking before my eyes like a deflating football. I watched the taut, glistening skin on his shoulders ruck, and rumple, and fall. Soon, part of his skin, formless as a pricked balloon, lay in floating folds like bright scum on top of the water: it was a monstrous and terrifying thing.”

Ms. Dillard, whose poetic observations could immortalize a frog’s demise, a solar eclipse, and post-World War II life in Provincetown, was 81 when she died Tuesday in her South Wellfleet home, where she lived for part or much of each year in her later decades.

Her literary executor, Maggie Nelson, said she died of “natural causes at her home, which overlooks the cove that she loved,” according to a statement provided to The Boston Globe by Ms. Dillard’s family.

Ms. Dillard had set her final book, “The Maytrees” (2007), in Provincetown along the dunes where Cape Cod curls into the Atlantic.

Lou and Toby Maytree made their home where “pioneer bay dwellers” had cut so much firewood that “topsoil blew away, leaving a Sahara of dunes on the primordial sandspit. There was no rock anywhere, just that stretch of sand the coastwise current picked up from crumbling cliffs to the south and dropped here in a spiral.”

“Tinker Creek” was published in 1974, a few months after her first book, the poetry collection “Tickets for a Prayer Wheel.”

Ms. Dillard’s accounts of her nature pilgrimage announced the arrival of a unique writer – one who “eludes classification,” Globe book critic Gail Caldwell wrote in 1983.

“Annie Dillard has been called seeker, Christian mystic, explorer, philosopher, naturalist, and a writer ‘posing as a hillbilly,’” Caldwell wrote. “With the possible exception of the last, none is incorrect, and yet no one term suffices.”

Reviewers of “Tinker Creek” saw an heir to Henry David Thoreau, the subject of a thesis Ms. Dillard wrote at Hollins College in Virginia.

She cut her own path on the page and in her life, though, initially heading to Bellingham, Wash., in part to escape heightened attention the 1975 Pulitzer for general nonfiction had brought.

Drawing from experiences there, Ms. Dillard published “Holy the Firm” (1977), an intense, slender volume critics likened to a prose poem.

“Every day is a god, each day is a god, and holiness holds forth in time,” she wrote to open the book, which includes a scene of a moth flying into a candle flame that seemed in conversation from afar with the doomed frog of “Tinker Creek.”

Her other books included “Living By Fiction” (1982), “Encounters with Chinese Writers” (1984), and “The Living” (1992), her first novel, which she set

DILLARD, Page B3

INSIDE

Macklemore, Kraft offer aid

The donations, pledged for humanitarian assistance for Palestinians, were the latest development in a controversy that erupted after the rapper Macklemore was removed from a tour that’s set to play at Gillette Stadium. **B2.**

Clancy development

Lindsay Clancy hired prominent attorney Martin G. Weinberg, who said he plans to file a motion to dismiss her triple-murder case on double jeopardy grounds. **B2.**

Parking on game day

A survey will be sent to neighbors of White Stadium in Boston, asking them about parking protections around the field on Boston Legacy FC game days. **B4.**

Scooter struck

A driver ran a red light, according to Mayor Michelle Wu’s office, and struck a scooter rider near the site where a transportation planner was fatally struck in July while riding her bike. **B5.**

T drops its restrictive RIDE rules

After outcry, agency gives elderly and disabled more leeway on belongings

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

The MBTA is reversing some of its most restrictive rules on what riders can — and cannot — bring on their door-to-door trips on the agency’s paratransit service, The RIDE, altering a policy that some riders said radically upended their routines.

Under the agency’s new policy, released on Wednesday, the MBTA is again allowing the service’s population of elderly users and people with disabilities to keep their belongings inside RIDE trunks and some foldable carts.

The T has said it also plans to install luggage racks in RIDE vans “soon,” and eventually give riders the option to indicate whether they

are bringing luggage or a shopping cart when they book a trip to help “make sure there is enough space on the vehicle.”

Riders are allowed to bring carts measuring up to 23 inches by 22 inches by 41 inches.

The changes are a welcome development for riders with wheelchairs and other mobility challenges, who told the Globe that the stricter rules the T enacted last year curtailed their ability to travel with groceries and get around independently.

Carolyn Villers, executive director of the Massachusetts Senior Action Council, said the new policy addresses many concerns the advocacy group raised with the T, and “reflects the reality that the RIDE is

more than a way to get from place to place.”

“It has been a difficult year for many who depend on the RIDE, but this change happened because people refused to accept the unacceptable and came together to be heard,” Villers said. “This policy shows what’s possible when the MBTA partners with the customers it serves, and we look forward to building on this important first step to improve the RIDE for everyone who depends on it.”

Phil Eng, the T’s general manager and the state’s interim transportation secretary, thanked members of the Massachusetts Senior Action Council for “sharing their needs so we can allow carts while still ensuring safety for all including our operators.”

“Providing riders with safe and reliable trips is our priority,” Eng said in a statement Wednesday.

“We look forward to continued dialogue with Mass Senior Action and all of our riders as we strive to continuously improve every mode of travel that we offer.”

Riders in past years been able to stow all their shopping either in the rear of a van or the trunk of a RIDE sedan, but under the limitations implemented last August, patrons were required to fit folded carts and belongings within their own sitting area, often jammed in by their feet or resting on their stomachs.

T officials had said the policy was intended to make the RIDE safer and faster for the roughly 4,000 weekly riders who use the shared door-to-door service. Fewer bags, T officials said, would leave more space for wheelchairs and walkers and prevent the possibility of produce and eggs shifting

THE RIDE, Page B3



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

SERVICE RECOGNIZED

Brigadier General Enoch “Woody” Woodhouse II received a pin from Peter Rice, president and CEO of the Hanscom Federal Credit Union, Wednesday at the State House, as Woodhouse was recognized as the emeritus chair of the Hanscom Federal Credit Union Charitable Foundation. He is a Roxbury native and one of the original Tuskegee Airmen from World War II.

Mayor faces an assault charge

Accused of touching a 17-year-old girl

By John R. Ellement
GLOBE STAFF

Brockton Mayor Moises M. Rodrigues is now facing a charge of assault and battery for allegedly touching a 17-year-old girl against her will during a city parade in May, records show.

Prosecutors brought the charge after a clerk magistrate’s hearing in August, when Rodrigues testified that he had no recollection of interacting with the teenager.

“I don’t recall, for the life of me. I didn’t even know the person,” he said during the Aug. 7 hearing in Wrentham District Court.

He is scheduled to be arraigned in Hingham District Court on Sept. 28, and one of his defense attorneys said Wednesday that the case will go to trial.

“There will be a formidable defense, of that you can rest assured,” Theodore A. Barone said in a telephone interview.

“I am not going to try this case in the news media, but we will be trying this case and the mayor proclaims his innocence.”

Barone said the family of the teenage girl has pursued the case against Rodrigues because of money.

“There is a financial motive on behalf of at least the family of the alleged victim, and that’s clear,”



MARK JARRET CHAVOUS/POOL FILE

Moises M. Rodrigues said he has no recollection of the incident.

Barone said. “The mayor’s representatives have received a letter already demanding \$150,000.”

Barone declined to provide more details about the letter. The lawyer for the family, Alex J. Grant, could not be reached for comment.

Barone said Rodrigues does not plan to resign.

“He’s doing his best as he always has to try and run the city in a good, progressive way,” Barone said. “That’s what he is trying to stay focused on from a day-to-day standpoint.”

The issue first surfaced publicly during the Brockton High School graduation ceremony on June 6, when the mother of the teenager angrily made her way across the field and confronted Rodrigues, who was standing on the stage.

“You have to [expletive] get out of here,” the woman can be heard

yelling in a video posted by the city’s public access channel. “You know what you did to my daughter. You know what you did to my daughter.”

The allegation stems from an interaction at the Huntington Parade on May 22, when Rodrigues allegedly put his arm around the girl, a trombone player, as she marched with the Brockton High School band.

At the Aug. 7 hearing, State Police Captain John Santos testified that the accusation against Rodrigues was based on videos, photographs, and interviews with the girl and other witnesses.

“I believe this touching was not consensual,” Santos said. “Rodrigues did not have any reason to physically interact with any of the students in the marching band. Rodrigues’s role in the parade was to walk with the politicians.”

Rodrigues, the first person of color elected to lead Brockton, is a former child protection specialist with the Roman Catholic Archdiocese of Boston who has said he has never previously been accused of misconduct.

The case is being prosecuted by Norfolk District Attorney Michael W. Morrissey’s office to avoid conflict of interest concerns with the office of Plymouth District Timothy J. Cruz, officials said.

John R. Ellement can be reached at john.ellement@globe.com.

Doctor: Shooting suspect was ill

Cites psychotic disorder

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

BURLINGTON, Vt. — A key witness in the trial of Jason Eaton, who is charged in the November 2023 shootings of three Palestinian students, testified Wednesday that Eaton was suffering from a psychotic disorder at the time and could not distinguish right from wrong.

Dr. Fabian Saleh, a forensic psychiatrist at the Johns Hopkins School of Medicine, said in Chittenden Superior Court that Eaton believed he was acting on the orders of intelligence agencies and a higher power when he allegedly shot the young men.

“In my opinion, he did suffer from a mental disease,” Saleh said. “And that he, as a result of that mental disease, lacked adequate ability to appreciate the criminality of his conduct.”

The testimony came on the third day of a trial for Eaton, who faces three counts of second-degree attempted murder in the shootings, which paralyzed one victim from the chest down and wounded the others. Eaton has pleaded not guilty by reason of insanity. Saleh is the central witness for the defense, which argues Eaton cannot be held responsible for his alleged actions due to his mental state at the time.

During Saleh’s testimony, defense attorneys played several recordings of Eaton speaking with them five days after the shooting, which took place on a quiet residential street over the Thanksgiving holiday. The recordings provided the clearest picture yet of Eaton’s condition at the time: manic and confused, but also articulate and assertive.

Eaton describes hearing from the Central Intelligence Agency, Israeli intelligence, his own ancestors, and God through FM radio and Bluetooth in the weeks and moments before the shooting. The narrative is confusing, but he maintains that he had been charged with conducting “an over-watch” of a Jewish household across the street from his apartment, referring to it as “a kibbutz.”

On the night of the attack, he says in the 2023 recording, he received another instruction: “They want me to shoot someone. It’s unclear to me who.”

Eaton suggests that the

SHOOTINGS, Page B5

Lindsay Clancy hires Read attorney

By Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF

Lindsay Clancy has hired prominent attorney Martin G. Weinberg, who briefly joined Karen Read’s legal team and more recently secured an acquittal for the Suffolk County sheriff in a federal extortion case, records show.

Weinberg on Tuesday filed a “notice of limited appearance” on behalf of Clancy in Plymouth Superior Court, to represent her “in regards to filing and litigating a forthcoming Motion to Dismiss for Double Jeopardy and related matters.”

The motion will presumably be related to the circumstances of her mistrial, which Judge Wil-

liam Sullivan declared after the jury said it could not reach a unanimous verdict.

Clancy, 36, a former labor and delivery nurse, has pleaded not guilty to three counts of first-degree murder in the 2023 deaths of her children, Cora, 5, Dawson, 3, and 8-month-old Callan.

Clancy admitted she strangled her children but argued through counsel that she wasn’t criminally responsible, a strategy commonly known as the insanity defense, because she was suffering from postpartum psychosis at the time.

Her trial ended in a hung jury on Sept. 4, with Sullivan declaring a mistrial after jurors said they remained deadlocked fol-

lowing roughly 38 hours of deliberations.

Multiple jurors have said in interviews that the margin was 11-1 in favor of acquitting Clancy for lack of criminal responsibility, with the lone holdout acknowledging he had doubt but still refusing to vote not guilty.

Weinberg is no stranger to high-profile cases. He argued before the state Supreme Judicial Court in 2024 on behalf of Read, who at the time was seeking the dismissal of some charges that remained pending after her first murder trial ended in a mistrial declaration earlier that summer.

Read’s request was denied, but a second jury ultimately acquitted her of murder at her re-

trial last year.

Weinberg also represented Suffolk Sheriff Steven W. Tompkins, who was acquitted this month of two counts of extortion stemming from his dealings with a local cannabis company.

He also represented Richard Vitale, a friend and onetime financial adviser to former state House speaker Salvatore F. DiMasi, when Vitale was acquitted of federal corruption charges in a 2011 case that brought down the once-powerful lawmaker.

In the Clancy matter, prosecutors haven’t said whether they intend to retry her; a hearing is scheduled for Sept. 29.

Should Clancy be acquitted for lack of criminal responsibili-



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF FILE

Martin Weinberg, pictured last year, says he plans to file a motion to dismiss the case on double jeopardy grounds.

ty at a potential retrial, she would not go free but would be sent to a state psychiatric hospital where she’d come up for periodic reviews to determine if she could safely live in the communi-

ty. The final decision to release her under that scenario would be made by a judge.

Travis Andersen can be reached at travis.andersen@globe.com.

Macklemore, Kraft pledge millions for aid groups

By Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

Macklemore and New England Patriots owner Robert Kraft each pledged major contributions Wednesday toward humanitarian aid for Palestinians, the latest turn in a controversy over the rapper’s removal from Ed Sheeran’s tour.

Macklemore said he would donate more than \$1 million in net earnings he received as a supporting act on the tour and challenged Kraft to match his contribution. Kraft responded hours later, saying he had already agreed to donate \$2 million after Sheeran asked him to match a contribution of his own toward humanitarian aid in the region.

“Whatever we disagree about, perhaps we can agree on this: Palestinian lives are worth protecting,” Macklemore wrote in a lengthy Instagram post.

The donations are the latest development in a controversy that erupted this week after Macklemore was removed from Sheeran’s Loop Tour following pro-Palestinian remarks he gave during a show at MetLife Stadium in New Jersey, where he exclaimed “Free Palestine.”

Macklemore said Monday that Kraft, the billionaire owner of the Patriots and Gillette Stadium, had told Sheeran that Macklemore would not be permitted to perform in Foxborough. Macklemore also alleged Kraft had encouraged other stadium owners to oppose his participation in the tour.

Kraft acknowledged that he would not allow Macklemore to perform at Gillette Stadium, saying the decision was based on the rapper’s recent remarks and what Kraft described as a “broader history of antisemitic rhetoric and imagery.”

Sheeran, meanwhile, attempted to defuse the situation on Tuesday, saying that it was the promoter’s decision to bar Macklemore — not his own.

By the end of the day, however, his remaining supporting acts— including his backing band — had left the tour. Several said they objected to what they characterized as the silencing of an artist for speaking in support of Palestinians.

Kraft, who founded the Foundation to Combat Antisemitism, has said his objection to Macklemore was not intended to diminish “the suffering of innocent Palestinians” or stifle advocacy on their behalf.

“I believe deeply that all lives are worth protecting,” Kraft said on social media Wednesday.

Macklemore, who has received an outpouring of support from other artists and politicians, said the conversation surrounding his removal has pulled focus from “where it belongs: to the Palestinian people.”

“That is what this has always been about. Not me. Not a tour. Not the headlines or the controversy. It is about Palestinians’ right to freedom, dignity ,and safety in their own homeland,” the Seattle-bred hip-hop artist said.

Macklemore said he would donate his tour earnings to six organizations: Palestine Children’s Relief Fund, HEAL Palestine, Gaza Soup Kitchen, Medical Aid for Palestinians, American Near East Refugee Aid, and United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugee.

He encouraged others to do the same if they’re able.

Shannon Larson can be reached at shannon.larson@globe.com.



PHOTOS BY LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF



SWEET AND SWEAT
— A runner emerged from a canopy of foliage in Torbert MacDonald Park in the Mystic River Reservation in Medford on a warm day earlier this month. At left, pollinators were busy at work around goldenrod.

Hackers steal student, staff information in cyberattack

By Tonya Alanez
GLOBE STAFF

A cyberattack that closed Springfield Public Schools last week also breached the data of students and staff, possibly including social security numbers, officials said.

On Tuesday afternoon, the FBI contacted the school district to report the data breach.

The full extent of exactly what information was breached and where it was leaked remains under investigation. Authorities said the breach ap-

pears to include student and staff information.

Staff social security numbers may have been among the stolen information, but that has not been confirmed, the district said in a statement on Tuesday.

Students’ social security numbers are not typically noted in student data files, according to the statement.

“The district fully understands the concerns this latest news raises for thousands of members of the Springfield Public Schools community,” the dis-

trict said.

The cyberattack crippled the district’s ability to function and led to a four-day closure Tuesday through Friday, just as the academic year was getting started. Classes resumed Monday.

The attack hindered access to vital and basic IT systems, including email and phones, medical and food databases, as well as classroom curriculum, Mayor Domenic J. Sarno’s office said.

Neither Sarno, nor Springfield Schools Superintendent Sonia E. Dinnall could be

reached for comment Tuesday.

Springfield has one of the largest school districts in Massachusetts, with more than 23,000 students, a teacher workforce that tops 2,000, and dozens of public schools.

At a news conference last week, Sarno declined to detail how the cyberattack unfolded. As for who was responsible, he described them as a “sophisticated” group of hackers.

Tonya Alanez can be reached at tonya.alanez@globe.com.

This day in history

Today is Thursday, Sept. 17, the 260th day of 2026. There are 105 days left in the year.

Birthdays: Senator Chuck Grassley is 93. Mountaineer Reinhold Messner is 82. Basketball Hall of Fame coach Phil Jackson is 81. Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi is 76. Actor Cassandra Peterson (“Elvira, Mistress of the Dark”) is 75. Director-actor Paul Feig is 64. Director Baz Luhrmann is 64. Singer BeBe Winans is 64. Actor Kyle Chandler is 61. Rapper Doug E. Fresh is 60. Author Cheryl Strayed is 58. NASCAR driver Jimmie Johnson is 51. NHL forward Alexander Ovechkin is 41. NFL quarter-

back Patrick Mahomes is 31.

►In 1774 , the First Continental Congress in Philadelphia unanimously approved the Suffolk Resolves, its first official act. The Suffolk Resolves, adopted by the towns of Suffolk County, called on its citizens to boycott British goods, train in a local militia, and reject the Intolerable Acts, which closed the port of Boston and replaced an elected local legislature with one appointed by England. In approving the declaration, the other 12 colonies cast their lot in with rebellious Massachusetts.

►In 1787, the Constitution of the United States was completed

and signed by a majority of delegates in Philadelphia.

►In 1862, more than 3,600 men were killed in the Civil War Battle of Antietam in Maryland.

►In 1908, Lieutenant Thomas E. Selfridge of the Army Signal Corps became the first person to die in the crash of a powered aircraft, the Wright Flyer, at Fort Myer, Va., just outside Washington, D.C. The pilot, Orville Wright, was seriously hurt.

►In 1978, after 12 days of meetings at Camp David, Egyptian President Anwar Sadat and Israeli Prime Minister Menachem Begin signed the Camp David Accords, a framework for a

peace treaty.

►In 2001, six days after 9/11, stock prices nosedived but stopped short of collapse in an emotional, flag-waving reopening of Wall Street.

►In 2011, a demonstration calling itself Occupy Wall Street began in New York, prompting similar protests around the United States and the world.

►In 2024, thousands of paggers distributed to the militant group Hezbollah blew up in homes, offices, and front lines across Lebanon, remotely detonated by Israel. The attack killed 12 people and wounded more than 3,000 others.

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Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)
EXACT ORDER
All 4 digits \$3,533
First or last 3 \$495
Any 2 digits \$42
Any 1 digit \$4
ANY ORDER
All 4 digits \$589
First 3 \$165
Last 3 \$165
WEDNESDAY NIGHT 5272
Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)
EXACT ORDER
All 4 digits \$4,411
First or last 3 \$618
Any 2 digits \$53
Any 1 digit \$5
ANY ORDER
All 4 digits \$368
First 3 \$103
Last 3 \$206
MILLIONAIRE FOR LIFE
Sept. 15 **5-6-14-36-38 MB 3**
Jackpot: \$1 million a year

MASS CASH
Sept. 16 **5-23-31-32-33**
Jackpot: \$100,000; no winners
MEGABUCKS
Sept. 16 **12-15-23-31-38-43**
Jackpot: \$500,000; no winners
MEGA MILLIONS
Sept. 15 **27-36-43-57-58**
Megaball 16
Jackpot: \$227,000,000; no winners
PREVIOUS DRAWINGS

	Midday	Night
Tuesday	2682	8173
Monday	6982	3817
Sunday	0055	7893
Saturday	4958	4352
Friday	6468	0213

WEDNESDAY NUMBERS AROUND NEW ENGLAND
Maine, N.H., Vermont
Day: 3-digit **057** 4-digit **4485**
Eve: 3-digit **835** 4-digit **4567**
Wed. Tri-State Megabucks
9-18-20-28-33 MB 3
Rhode Island **2244**
Powerball **2-21-24-25-64 (7)**



JILL KREMENTZ



STEPHEN ROSE FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE/FILE

Ms. Dillard (left) in 1974, the year her Pulitzer-Prize winning book was published, and (right), outside her Wellfleet cottage in 2002. She died Tuesday in Wellfleet.

Annie Dillard dies at 81; famed writer loved the Cape

►DILLARD

Continued from Page B1

in 19th century logging communities near Puget Sound in the Pacific Northwest.

In the 1982 essay collection “Teaching a Stone to Talk,” Ms. Dillard’s eye for transcendent detail turned “Total Eclipse” into an often-taught piece of prose, a favorite among fans.

As the western sky “deepened to indigo, a color never seen,” Ms. Dillard glanced at the ground to see the eclipse transform the grasses around her. “Their every detail of stem, head, and blade shone lightless and artificially distinct as an art photographer’s platinum print.”

Meta Ann Doak was born in Pittsburgh on April 30, 1945, the oldest of three sisters.

Her father, Frank Doak, was an executive in his family’s manufacturing firm American Standard whose “romantic wander-

lust won out for a few months in 1955, when he set a boat down river on the Allegheny and headed for New Orleans,” Caldwell wrote in a 1987 Globe review of Ms. Dillard’s memoir, “An American Childhood.”

Though often deferring to Frank’s stellar timing telling a joke, Ms. Dillard’s mother, Pam Lambert Doak, had a sharp ear for an unintentionally amusing phrase, such as “Terwilliger bunts one” – a chance line from a radio broadcast of a baseball game. Pam made the phrase her own – a repeated punchline in no need of a setup.

Of her early Pittsburgh girlhood, Ms. Dillard wrote: “I was just waking up then, just barely.” By turns, life unfurled slowly or hurriedly. A driver irritated by schoolchildren’s hurled snowballs chased her for 10 blocks “through backyard labyrinths,” which she rendered in a cine-

matically nail-biting scene.

Ms. Dillard graduated with a bachelor’s degree and master’s from what was then Hollins College in Hollins, Va.

While there she married Richard Dillard, a creative writing teacher. Their marriage ended in divorce, as did a second marriage, to anthropologist Gary Clevidence, with whom Ms. Dillard had a child, Cody-Rose.

In 1988, she married the biographer Robert D. Richardson, whom she met after sending him a fan letter about his 1986 book “Henry Thoreau: A Life of the Mind.” He died in 2020.

After teaching college courses in the Pacific Northwest, Ms. Dillard joined the faculty of Wesleyan University in Middletown, Conn., where she taught until retiring in 2001.

“What kind of writer is Annie Dillard? One of those writers,

she decided early on, who chose to define herself in extra-literary terms: ‘an explorer of the neighborhood,’ ‘a fugitive and a vagabond, a sojourner seeking signs,’ and ‘a stalker, or the instrument of the hunt itself,’” the writer Geoff Dyer said in a forward to “The Abundance.”

With that 2016 collection, like 1994’s “The Annie Dillard Reader,” she chose excerpts from her books and essays to curate and narrate her writing life in new ways.

“Write as if you were dying,” she said in “The Writing Life,” her 1989 book that offers insights into craft and, inevitably, into Ms. Dillard herself.

“At the same time, assume you write for an audience consisting solely of terminal patients,” she added. “That is, after all, the case. What would you begin writing if you knew you would die soon? What could you

say to a dying person that would not enrage by its triviality?”

In a statement, Nelson, the literary executor, said that in addition to Cody-Rose Clevidence, Ms. Dillard leaves four stepdaughters from previous marriages, Carin and Shelly Clevidence, Anne Richardson, and Lissa Richardson Biddle; and two sisters, Amy Fields and Molly Simonds.

Plans for a memorial gathering were not immediately available.

In 2014, President Barack Obama awarded Ms. Dillard the National Humanities Medal, praising her “profound reflections on human life and nature.”

Three years earlier, in Globe interview for the obituary of John Hay, a Cape Cod nature writer whose work she devoured, Ms. Dillard noted that her 1999 book “For the Time Being” was among her very favor-

ites.

Writer and Globe book columnist Nina MacLaughlin called it a “beautiful, beguiling work,” and added that Ms. Dillard’s “eye is trained on all that we miss in our dash and detachment, and we’re lucky that she’s been looking for us.”

That book examined human cruelty and redemption, optimism and death — a topic she revisited in her writings.

Near the conclusion of “The Maytrees,” Ms. Dillard brings readers into the drifting thoughts of the dying poet Toby Maytree, which offered a benediction for the life of the mind, the writing life, and life itself: “I scarcely knew how pleasantly the moments were falling, until now, when looking them over through the telescope of years.”

Bryan Marquard can be reached at bryan.marquard@globe.com.

Holtec loses nuclear plant appeal

By Nick Stoico

GLOBE STAFF

State regulators on Tuesday rejected an energy company’s appeal of a decision barring the discharge of waste water from the former Pilgrim nuclear plant into Cape Cod Bay.

In a statement, the state’s Department of Environmental Protection upheld its 2024 decision denying Holtec Decommissioning International’s request to discharge as much as 1.1 million gallons of treated waste water into the bay.

The company can appeal the ruling to the Superior Court, regulators said.

Patrick O’Brien, director of government affairs and communications at Holtec, said the company is reviewing the decision and “looking at what options may remain available.”

“Our goal has always been to safely clean up the site for future economic reuse,” O’Brien said by email. “The original plan

to clean up Pilgrim in 8 years has already been delayed as a result of the challenges to safe discharges, which had occurred for over 45 years of plant operation and are regulated by the” Nuclear Regulatory Commission.

Holtec is overseeing the decommissioning of the Pilgrim nuclear plant, which stopped generating electricity in May 2019. The Florida-based company sought permission in 2023 to discharge waste water stored at the plant into the bay.

Environmental regulators denied the request in July 2024 after a public hearing and reviewing more than 1,000 comments, according to the statement.

At the center of the dispute is the state’s Ocean Sanctuaries Act, which bans the “dumping or discharge of commercial, municipal, domestic or industrial wastes” into ocean sanctuaries, according to MassDEP. Cape Cod Bay is a protected sanctuary.

State regulators determined

the water Holtec wanted to release qualifies as industrial waste water and therefore cannot be discharged into the bay.

Holtec appealed the decision in August 2024 to DEP’s Office of Appeals and Dispute Resolution. Chief presiding officer Salvatore Giorlandino sided with MassDEP in a November 2025 decision.

Holtec had argued that Pilgrim discharged water into Cape Cod Bay for decades while the plant was operating, and that its proposed discharge was a continuation of that use.

As of November, about 860,000 gallons of waste water remained at the plant. The water contained radioactive and non-radioactive contaminants.

Holtec has said it would treat the water to meet standards for conventional pollutants and has argued that the discharge would not harm the bay’s ecosystem.

Nick Stoico can be reached at nick.stoico@globe.com.

T reverses unpopular RIDE rules

►THE RIDE

Continued from Page B1

around in traffic.

But the changes were met with months of pushback, including from 50 RIDE patrons who appeared at a July T board meeting.

Permitting belongings only within the confines of their seat, removed entirely from carts, exacerbated some riders’ medical issues, critics argued. At least a few users said they were stranded — in parking lots or outside the airport — for having too much stuff. Others skipped trips to the grocery store or food pantry.

“To eliminate shopping carts and say this is a safety issue, without hearing from us, is wrong,” Daniela Depina, a visually impaired RIDE user and transportation advocate, told the Globe during this summer.

The T ultimately agreed and rolled back pieces of the policy. The agency told riders in its updated policy that they “will never



DAVID L RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

With the help of the driver and a lift, Lillie Bryan, 79, boarded a RIDE van outside her Dorchester home in July.

be required to hold all your belongings on your lap.” Riders will also be offered large, zippered grocery bags to help safely store belongings during a trip

The T warned, however, that those with “excess baggage may not be able to be transported.” In

instances where a driver determines there is not enough room in a vehicle for a rider’s items, drivers will call the paratransit service dispatch.

Diti Kohli can be reached at diti.kohli@globe.com.

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THE STARS AND A FEW STRIPES

During a visit to Franklin Park Zoo in Boston, children peered through a glass window of the Penguin Coast, an immersive new habitat for the critically endangered African penguins. Also featured: a herd of Hartmann’s mountain zebras in a Serengeti Crossing multi-species habitat; Julius, a male ostrich, with an upside-down approach to the day; and a Western Lowland gorilla appearing to rest against the back of Ryan Lo from Newton, as he was having his photograph taken by a family member.



PHOTOS BY DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF



Malden school worker arrested

Charged with child exploitation

By Shannon Larson and Tonya Alanez
GLOBE STAFF

A school worker in Malden was terminated Tuesday following his early morning arrest on federal child exploitation charges related to two teen girls in Michigan, according to court records and police officials.

Anthony Fowlkes, who was a staff member in an after-school program, was arrested at his Malden home. At a hearing in federal court in Boston, Fowlkes agreed to voluntary detention, and he was remanded into the custody of the US Marshals Service. An order for Fowlkes’s extradition to Michigan will be issued, court records show.

Fowlkes faces five federal charges, including sexual exploitation of a child, possession of child pornography, and interstate threats issued out of the US District Court of Eastern Michigan.

“Based on the seriousness of the allegations, Mr. Fowlkes was terminated by AlphaBEST,” Malden Public Schools Superintendent Timothy Sippel said in a statement. “He no longer has access to any Malden Public Schools facilities.”

Sippel said there is no indication “that the charges involved the Malden Public Schools in any way.”

Fowlkes previously worked as a district employee at the Linden School, a magnet school, Sippel said.

Charging documents allege that Fowlkes sexually extorted 15- and 16-year-old girls after he befriended one of them in July on a video chat platform called The Monkey App.

Fowlkes is accused of cultivating a dominant/submissive relationship with the girl, encouraging her to send him nude photos, and persuading her to recruit her girlfriend to do the same.

When the girls tried to end their relationships with Fowlkes, he threatened to post their images on social media sites, prosecutors allege.

Fowlkes told the girls he was 40 years old and discussed having them move to Massachusetts to live with him, according to an affidavit written by Special Agent Sarah Pettey, of Homeland Security Investigations.

The girls went to police in Waterford, Mich., on Aug. 1.

Federal authorities obtained arrest and search warrants. Malden police and Homeland Security agents executed the warrants at Fowlkes home at 6 a.m. Tuesday.

Shannon Larson can be reached at shannon.larson@globe.com. Tonya Alanez can be reached at tonya.alanez@globe.com.

Residents mull proposed White Stadium parking plan

Will determine area restrictions

By Lauren Albano
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The decision about resident parking protections around White Stadium on Boston Legacy FC game days will be put in the hands of the neighborhoods surrounding Franklin Park, according to city officials.

A survey will ask residents for their opinion on the city’s proposed parking protections in their area, which would go into effect on game days for the National Women’s Soccer League team at White Stadium, city officials said Tuesday evening.

“The neighborhoods decide,” Mayor Michelle Wu said Tuesday evening to around 40 Roxbury residents at the Bruce C. Bolling Municipal Building. “What we do as a city is we put in the policy that we believe best reflects the consensus and decisions and needs of our residents, and then we continue to evaluate.”

The Roxbury meeting was the first of four that will be held

with residents and business owners of the neighborhoods surrounding Franklin Park to share the new transportation plan and request their input on parking restrictions.

For five hours on game days — including two hours before kickoff and one hour after games conclude — the city proposed a “resident parking protection zone” stretching 0.75 miles from the stadium entrance, which residents will vote on.

The survey asks residents whether they approve of the resident parking protection zone, as well as proposed protections for general parking inside Franklin Park, including for golfers and visitors to its zoo.

The results of the survey, which closes Oct. 24, will be shared with neighborhood associations in Roxbury, Dorchester, Jamaica Plain, and Mattapan, which will ultimately vote whether to add the parking restrictions, officials said.

Officials also shared the city’s broader plan to promote public transportation by fans. Boston Legacy FC will fund the

operation and enforcement of the plan, according to the city.

There is no spectator parking at White Stadium, officials said.

On game days, the city will provide free shuttles at MBTA stations and at satellite parking lots outside Boston. It will also use a parking lot on Seaver Street as a pickup and drop-off area for game attendees using ride-sharing services like Uber and Lyft.

The city is also upgrading bike and pedestrian pathways around Franklin Park to allow for stadium access.

The renovation of White Stadium drew harsh criticism from opponents concerned that the involvement of Boston Legacy FC, a for-profit sports team, would illegally allow a private company to profit from public parkland and improperly limit the public’s access to the facility.

In August, the city’s \$325 million plan to renovate White Stadium was backed by the Supreme Judicial Court when it rejected a lawsuit trying to halt the project, ruling the overhaul does not violate a state law that



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

On game days, the city proposed a “resident parking protection zone” stretching 0.75 miles from the stadium.

protects public parkland.

The ruling also ended a yearslong lawsuit to stop the project brought by the Emerald Necklace Conservancy, an environmental nonprofit, and a coalition of residents living in the neighborhoods surrounding Franklin Park.

The renovated stadium will serve as a new hub for Boston Public Schools Athletics and be-

come the home stadium for Boston Legacy FC.

The stadium will still be owned by the city and primarily used by students and Boston residents, officials said at Tuesday’s meeting. The current lease agreement allows Boston Legacy FC to use the stadium for up to 20 home games and 20 practices each year.

Still, Roxbury residents

have many concerns about game day operations, ranging from the sale of alcohol to the impact on other community events.

“If someone shows up from out of town and they’re not aware it’s game day, they can have their car towed,” said Louis Elisa, 77, a Seaver Street resident and cofounder of the Franklin Park Coalition, which aims to preserve the historic green space.

“You’re not allowing the people who’ve been in this community, taking care of this park, taking care of this community, to live freely and enjoy themselves,” Elisa said.

Tony Brewer, who lives a few doors down from Elisa, said in an interview that solving the resident parking issue is essential before White Stadium opens.

“We don’t have to fight about it,” Brewer said. “We just need to come up with ways of resolving it in a peaceful manner.”

Lauren Albano can be reached at lauren.albano@globe.com. Follow her on X @LaurenAlbano.

LivingArts



Scenes from “Babies” (left), “Bucking Fastard” (right), and “Ha-Chan, Shake Your Booty!” (below).

By Odie Henderson
GLOBE STAFF

TORONTO — As a critic, I’m always asked about the best and worst movies I’ve recently seen. My answer can guide someone toward a hidden gem that wasn’t on their radar, or steer them away from a movie they considered. The question never gave me pause until this year’s Toronto International Film Festival. As they say in the stand-up comedy business, some of the titles are working blue.

Let’s start with legendary director Werner Herzog’s strange new film, “Bucking Fastard.” The title’s only dangerous if you spoonerize it, which I’m sure is the intention. Rooney Mara (“Carol”) and her older sister, Kate (“House of Cards”) star as sisters who repeatedly correct those who assume they’re twins. The mistake is easy to make: Jean and Joan Holbrooke dress the same and speak in unison, as if sharing a hive mind. The actors are even credited as “Mara,” like they’re one entity.

All of the characters take this unusual sisterly bond at face value, including the judge presiding over the restraining order trial that opens the film. Joan (Rooney) and Jean (Kate) are being prosecuted in Irish court for stalking their former lover, Gareth (a suitably sleazy Orlando Bloom). Gareth thought he was merely enjoying a certain French termed carnal act with no strings attached; his partners thought otherwise, falling so madly in love with him that they resorted to criminal mischief when Gareth dumped them for another woman.

I was worried that Herzog couldn’t sustain this flashback-heavy plotline for feature length. Thankfully, he resolves it within the first half-hour. Then, “Bucking Fastard” becomes a quest for the Holbrookes to find a mountain cave tunnel to Scotland’s Orkney Islands, a path rumored to have been forged by an insane man on his own quest. They’re accompa-

Hey, TIFF! Do you kiss your mother with that title?



nied by a fox they name Cupid. Metaphors about nature, quests of insane men, and oddball characters are staples in a Herzog film. The Holbrookes are intriguing protagonists, and the talking in unison gimmick didn’t bother me as much as I thought it would. There’s also a caged bird metaphor that I wish Herzog had delved into more deeply.

While I had no idea what the hell was going on, I remained riveted. However, I counted 12 walkouts as the movie got weirder. Twelve is also about the number of times I messed up saying “Bucking Fastard.” I’m sure I typed it wrong at least once here.

Rinko Kikuchi (“Babel,” “Pacific Rim”) may be the first Oscar nominee

to star in a movie with a butt in the title. “Ha-Chan, Shake Your Booty!” is a title I couldn’t say to people without, well, shakin’ my booty. Yes, I’m a grown man! Anyway, director Josef Kubota Wladyska’s Japan-set film plays like an R-rated mashup of “Shall We Dance” and “Truly, Madly, Deeply” wrapped inside the magical realism found in Latin American cinema.

Ha-Chan (Kikuchi) and her Mexican husband, Luis (Alejandro Edda), are great dancers who enter and win competitions across town. During one such event, Luis suddenly dies, leaving Ha-Chan distraught and unwilling to dance. But when sexy “Dancing with the Stars” winner

Fedir (Alberto Guerra) comes to town to give lessons, Ha-Chan gets the burning desire to take her movie title’s advice. She also gets the hots for Fedir.

Unfortunately, Luis is haunting her house and he’s dressed like a gigantic bird. I’m sure I’m missing some symbolism here.

The “Day of the Dead” visuals feel a bit like cultural appropriation, and the third act is as shaky as a dancing booty. Other than that, “Ha-Chan” is a fun, colorful fantasy with dance numbers that live up to that title. Kikuchi is excellent.

“Those aren’t such bad titles, Odie!” you say? Well, allow me to respond.

Every time someone inquired about the worst movie I’ve seen at this year’s TIFF, I’ve had to answer “Everybody Wants to F*ck Me.” It didn’t matter if it was a little old lady or a twentysomething film bro, I had to say those exact five words. A few people thought I was talking about myself, a misunderstanding that was funnier than anything in this atrocious horror comedy.

Writer-director Jonathan Schey’s film stars Taron Egerton (“Rocketman”) as Adam, a player who thinks he’s “a nice guy.” That is, he does the dishonest things straight male incel influencers believe will get them laid. He feigns interest in his dates’ conversations, reads the books he thinks

women read, and says he’s a “feminist” who honors their feelings. Of course, women fall for this malarkey because this movie was written by a man.

However, one night, Adam encounters a strange woman (Jessica Henwick) who won’t fall for his act. She takes him home anyway, drugs him, and apparently has her way with him. The next morning, Adam starts realizing that all the women in the movie want to, well, see the title. This includes his own mother and the dog he named after Alana Heim. (What happens to that dog is not pretty.)

Adam thinks he might be cursed, especially when every woman suddenly wants to kill him with sex. That’s when “EWTFM” becomes a horror movie, and a bad one at that.

Schey is too afraid to go to the dark places this material needed to traverse in order to achieve the broad satire he’s going for here. The screenplay is so shallow that women are either too stupid to see through Adam’s act or are murderous harpies who want to destroy all men. The result is a misogynistic mess that lets its hero off the hook while pretending to like women. It’s a movie that men who feel victimized by smart women would enjoy.

To close out on a happier note, “Babies,” the new comedy starring Anna Kendrick and Seth Rogen, is a delightful, funny comedy about whether or not to have children. Kendrick and Rogen are the only childless couple in their circle of friends (which include Issa Rae, Zach Cherry, and Kate Berlant). The screenplay, by director Lauren Miller Rogen (Seth’s wife), is surprisingly evenhanded, giving grace to all of its characters and the decisions they make. It’s a foul-mouthed charmer that should have had a dirtier title.

Next time: “Being Heumann” and movies about being human.

Odie Henderson is the Boston Globe’s film critic.

Legs McNeil, the Connecticut native who gave punk music its name, releases a new memoir

By James Sullivan
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The indispensable 1996 oral history of punk rock, “Please Kill Me,” opens with one of the music’s godfathers setting the table. Ladies and gentlemen: Lou Reed.

“Rock ‘n’ roll is so great, people should start dying for it,” Reed says. “People are dying for everything else, so why not the music?”

The man who gave punk its name, Legs McNeil, co-wrote “Please Kill Me” with Gillian McCain. In his new memoir, “Resident Punk,” McNeil explains that he saw Reed’s quote as the guiding theme of the whole era. “I thought that would be a worthwhile question to pose, especially since the basis of all philosophies is: ‘To be or not to be?’” he writes. “I mean, why go on?”

As one of the first chroniclers of the nihilistic (yet somehow life-affirming) music scene that sprouted in some of the most dismal corners of New York and London in the mid-1970s, McNeil by rights should have flamed out early. Co-written with Crispin Kott, “Resident Punk” is full of stomach-churning tales of excess and debauchery.

Growing up in Connecticut, near New Haven, by adolescence McNeil was well on his way to dissipation.

“At 13, I already had the lungs of an ashtray and the liver

of a Richard Burton,” he writes.

With a couple of hometown friends, John Holmstrom and Ged Dunn, McNeil moved to New York at the nadir of the city’s financial crisis, and they soon stumbled into the raw, loud, iconoclastic music scene that was spreading like mold in the city’s dank bar-rooms. Bands such as the Ramones, the Dictators, and Suicide instantly thrilled the newcomers.

Holmstrom, a cartoonist who studied with comics legends Will Eisner and Harvey Kurtzman, promptly conceived of a handmade publication dedicated to this new cultural avant-garde, and he dubbed McNeil the new magazine’s “resident punk.”

But punk, in its initial incarnation, only lasted a few years. McNeil went on to become a senior editor at Spin Magazine, a short-lived corporate shill (writing an extensive cultural history of Pepsi-Cola that was never published), and the author of a book about the history of the porn industry (“The Other Hollywood”).

Meanwhile, he fashioned himself a kind of Zelig for the counterculture of the late 20th century, rubbing elbows with Andy Warhol, writing about Norman Mailer for High Times, and flirting with a young Sinead O’Connor.

“I didn’t want to be known as the guy who wrote ‘Please Kill Me’ for the rest of my life,” he said during a recent phone conversation from his home in eastern Pennsylvania, about two hours from Manhattan. Still, at 70, he knows his legacy is inextricably linked to his presence at the foundation of punk.

“Resident Punk” covers those early days (or nights, really), when McNeil befriended Richard Hell and Joey Ramone and helped define the outsize cultural impact of punk’s original poses and ripped T-shirts inspired the Sex Pistols. (Years later, in 1985, Hell and McNeil undertook a daft excursion on inflatable rafts down the Mississippi River to mark the 100th anniversary of Mark Twain’s “Adventures of Huckleberry Finn.”)

McNeil also befriended Jonathan Paley, one-half of the power-pop group the Paley Brothers. Coming out of the Boston scene of the 1970s, Jonathan and his brother, Andy, were variously associated with Jonathan Richman, the Nervous Eaters, and Billy Squier. After playing a benefit for Punk in 1977, the Paley Brothers opened for teen heartthrob Shaun Cassidy at Madison Square Garden.

“We thought that was fantastic,” recalled McNeil. “We loved the Paley Brothers. They played

such saccharine pop songs.

“I always loved pop,” he said. “I think the Ramones were bubblegum music.”

With the publication of “Please Kill Me,” he and McCain expanded the parameters of punk’s origins to include Reed’s Velvet Underground, Iggy Pop and the Stooges, and other bands who laid the groundwork.

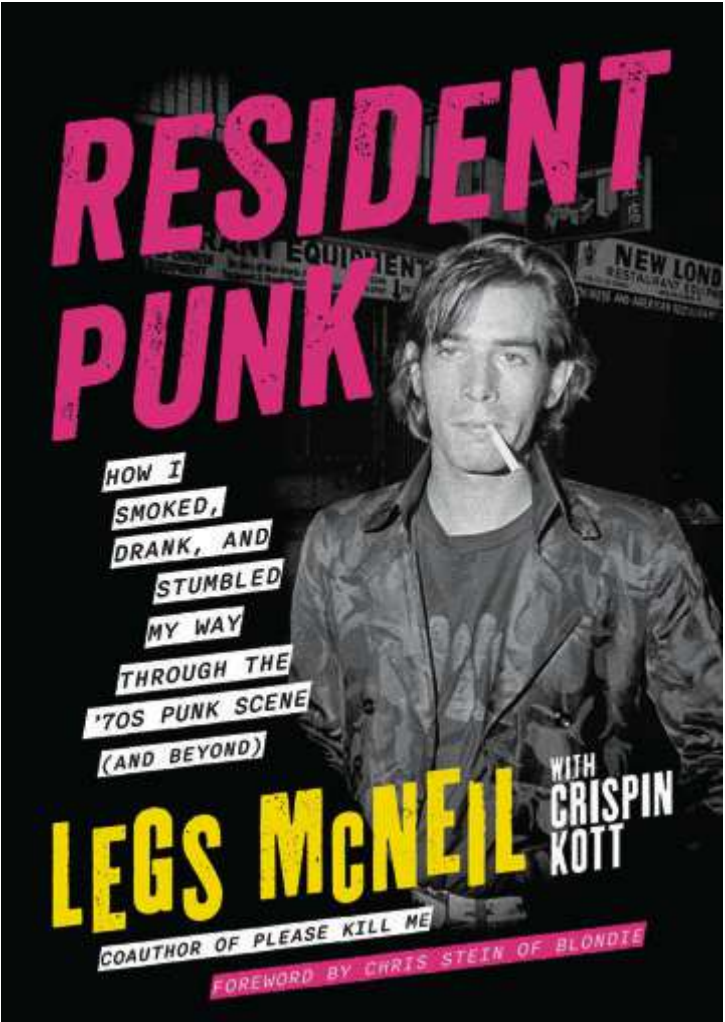
Prior to their oral history, McNeil claimed, “Punk was never put into a context. It was always just put *down*. No one ever talked about the music. I just decided, let’s tell the whole story.”

Only a few of the original punk bands — Blondie, Talking Heads — found mainstream success, he noted.

“I don’t think any of them got any credit,” he said. The Ramones’ popularity only came later, “when they started playing them on every [television] commercial,” he said. He considers “L.A.M.F.” by New York’s Heartbreakers to be “one of the best records ever made,” but frontman Johnny Thunders was a prime example of a punk whose reckless abandon got the best of him. McNeil himself got sober in 1988.

Throughout his life he has been vocal about his disdain for his Connecticut upbringing. But that sentiment doesn’t extend to the rest of New England, he insisted.

“I love Provincetown and the Cape,” he said. “I love New Hampshire and Vermont.



“Resident Punk” is the new memoir from Legs McNeil.

Maine’s cool, too. My wife is from Worcester. Her sister and brother still live there.”

McNeil remains as enthusiastic as ever for the books, music, and movies that have shaped his world. On Instagram, he posts a steady stream of tributes, which he invariably prefaces with one word: “Yes!”

“Resident Punk,” too, is peppered with exclamation points.

Richard Hell, who wrote one of the seminal memoirs of the punk years (2013’s “I Dreamed I Was a Very Clean Tramp”), has chastised his old friend for his excessive use of excitable punctuation. To Hell, it’s uncool.

But Legs McNeil stopped caring long ago.

James Sullivan can be reached at jamesgsullivan@gmail.com.

TV HIGHLIGHTS

WNBA: Sun-Dream, 7:30 p.m., NBCSB
College football: Syracuse-Pittsburgh, 7:30 p.m., ESPN
Baseball: Red Sox-Rangers, 8:05 p.m., NESN
NFL: Lions-Bills, 8:15 p.m., Amazon
Listings, C7

Sports

C

THE BOSTON GLOBE THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 17, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/SPORTS



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

A big takeaway from the Patriots’ Week 1 loss to the Seahawks was the 0-3 turnover deficit, something Christian Gonzalez looks to change. **Story, C2**

Patriots hit with an early reality check

BEN VOLIN
ON FOOTBALL

The Patriots’ Week 2 matchup against the Steelers probably isn’t a “must win,” since there will still be 15 games remaining in the season. But even Drake Maye knows the importance of Sunday’s game.
“There’s a full season ahead, but you’ve got to get this going early,” Maye said.
If the urgency isn’t high in Foxborough this week, it needs to be. Coming off a dream season that ended in an unexpected Super Bowl run, it took all of one week in 2026 for reality to smack the Patriots in the face.
They opened the season with a loss they surely will come to regret, failing to protect a 10-point lead in the second half and losing to the Seahawks’ backup quarterback. Now the



STEELERS AT PATRIOTS
Sunday, 1 p.m., CBS

road ahead is suddenly far more daunting than any of us realized back in August.
That’s because no one projected the Patriots would lose their top offensive weapon in the first game of the season. A.J. Brown, the linchpin of the Patriots’ offensive attack, will be out 4-6 weeks with a high ankle sprain, possibly longer.
It’s hard to overstate the enormity of this loss for the Patriots’ offense. Brown is their deep threat, contested-catch expert, and most physical offensive weapon. He draws extra at-

tention from the defense and opens up the field for his teammates. The entire offseason plan to improve the roster revolved around trading a future first-round pick for Brown.
The Patriots never had to worry about playing without their No. 1 receiver last year. Stefon Diggs, coming off a torn ACL, played in all 21 games, including playoffs.
Diggs is gone, though, of the Patriots’ own choosing. So is Kayshon Boutte, their top deep threat last year. Now with Brown out, a wide receiver position that was the team’s strength in training camp is suddenly thin.
“I wish life was like that, where you could wait for your guys to come back and be healthy again,” fellow receiver Mack Hollins said. “But, it’s NFL football.”
Last year, Brown’s injury wouldn’t have been as significant. The Patriots’ early-season

ON FOOTBALL, Page C2

KEVIN PAUL DUPONT
ON HOCKEY

Bruins will have a captain, but Sweeney says it’s TBA

The Bruins officially opened training camp on Wednesday, and only a couple of minutes into an early-afternoon presser on Causeway Street, general manager Don Sweeney announced his 2026-27 Bruins indeed will have a captain.
The name of the man who’ll wear the “C”? To Be Announced (TBA).
When will the captain’s identity be revealed?
On or before the Sept. 29 season opener.
And that’s all, folks. Simultaneous with revealing the captaincy will be filled — now 558 days since Brad Marchand abdicated the “C” upon being abruptly dealt to Florida on March 7, 2025 — Sweeney



DAVID PASTRNAK
Entering 13th season

placed the topic into the equivalent of a neutral zone trap the envy of Jacques Lemaire (who perfected NZT in his days as Devils coach).
“So nobody has to ask who it is, or whatnot,” noted Sweeney, now a decade-plus into keeping the lid sealed on all house secrets, big and small.
Sweeney further assured the assembled media that his management team “spent a lot of time” on the decision and considered the “legacy of our organization.”
Beyond that, well, loyal fans of the Black and Gold, keep an eye peeled on the Bruins official website for the announcement as the Sept. 29 date with the Rangers approaches.
In the end, it was an announcement that an announcement will be forthcoming. Not a slow news day, but a *slowoverview* drip, for sure.
It’s hardly any secret that the new captain will be David Pastrnak or Charlie McAvoy. They are the only viable candidates in residence. They are top-of-the-roster contributors, top-of-the-payroll employees, both under contract for years to come, McAvoy for at least four more seasons and Pastrnak for at least five. All of that factors in the decision.
They’re both fully committed pros, sincere and well-spoken, with Pastrnak’s delightful Czech accent a tiny, and sometimes amusing, value added when talking with the media.
Both are well-liked and respected by teammates, which is perhaps the most important

ON HOCKEY, Page C6



TONY GUTIERREZ/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Red Sox starter Jake Bennett allowed eight hits and three runs in 4⅓ innings to go with one walk and seven strikeouts vs. the Rangers.

ALEX SPEIER
ON BASEBALL

Targeted response from obscure finds

ARLINGTON, Texas — For the Red Sox, the vision of contention in 2026 seemed straightforward.
The team’s championship window had been pried open by the presence of a pair of cornerstones, with Garrett Crochet anchoring the rotation and Roman Anthony representing a lineup anchor not only for this year but several seasons to come.
But while the Sox are amid a magic-number countdown to a playoff berth, they’ve done so without Anthony and Crochet for most of the year. Their season has been saved in no small part by players

ON BASEBALL, Page C4

Bats gone quiet

Red Sox offense only has three hits in loss to Texas

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF

Rangers 7
Red Sox 3
ARLINGTON, Texas — As they prepare for the post-season, the Red Sox have another key item on an otherwise tidy-seeming to-do list: Rediscover the offensive magic that was so key to their summer surge.
In another loss to the Rangers, 7-3, Wednesday night, the Sox totaled just three hits.
Willson Contreras homered in the first inning. Trevor Story had an infield single in the fifth. And pinch hitter Nick Sogard singled in the sixth.
“First-inning homer, it’s always

good, but it’s even better if we win,” Contreras said. “We battle. We come here with the right mind-set. We work hard . . . But sometimes it’s baseball. Sometimes, it doesn’t matter how hard we work. Sometimes, the results are not going to come. But you have to build off that. You have to take those types of games personal and get better for tomorrow.”
Interim manager Chad Tracy said: “We’re going through it a little bit.”
Any sense of why?
“Probably the easy answer is: baseball,” Tracy said. “We got some guys going through it, and then you could see one or two big

swings in a complete turn the other direction. So we just got to keep plugging away at it.”
It represented another down day in a month marked by them. In September, the Red Sox rank tied for 26th in the majors in average (.222), 26th in OPS (.675), tied for 16th in home runs (17), and 27th in runs (50). Collectively, they have hit similarly to Connor Wong.
Consider it another turn in a year full of them for the Sox, who put together one of the worst offenses in the game halfway through the season, went on a tear for upwards of two months, and

RED SOX, Page C4

INSIDE



KEN MCGAGH FOR THE GLOBE

Something special
No. 3 Concord-Carlisle and Duke-bound Emmy O’Donnell (left) have title aspirations. **C7**

Forward thinking
It’s time for Celtics fans to turn the page after the trade of Jaylen Brown. **Finn, C6**

Important work being done off field

Mental performance coach helping to unlock Legacy’s potential

By Emma Healy
GLOBE STAFF

The Legacy players showed all the hallmarks of frustration during their April game in frigid Chicago: heads hanging low, gloved palms up to the sky, pleading with teammates and themselves to make something happen.
The Legacy fired off 28 shots — their best offensive showing of the season to that point — but loaded the bus having been shut out, 2-0, for their fifth straight loss.
Physically, the Legacy looked the strongest they had to that point. But there was a roadblock in their way, something mental that kept that elusive victory out of reach.
“We are not failures because we lost games,” coach Filipa Patão said a few days after the loss. “We are failures if we start to not

believe in our process and give up here.”
The Legacy built one of the youngest, most-international, and least-experienced rosters in the NWSL and had just a few weeks together to build a culture and identity before the season set off at a blistering pace.
They installed tactics, built up their conditioning, and began building chemistry on the field — work that is ongoing with two months left in the season. But the physical side of the game is only half of the story. So much of soccer is mental, especially for a young expansion team still trying to find its footing.
That’s what makes mental performance coach Jacqueline Kelly crucial to the operation.
It’s part of Kelly’s job to keep the players’

heads in it, even when they’ve lost five games in a row like they did to start the season. Whether players are dealing with nerves, inexperience, self-doubt, or familial pressure, most of what Kelly does is “removing mental roadblocks” that prevent the players from reaching their physical potential.
“This is work that everybody needs to do,” Patão said. “Because if you have 1 percent, 2 percent, 3 percent more inside of you that can help and can [make] you better, of course, we will do it.”
Mental performance, long perceived as a subjective and unmeasurable science, has transformed in recent years through technological advances that allow Kelly and her peers to gather hundreds of data points from each game that she can turn into lessons for

LEGACY, Page C6

Pro football

Defensive takeaway: a need to create turnovers

By Christopher Price
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — Most days at training camp this summer, it wasn't a question of whether the Patriots' defense would come away with a takeaway. It was more a matter of how many it would have before the end of the session.

While the defense played well in the opener against the Seahawks, the fact it couldn't come away with a takeaway in the 13-10 loss is something that has continued to stick with the players in the days since.

Christian Gonzalez welcomes the change that. The cornerback said Wednesday the plan is clear for Sunday's game against the Steelers.

"I have to make the plays I need to make," he said. "That I'm *supposed* to make. [But] that's the message every week as a defense. That's what we want to do," added Gonzalez, who had two tackles and two passes defended against the Seahawks. "We either want to get the ball back to Drake [Maye] or let Marcus [Jones] go back there and catch the punt and do what he does back there. That's always the goal; to get the ball off of the offense and take it away.

"I mean, if you have more turnovers, you're more likely to win a game. That's what it comes down to. And that's what we've got to do."

To his point, turnover ratio is a usually an indication of success or failure. And so seeing the Patriots' minus-3 (three giveaways, no takeaways) in the opener, it's easy to draw a line between that and the loss.

When it comes to takeaways, how do the Patriots bounce back against the Steelers?

"You have to go attack the football," said coach Mike Vrabel. "The easiest target is the quarterback, so you have to force the quarterback into mistakes. You have to hit it out of his hands.

"We had a couple opportunities [against Seattle] where we did hit the quarterback, but again, you've got to knock it out of his hands. Make it a concerted effort, and we do it every single day. Finding ways to work together to create ball disruption."

The Steelers' Aaron Rodgers has been known to take some chances in the passing game, but Gonzalez said he's a fan of the guy he called a "Hall of Fame" quarterback.

"Nothing but respect for him and just what he does for that team, and just the talent he has," Gonzalez said. "He can make every single throw. He's still moving pretty well back there. He's running around. They've got some pieces over there. So it presents a challenge, and we look forward to it."

Veteran safety Kevin Byard is second



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Mike Vrabel will want a better performance out of his team in Week 2 against the Steelers after it failed to force a turnover in its Week 1 defeat.

among active players in career interceptions, and he preached the takeaway-a-day philosophy throughout training camp. He said there's not much you can show Rodgers that he hasn't seen. The key? Make him feel uncomfortable.

"Try to make sure we're forcing him off his spot, and try to force him to throw us an interception," Byard said. "He gets the ball out really fast, so if it's

going to be those checkdown throws, those short throws, we have to make sure we're swarming to the ball."

The Patriots are facing some pressure Sunday. Takeaways mean wins, and history says an 0-2 start would put a serious crimp in playoff plans (since 2016, teams that lose their first two games have made the playoffs only 14.3 percent of the time).

NFL NOTEBOOK

Colts WR faces DUI charges

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Colts receiver **Keenan Allen** will face two misdemeanor charges in an alleged drunken driving incident, according to court records.

The six-time Pro Bowler was formally charged Tuesday with operating a vehicle with alcohol concentration equivalent to 0.15 or more and operating a vehicle while intoxicated. He posted \$500 cash bond, and his attorneys waived an initial hearing that had been scheduled for Wednesday. An attorney conference is set for Oct. 26.

Colts coach **Shane Steichen** declined to address the latest twist before Wednesday's practice, at which Allen is expected to be a participant. Allen has not addressed the incident publicly.

According to the Indianapolis Metropolitan Police Department, officers conducted a traffic investigation on Aug. 30 shortly after 1 a.m. after observing a vehicle park in a no-parking zone. Officers "noticed signs of intoxication" when they spoke with Allen. He was arrested after further investigation.

Lock to start for Seahawks

With **Sam Darnold** out because of a glute injury, **Drew Lock** will start at quarterback Sunday for the Super Bowl champions at Arizona, with **Jalen Milroe** in the backup role.

Darnold was injured when he was sacked by **Dre'Mont Jones** on the first series against the Patriots last week in Seattle.

Lock replaced him and went 16 of 22 for 187 yards and a touchdown as the Seahawks rallied for a 13-10 victory.



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

In his last five games dating to last season's playoff run, Drake Maye has thrown seven interceptions to go with seven touchdown passes.

Globe staff's pro picks WEEK 2

	Las Vegas line	Chad Finn	Chris Price	Tara Sullivan	Scott Thurston	Ben Volin	Nicole Yang
Last week		9-6-1	7-8-1	8-7-1	7-8-1	5-10-1	7-8-1
Season		9-6-1	7-8-1	8-7-1	7-8-1	5-10-1	7-8-1
Best bets		1-0	0-1	0-1	0-1	1-0	0-1
Detroit at Buffalo	Buffalo by 5½	Buffalo	Buffalo	Detroit	Buffalo	Detroit	Buffalo
Selections are against the pointspread.							

Falcons yet to name QB

Falcons coach **Kevin Stefanski** said Monday he's not ready to announce a starting quarterback for Sunday's home opener against Carolina, but it appears **Cooper Rush's** one-week hold on the job is in jeopardy.

Michael Penix Jr. may be close to reclaiming his role as the starter, especially since **Tua Tagovailoa** was held out on Wednesday after leaving practice last Thursday with an oblique injury.

Rush started in the Falcons' 20-13 opening loss against the Steelers in Pittsburgh last Sunday. Rush threw two interceptions, including **T.J. Watt's** pick-6 in the fourth quarter. Rush com-

pleted 12 of 22 passes for 143 yards and a touchdown.

Jets duo 'week to week'

Jets safety **Minkah Fitzpatrick** and rookie wide receiver **Omar Cooper Jr.** did not practice because of injuries and coach **Aaron Glenn** said both are "week to week." Fitzpatrick injured his groin during the Jets' season-opening win over the Titans in Nashville while Cooper left with an ankle injury. . . . The Lions will be without two starting offensive linemen against the Bills on Thursday night: rookie offensive tackle **Blake Miller** (knee) and guard **Christian Mahogany** (hip), a former BC standout.

By Nicole Yang

GLOBE STAFF

After the Patriots blew a 10-point lead against a backup quarterback in their season opener, let's take a look at who's up, who's down, and whom to watch against the Steelers in Week 2 . . .

Three up

Left tackle Will Campbell: After an ugly postseason performance, in which he consistently appeared under pressure, Campbell held his ground against the reigning Super Bowl champions. The Seahawks' defensive front overpowered Campbell in Super Bowl LX, registering eight pressures and a sack against him. Campbell turned in a cleaner sheet on Wednesday, especially in the first half. Some struggles popped up in the second half, when he was flagged for two penalties (holding and an illegal block above the waist) and allowed a sack, but Campbell's overall showing was encouraging. He dedicated this offseason to building strength and improving his technique — and it showed.

Edge rusher Gabe Jacas: Training camp was a mixed bag for Jacas, who missed the spring program because of his contract situation. He played with impressive force but sometimes had trouble reading plays and ended up out of position. In his NFL debut, though, Jacas maximized his 19 snaps, 11 in pass rush and eight in run defense. His pursuit and instinct were on display on his sack of Drew Lock and tackle for loss on Jadarian Price. Edge rusher remains one of the thinnest positions for the Patriots, but Jacas's performance was promising. It will be worth watching whether he can expand his role.

Cornerback Christian Gonzalez: The Patriots and Gonzalez agreed to a contract extension ahead of the opener, putting an end to any uncertainty about Gonzalez's status in Week 1. The Patriots deployed a mix of man and zone coverage against the Seahawks, so Gonzalez didn't travel with Seahawks star receiver Jaxon Smith-Njigba. In their 10 coverage matchups, Gonzalez did not allow a reception and broke up a pass.

Three down

Quarterback Drake Maye: Maye's fourth-quarter collapse, when all three of New England's possessions ended in an interception, cost the Patriots the game. His poor decision-making, particularly on his last pick, was, in Maye's words, "just unacceptable." Perhaps Maye just needed a game to become comfortable with live action, after not playing any preseason snaps. But his struggles date back to the postseason. In his last five games, Maye has completed just 60 percent of his passes with seven interceptions and seven touchdowns. Although the Patriots have high hopes for Maye in Year 3, Wednesday was a clear step back.

Wide receiver Romeo Doubs: Doubs's Patriots debut couldn't have gone much worse. The most pivotal flub came in the fourth quarter, when he dropped a wide-open pass that would have converted a second and 14. Instead, Maye threw an interception on the ensuing third down. The pressure is now on Doubs to bounce back. He had a quiet start to training camp but came

Gonzalez welcomes the scrutiny of a matchup of this magnitude, one that comes with facing Rodgers and a wide receiver such as DK Metcalf. Gonzalez said to play defensive back, "you have to be a little crazy in the head."

"You're on the outside. If you give a play, everybody sees it. If something happens [to] a corner, everybody sees it. No matter what," he said. "So that's kind of what I was saying. You've got to be a little crazy to play the position. You invite it. You enjoy it. It's all about how you respond."

Ultimately, how the Patriots' defense responds this week will be a key. When it was denied a takeaway over the summer, it would counter by converting on multiple opportunities the next day. If Gonzalez and the defense can answer the call in a similar fashion against Rodgers and the Steelers, chances are it'll go a long way toward evening New England's record at 1-1, and putting the loss to the Seahawks even further in the rearview mirror.

"It just comes down to communication," Gonzalez said. "Us getting us in the right spot, and then, capitalizing and making the play"

Christopher Price can be reached at christopher.price@globe.com. Follow him on Bluesky at christopherprice.bsky.social.



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Patriots cornerback Christian Gonzalez did not allow a reception in the 10 times he matched up in coverage with Jaxon Smith-Njigba.

on strong with multiple impressive catches from Maye in the final two weeks. The Patriots need the two to find that connection again.

Left guard Alijah Vera-Tucker: The offensive line as a whole looked to be improved, but newly acquired Vera-Tucker appeared to be the weak link at times. According to Pro Football Focus, Vera-Tucker allowed a team-high four hurries. The rest of the line combined for three. Vera-Tucker missed the 2025 season because of a torn triceps, so it's likely he needed time to shake the rust off. In 2024, when he played 15 games, he allowed the third-lowest pressure rate at right guard, then his position.

Three to watch

Running back TreVeyon Henderson: Henderson (ankle) returned to practice on Monday for the first time since leaving early on Aug. 24. The Patriots rightfully relied on Rhamondre Stevenson to serve as the bell cow out of the backfield last week but would welcome the addition of a speedy home-run threat. Henderson didn't wow during camp — the run game can be difficult to evaluate without tackling to the ground — so his showing, and any Year 2 improvements, will be worth watching.

Wide receiver Kyle Williams: A.J. Brown's high ankle sprain will only make things more challenging for Maye. Not only does Doubs need to rebound, but Williams needs to find a way to contribute. He played just 12 snaps in the opener, but that number will likely increase on Sunday. Even though Mack Hollins ended up being Maye's go-to guy after Brown's injury, it's time for Williams to show he can maintain a larger role.

Safety Jaylen Reed: Reed played only on special teams during the opener. The Patriots deployed a three-safety look to start the game, with Dell Pettus joining Kevin Byard and Craig Woodson. That big-nickel grouping did not fare that well, but Reed might be a better fit than Pettus if the Patriots want to turn to it again.

Nicole Yang can be reached at nicole.yang@globe.com. Follow her on X @nicolecyang.

Reality check hits team early this season

►ON FOOTBALL
Continued from Page C1

schedule was loaded with cupcakes, from Miami to Carolina, Tennessee, New Orleans, and more.

This year, the Patriots have no such luck. They have to reconfigure their offense on the fly against a ruthless schedule. After hosting Pittsburgh, they travel to Jacksonville for a game that looks like a potential bloodbath for the Patriots, then to Buffalo, which just scored 36 points against the Texans' defense. If the Patriots aren't careful, they could be 1-3 or 0-4 before they blink.

With Brown out, the wide receiver depth chart suddenly doesn't look so hot — Romeo Doubs, DeMario Douglas, Kyle Williams, Efton Chism, and Hollins. It looks like a return to the Dark Ages of 2022-24, when the Patriots had a bunch of No. 2 and 3 receivers, but no one that scared an opposing defense.

Doubs will surely bounce back from a rough Week 1, and Hunter Henry, Rhamondre Stevenson, and Hollins are reliable weapons in the passing game. But none of them require a double team or extra attention, and they will find the field much more compressed without Brown in the lineup.

So now Maye and Josh McDaniels need to find ways to manufacture explosive plays and get peripheral pieces involved. One player squarely in the spotlight is Williams, last year's third-round pick who has blazing speed but has struggled to learn the offense. Williams had just 12 snaps and no targets in Week 1, suggesting he still has a ways to go. But at minimum, the Patriots need to get him the ball on designed plays — jet sweeps, quick screens, and crossers.

Another solution could be to turn into a ground-and-pound team that hits a few big plays with play-action passes. Given the Patriots' lack of a No. 1 receiver, play-action may be the only consistent way to create separation. The Patriots need to use a lot more of fullback Reggie Gilliam, who played just 13 of 71 snaps against the Seahawks.

But the Patriots aren't really built for a power run game. The loss of No. 2 blocking tight end Julian Hill to a torn ACL this spring was quietly significant, as the Patriots now have little depth behind Henry. Backups Eli Raridon, Tanner Arkin, and Cameron Latu, two rookies and a journeyman, aren't ready to fill Hill's role up front. The Patriots' run game was smothered by the Sea-

hawks, with Stevenson and Corey Kiner averaging just 2.6 yards on their 24 carries.

The Patriots' X-factor becomes TreVeyon Henderson, their second-year running back. He has been out nearly a month since suffering an ankle injury in practice but returned to practice Monday and may have a chance to play Sunday against the Steelers. Henderson is the Patriots' most dynamic runner, scoring four touchdowns of 50-plus yards last year. Henderson is the Patriots' best hope of replacing Brown's impact and loosening up the defense, especially if McDaniels can move him around the formation.

Coach Mike Vrabel wasn't stressing much on Monday when asked about moving on without Brown.

"I don't know how much we want to tweak things," he said. "We'll [just] have to move guys around to different positions."

But coming off a regrettable loss and facing a brutal schedule, Brown was the one non-quarterback piece the Patriots could least afford to lose.

Ben Volin can be reached at ben.volin@globe.com.

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Baseball

Who will pinch run in the playoffs?

Red Sox weighing options for key job

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF

ARLINGTON, Texas — The franchise that put **Dave Roberts** and **Quintin Berry**’s skill sets to famously good use on the way to World Series championships is considering anew who might fill that role of postseason pinch runner.

For these Red Sox, though, there is not an obvious answer. But that bench gig is “an important piece down the stretch for sure,” interim manager **Chad Tracy** said.

“It just depends on what the roster looks like,” Tracy said Wednesday, before the Sox lost to the Rangers, 7-3. “It’s hard to answer because you don’t know between now and the end of the season, are we going to be status quo with the roster? Is everybody going to be healthy? Are people not going to be healthy? And if everybody’s healthy, how are you going to structure the lineup and who does that put on the bench?”

Until last week, it seemed like an easy enough call: Backup outfielder **Eli White**, unlikely to crack the starting lineup with a healthy group, could come off the bench to run for a slower player and swipe a bag. Over the past two seasons, he has just 15 steals, but those have come in 17 attempts. When he goes, he’s good.

But he injured a ligament in his



TONY GUTIERREZ/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Center fielder Nate Eaton came up short on a ground-rule RBI double by the Rangers in the first inning.

right foot on Sept. 8. He will miss at least the beginning and perhaps all of the playoffs; the Red Sox await a final diagnosis.

“I know that’s taken a while, but we’re still waiting on the doctor to read the results,” Tracy said.

Since the Red Sox have stopped playing **Jarren Duran** against lefthanders — such as, say, the Yankees’ **Max Fried** in a likely first-round matchup — his services would be available. In addi-

tion to stealing 19 bases in 23 tries for a 83 percent success rate, Duran rates as a strong all-around baserunner, stealing or otherwise.

And then there is **Braiden Ward**, a star of spring training if there is such a thing, racking up 19 steals — the most in recorded Grapefruit League history.

In March, he said, “Hopefully I can be the next Dave Roberts.” Then-manager **Alex Cora** talked up the Sox maybe calling him up late in the season as a pinch runner.

Now, Tracy is leaving open the same possibility.

“Every time he gets on, he’s not afraid,” said Tracy, who had Ward with Triple-A Worcester for the first month of the season. “That’s the thing. He gets on base, he’s looking to go. That’s a unique trait. There’s a lot of guys that can run and steal bases, and then there’s other guys that every single time I get on, almost regardless of the time of the pitcher, I feel like I can outrun the ball.”

Ward has 60 steals in 69 tries in Triple-A. That is an 87 percent success rate — a great number, particularly when everybody knows he is going.

“It’s very obvious that you have a guy down there that has a really good capability to run and steal bases,” Tracy said. “So we’ll see where we get at the end of the season and how all that fits.”

Guerrero ‘on hold’

Righthander **Tyron Guerrero**’s return from the injured list is “on hold” after experiencing muscle cramps in his lower back Tuesday, Tracy said.

Although Guerrero (right shoulder inflammation) was eligible to be activated Wednesday, the Red Sox postponed that by at least a day.

“Very encouraging to see him come in today already feeling a lot better, was able to go out there and throw, which is great,” Tracy said. “But kind of on hold right now as to what we’re going to do and when we’re going to activate him.”

Rehab roundup

The Red Sox got specifics on **Anthony Seigler**’s right wrist inflammation: “It was described as inflammation due to a bony abscess in there, something that he rolled over on” on a swing last weekend, Tracy said. Their plan is to wait a week and reassess. Seigler remains sore, per Tracy. . . Righthander **Johan Oviedo** will make a rehab appearance with Triple-A Worcester on Thursday, his first game action since March 30, his lone major league appearance of the year. . . **Ceddanne Rafaela** (right quad strain) said he wants to play with the Red Sox in Tampa Bay, but it is not sounding like he will be ready for the start of that series Friday. “We’re going to continue ramping up the sprint work over the next few days,” Tracy said. “We’ll kind of assess where he’s at, his readiness, whether that’s to join us? Is it a rehab? Do we need to slow him down? We’ve just got to give him the time to continue to do that and see where he’s at as he continues to get more volume.”

Tim Healey can be reached at timothy.healey@globe.com.

Targeted response from obscure finds says plenty

►ON BASEBALL
Continued from Page C1

who have emerged from obscurity to play critical roles — with essential contributions coming from Andrew Monasterio, Anthony Seigler, Mickey Gasper, Tsung-Che Cheng, Jahmai Jones, Tyron Guerrero, and more.

“I don’t think anybody had that on the drawing board,” said interim manager Chad Tracy with a chuckle. “They were asked to play a lot, and they produced. And if they didn’t, we were in trouble. It’s a huge piece of the 2026 season, no question.”

Of course, while no one expected the outsized impact of players who began the year as big league backups or in Triple-A, the Sox also took considerable pains to build organizational depth through a variety of transactions.

Whether it was an expanded version of the trade that brought Caleb Durbin from Milwaukee to include Monasterio and Seigler, or waiver claims of Cheng and Gasper, or a minor league deal for Guerrero, the season has been a case study in the notion that perceived little moves can have a huge impact.

“Every move and every decision matters,” said assistant general manager Mike Groopman, who oversees the team’s acquisitions group. “The big ones, whether it’s a larger free agent deal, [or] a larger, more high-profile trade, is naturally going to get a lot of attention.”

“I don’t think this is unique to the Red Sox. There are 29 other teams that try to and do a very good job about car- ing about the ‘little’ things. But I think what we really try to reinforce is . . . that year over year, around the game, you

see things that seem ‘little’ that end up being really impactful and big. [Deals that] seemed like small moves at the outset end up having a much, much larger impact commensurate with what would have been perceived at the time as a ‘larger’ move.”

Players who evolve from theoretical depth to become big league contributors excite numerous corners of an organization. The primary credit for those contributions, of course, belongs with a player, but they still often represent the combined efforts of personnel in scouting who identify the player’s potential contributions, player development personnel who help the player build on preexisting strengths and abilities in the minors, and big league staffers who help the players to perform at the game’s highest level.

Take Guerrero. After brief stints in the majors in 2018 and ’19, he’d become a journeyman, shuffling between organizations — and countries — but unable to forge a way back to the big leagues despite elite velocity.

But the Sox — who’d been interested in signing Guerrero before he pitched in the NPB in Japan in 2025 — remained intrigued, thanks in part to strong scouting recommendations from Kento Matsumoto in Japan and Manny Nanita in the Dominican Winter League. After they signed Guerrero to a minor league deal in the offseason, player development officials worked with him on some minor grip changes that unlocked significantly improved command with a sinker that regularly reached triple digits.

Guerrero’s dominance this year in Triple-A (0.92 ERA) essentially forced

the Sox to call him up, and the 35-year-old emerged as a late-innings force from late June to late August (before shoulder fatigue led to a bad outing fol- lowed by a trip to the injured list), post- ing a 2.13 ERA over a 23-appearance stretch.

Again, the lion’s share of the credit goes to Guerrero for the work he did to fight his way back to the big leagues. But his emergence embodies the sort of under-the-radar acquisition that helped save the Sox’ season.

“The connection and integration be- tween acquisition and development is really important,” said Groopman. “Guerrero and our [player develop- ment] group put a lot of time into [those changes] in the spring and the early season, to get him to a point where he was able to lock in some of these changes and unlock what was su- per obvious arm talent into something that was translating more consistently onto the major league mound.”

Of course, talent alone doesn’t dic- tate success once a depth player gets to the big leagues. They must also have the opportunity to contribute — and, in many cases, the freedom to fail while getting their bearings.

Tracy, who spent time with nearly all of this year’s depth contributors in Triple-A at the beginning of the year, has been mindful of creating an environ- ment in which call-ups can contribute.

“I’m in the same boat [as them]. I want the freedom to go manage the game [as a first-time big league manag- er],” said Tracy. “I need to manage a game and feel like if I do something that doesn’t go right, it’s not the end of the world. If I feel that way, then I want the



TONY GUTIERREZ/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Willson Contreras’s first-inning home run gave the Red Sox a 2-0 lead.

player to feel like, ‘Hey, if you go out there and play second base today and you make an error, move on to the next play.’

“If the culture becomes, ‘If I make a mistake, then all of a sudden I clam up and I get really tight,’ we’re going to have a problem. So you look at them and say, ‘You’re here for a reason: To go play your game. Don’t worry about making a mistake. Move on to the next pitch, next play.’ And they did that, and they were awesome.”

Alex Speier can be reached at alex.speier@globe.com. Follow him @alexspeier.

Rangers 7, Red Sox 3

At Globe Life Field, Arlington, Texas										
BOSTON	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.			
Anthony lf	3	0	0	0	1	1	.236			
Jones dh	2	0	0	0	0	0	.211			
a-Sogard ph-dh	2	0	1	0	0	0	.266			
Abreu rf	4	1	0	0	0	0	.254			
Contreras 1b	3	1	1	2	0	0	.275			
Rutschman c	4	0	0	0	0	0	.234			
Durbin 3b	2	1	0	0	2	0	.249			
Story ss	3	0	1	0	0	1	.241			
Kiner-Falefa 2b	3	0	0	0	0	1	.262			
Eaton cf	1	0	0	0	0	0	.128			
b-Gasper ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	.266			
JDuran cf	1	0	0	0	0	0	.204			
Totals	29	3	3	2	3	3				
TEXAS	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.			
Foscue 2b	5	1	2	1	0	1	.271			
Carter cf	0	0	0	0	0	0	.193			
Seager ss	4	1	1	1	0	2	.234			
Jung 3b	5	1	3	0	0	0	.298			
c-Lopez pr-2b	0	0	0	0	0	0	.277			
Burger 1b	4	1	2	1	1	1	.234			
Nimmo rf	4	1	1	1	0	1	.263			
Langford lf	3	1	1	1	1	2	.239			
EDuran cf-3b	4	0	1	2	0	2	.270			
Díaz dh	4	0	1	0	0	0	.239			
d-Osuna pr-dh	0	1	0	0	0	0	.254			
Jansen c	3	0	1	0	0	0	.194			
Totals	36	7	13	7	2	9				
Boston	200	0	0	0	—	3	3	1		
Texas	100	110	31x	—	7	13	0			
a-singled for Jones in 6th, b-grounded out for Eaton in 5th, c-ran for Jung in 8th, d-ran for ElDíaz in 8th. E —Burgos (1). LOB —Boston 3, Texas 9. 2B —Foscue (13), Jung 2 (25), Burger (22), Nimmo (34). HR —Contreras (27), off Gore. SB —Durbin (19), Story (5). CS —EDuran (4). S —Jansen. Runners left in scoring position —Boston 2 (Anthony, Durbin), Texas 5 (Seager, Burger 2, Langford 2). RISP —Boston 0 for 7, Texas 7 for 16. Runners moved up —Story. DP —Texas 1 (Jung).										
Boston	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA		
Bennett	4½	8	3	3	1	7	91	3.78		
Weissert	1½	1	0	0	0	1	15	3.45		
Miller L 2-1	1	2	3	3	1	1	22	2.87		
Burgos	1	2	1	0	0	0	18	5.19		
Texas	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA		
Gore	4	2	3	3	3	0	69	4.67		
Junis	1	0	0	0	0	2	13	3.33		
Eovaldi W 11-9	4	1	0	0	0	1	46	4.07		
Gore pitched to 2 batters in the 5th. Inherited runners scored —Weissert 1-1, Junis 2-1. HBP —by Miller (Seager), by Eovaldi (Contreras). Balk —Junis. Umpires —Home, Nick Mahrley; First, Ben May; Second, Willie Traynor; Third, Tripp Gibson. T —2:42. A —26,364 (40,518).										

HOW THE RUNS SCORED										
FIRST INNING										
RED SOX — Anthony walked. Jones flied out to left. Abreu grounded into fielder’s choice, second to shortstop, Anthony out. Contreras homered to left on a 2-0 count, Abreu scored. Rutschman flied out to center.										
RANGERS — Foscue doubled to left. Seager struck out. Jung singled to right, Foscue to third. Burger hit a ground-rule double to center, Foscue scored, Jung to third. Nimmo grounded out to first. Langford struck out.										
FOURTH INNING										
RANGERS — Langford walked. Duran struck out. ElDíaz flied out to center. Jansen hit an infield single to shortstop, Langford to second. Foscue singled to center, Langford scored, Jansen to second. Seager struck out.										
FIFTH INNING										
RED SOX — Durbin walked. Story hit an in- field single to third, Durbin to third. Junis pitching. Kiner-Falefa struck out. Story stole second. Gasper pinch-hitting for Eaton. On Junis’ balk, Durbin scored, Story to third. Gasper grounded out to shortstop. Anthony struck out.										
RANGERS — Duran in as center fielder. Jung doubled to center. Burger struck out. Nimmo struck out. Weissert pitching. Lang- ford singled to center, Jung scored. Duran struck out.										
SEVENTH INNING										
RANGERS — Miller pitching. Seager was hit by a pitch. Jung lined out to right. Burger walked, Seager to second. Nimmo doubled to center, Seager scored, Burger to third. Langford struck out. Duran singled to left, Burger scored, Nimmo scored. Duran was caught stealing.										
EIGHTH INNING										
RANGERS — Burgos pitching. ElDíaz safe at first on throwing error by pitcher Burgos. Osuna pinch-running for ElDíaz. Jansen sac- rificed, Osuna to second. Foscue flied out to center. Seager singled to center, Osuna scored. Jung doubled to left, Seager to third. Lopez pinch-running for Jung. Burger grounded out to shortstop.										

AL wild card

	W	L	Pct.	GB
p-New York.....	88	64	.579	+11
Boston	82	70	.539	+5
Chicago.....	77	75	.507	—
Texas.....	76	76	.500	1
Toronto.....	76	77	.497	1½
Baltimore.....	75	78	.490	2½
Detroit.....	72	80	.474	5
Minnesota.....	71	81	.467	6
*Seattle.....	70	82	.461	7
Kansas City.....	67	85	.441	10
* — Not including late game				

Red Sox bats go quiet again in loss to Rangers

►RED SOX
Continued from Page C1

now have dipped again.

The specifics this time perhaps make it feel worse. After the blast from Con- treras, the Red Sox’ only other run came via Jakob Junis’s balk, called because he dropped the ball while on the pitching rubber. They didn’t do much against lefthander MacKenzie Gore, whose ve- locity was down as he dealt with shoul- der/back spasms. They finished 0 for 7 with runners in scoring position.

“We’re not coming through with runners in scoring position, and those kind of come in waves,” Caleb Durbin said.

Former Red Sox hurler Nathan Eovaldi, pitching out of the bullpen fol- lowing his recent return from the in- jured list, handled the final four innings for the Rangers to pick up the win. He gave up a lone knock without allowing a run or a walk.

The game turned in the bottom of the seventh, when lefthander Erik Mill- er gave up three runs. After he hit a bat- ter and walked another, Brandon Nim- mo doubled to put Texas (76-76) ahead. Ezequiel Duran’s two-run single opened

up that lead.

Over his past five games, the previ- ously dominant Miller has yielded six walks (one intentional) plus the hit-by- pitch.

“It doesn’t really matter how good your stuff is. If the guy knows what’s coming, usually doesn’t end well,” Mill- er said. “Just wasn’t my day. Just kind of working through some stuff [in his me- chanics] right now.”

For starters, lefthanders Jake Ben- nett (4½ innings, three runs) and Gore (four innings, three runs) pitched to a draw.

Bennett encountered trouble in a 26- pitch opening inning but held the Rang- ers to one run. He allowed eight hits and a walk altogether.

“Overall, not horrible,” Tracy said.

Bennett has a 5.14 ERA in his past 10 starts.

“Now that I’ve been up [in the ma- jors] for a little while, the scouting rep- ort is out,” he said. “These guys know what I’m trying to do, so just going to be adjusting to their game plan and maybe trying to mix in a little more sweeper, like we did tonight.”

With the loss, the Red Sox (82-70)



¼TONY GUTIERREZ/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Former Red Sox righthander Nate Eovaldi threw four scoreless innings to finish the Rangers’ win Wednesday.

were officially eliminated from AL East contention.

They are 7-7 in September and have lost five of their past seven games, but they remain entrenched in the second wild-card spot in the American League.

Durbin said the club has “full confi-

dence” they’ll figure it out over the final 10 games of the regular season, and he cited the expected return of Ceddanne Rafaela (right quad strain) as a reason.

“We know what we’re capable of. You get to September, and it can be a drag at times,” Durbin said. “Obviously,

we’re still trying to make a postseason, clinch a spot, but we’ve done a good job of putting ourselves in a position where if we drop a couple games, we’re still OK. We earned that. But there’s still that sense of urgency to get the job done.”

Baseball

NOTEBOOK

Judge (leg) exits Yankees' loss to Twins

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Luke Keaschall went 3 for 5 and scored from second base on **Victor Caratini's** game-ending single in the 13th inning Wednesday in Minneapolis, sending the Twins to a 5-4 win against the Yankees.

New York, which owns the American League's top wild card and is still in contention for the AL East title with a four-game series vs. the first-place Rays looming next week, pulled **Aaron Judge** for a pinch hitter in the sixth inning with tightness in his lower right leg. The three-time AL MVP's removal was precautionary after an injury he characterized as a normal occurrence soon after a long layoff. He is 4 for 26 with 13 strikeouts and one extra-base hit in seven games since returning from a broken rib.

John Schreiber (2-4) took the hard-luck loss. Leading off the 13th with Keaschall on second, pinch-hitter Caratini smacked a sinker up the middle that rookie shortstop **George Lombard Jr.** charged but had scoot underneath his glove.

Tommy Nance (3-3) pitched a perfect 13th for the Twins, who avoided a three-game sweep.

New York struck out a season-high-tying 17 times, including five by **Spencer Jones**, and left a season high 13 men on base.

Anthony Volpe's tying two-run double with two outs in the ninth off **Yoendrys Gómez** put the Yankees on the board after they were silenced by Twins starter **Zebby Matthews** over six innings. Keaschall drove in the automatic runner with a leadoff single in the 10th to tie the game after **Ali Sanchez's** RBI single in the top of the inning. **José Caballero** and **Royce Lewis** traded sacrifice flies in the 11th.

Rays roll on, extend lead

Nick Martinez worked five efficient innings in St. Petersburg, Fla., to improve to 15-4, **Jonny DeLuca** was 2 for 4 with an RBI double, and the AL East-leading Rays edged the Athletics, 4-3, for their fifth straight win. Tampa Bay, which last week were the majors' first team to clinch a postseason bid, extended their division lead to 4½ games over the Yankees.

Ryan Lasko, a 23-year-old Athletics outfield prospect who was paralyzed from the chest down in an outfield collision with a teammate in a Double-A game in June, was released from a hospital and will continue his recovery from home in New Jersey.

In another AL East win with playoff implications, **Myles Straw** had two hits and an RBI, **Max Scherzer** (3-8) allowed one run in five innings, and the host Blue Jays came out on top, 5-1, to end the Tigers' winning streak at six. **Brett Bateman** had two hits and scored a run as Toronto avoided a three-game sweep and sits 1½ games behind the White Sox for the final wild card in the league.

And in New York, **Pete Alonso** homered against his former team again, a solo shot in the first inning off fill-in starter **Xzavion Curry** (0-1) for career No. 301 that sent the Orioles to a 7-1 victory and series sweep of the Mets. Ex-Met **Chris Bassitt** (8-5) pitched into the seventh for the Orioles, who moved within 2½ games of the last AL playoff spot.

Guardians move into first place

Petey Halpin hit a three-run home run in a four-run sixth inning and the Guardians moved into first place in the AL Central with a 6-3 victory over the visiting White Sox. The Guardians have a half-game lead over the White Sox after taking two of three in the series as they go for a third straight division title.

The White Sox dropped seven of nine and 12 of 17, ending their run of 74 straight days in first.

José Ramírez had two doubles to tie **Nap Lajoie** for second on the franchise's career list with 424, and **Jo Adell** had a two-run single in the third.

White Sox infielder **Colson Montgomery** was taken out during the fifth inning because of a bruised left wrist suffered on a hit by pitch.

Astros lose, slip into second

John Rave hit a two-run homer and **Michael Massey** added a solo shot as the visiting Royals topped the Astros, 5-2, dropping Houston into a first-place tie with the Rangers, who climbed up with a win over the Red Sox, in the AL West.

The Astros own the tiebreaker with the Rangers with both teams at 76-76, but this is the first time since Aug. 24 the Astros have not been alone in first place. Whichever team doesn't win the division could still make the playoffs as a wild card.

Jeremy Peña was 3 for 4 with a double, his second consecutive three-hit game for the Astros. **Yainer Diaz** homered in the ninth inning.

Reds delay a Dodgers title

The Reds prevented the visiting Dodgers from clinching the NL West title with a 6-2 victory. The Dodgers (92-60) needed to win or for the Padres to lose a later game to clinch their fifth straight NL West crown and 13th in 14 seasons, but they lost and wild-card hopeful Padres beat the Rockies, 9-3, in Denver as **Ethan Salas** became the youngest catcher with a multi-homer game by hitting two at 20 and 107 days, besting **Butch Wynegar's** mark of 20 and192 days in 1976 for the Twins. **Blake Snell** started for the Dodgers but departed after a 19-pitch first inning with left groin tightness. . . **Pete-Crow Armstrong** hit his 43rd and 44th homers to break **Billy Williams's** Cubs record for lefties, and **Shota Imanaga** (11-10) allowed a run in six innings in an 8-4 victory over the NL East-best Braves. **Alex Gregman** went 3 for 4 (homer, triple, double; four RBIs), and Crow-Armstrong added an RBI triple as the Cubs stayed a half-game ahead of the Phillies for the first NL wild card. . . **Zack Wheeler** pitched seven scoreless innings, **Alec Bohm** went 2 for 2 with an RBI and three of his team's season-high 13 walks, and the Phillies shut out the host Nationals, 3-0.

Wheeler (13-5) allowed four hits, walked one, and had four strikeouts.

TWINS 5, YANKEES 4

NY Yankees	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Rice dh	3	0	1	0	3	1	.262
Bellinger lf-1b	5	1	3	0	1	0	.276
Judge rf	2	1	0	0	2	1	.221
Ramos ph-rf	3	0	0	0	1	1	.171
García Jr. 1b	4	0	0	0	0	3	.285
Sánchez c	2	0	1	1	0	1	.250
Jones cf	6	2	1	0	1	0	.252
Lombard Jr. ss	6	2	1	0	0	0	.253
McMahon 3b	6	0	0	0	0	4	.170
Wells c	2	0	0	0	0	0	.219
Gidschmidt ph-1b	2	0	1	0	0	0	.253
Caballero pr-if	3	1	0	1	0	0	.224
Volpe 2b	5	0	2	2	0	0	.253
Totals	46	4	9	4	5	17	

MINNESOTA	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Keaschall rf	5	2	3	1	0	0	.279
Martin lf	5	0	1	0	0	1	.234
Caratini ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	.221
Jeffers c	4	0	0	0	1	1	.253
Bell dh	5	0	1	1	0	0	.221
Jenkins pr-dh	0	1	0	0	0	0	.089
Clemens 1b-2b	4	0	1	0	1	2	.241
Lewis 3b-2b	4	0	1	0	1	0	.228
Rodriguez cf	4	0	0	0	1	1	.263
Kreidler 2b-ss	4	1	1	1	1	2	.217
Ross ss	2	0	1	0	0	0	.167
Lee ph-3b	2	0	1	0	1	0	.246
Totals	40	10	10	5	11	24	

E—Jones (2). LOB —NY Yankees 13, Minnesota 10. 2B —Volpe (11), Ross (1). HR —Kreidler (7), off Rodon. SB —Bellinger (1). CS —Volpe (11), Keaschall (18), Clemens (9). CS —Kreidler (4). S —Keaschall. SF —Caballero, Lewis. DP —NY Yankees 1; Minnesota 4.									
NY Yankees	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ER	BB	SO
Rodón	6	4	2	3	3	5	2.25	3	5
Schmidt	3 2/3	2	0	0	0	2	0.00	2	0
Headrick	1 1/3	0	0	0	0	2	1.50	1	2
Blackburn	1	0	0	0	1	0	1.00	1	0
Bednar BS 4	2	3	2	0	0	2	2.25	2	2
Schreiner 1-2-4	1	1	1	0	1	0	3.00	1	3

NY Yankees	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Rodón	6	2	0	0	2	3	.295
Schmidt	½	2	0	0	0	2	0.00
Headrick	1½	0	0	0	0	2	1.90
Blackburn	1	0	0	0	1	0	1.65
Bednar BS 4	2	3	2	0	0	2	2.58
Jeffers L 2-4	1	1	1	1	1	1	3.14
Minnesota	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Mathews	6	1	0	0	0	2	.252
Hoffman	1	0	0	0	0	2	3.93
Minter	1	2	0	0	0	1	2.55
Gómez BS 1	¾	3	2	2	1	4	2.10
Funderburk	½	0	0	0	0	1	3.86
Adams	¾	2	0	0	1	1	4.97
Nance W 3-3	1	0	0	0	0	2	4.06

Schreiber pitched to 1 batter in the 13th. Inherited runners-scored—Headrick 2-0, Funderburk 2-0. IBB—off Schreiber (Lee). NP—Rodón 102, Schmidt 24, Headrick 21, Blackburn 11, Bednar 26, Schreiber 4, Matthews 97, Hoffman 16, Minter 22, Gómez 24, Funderburk 3, Adams 34, Nance 14. Umpires—Home, Edwin Jimenez; First, Louis Krupa; Second, John Tumpane; Third, Jereennan Miller. T—3:48. A—21,887 (38,544).
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BLUE JAYS 5, TIGERS 1

DETROIT	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
McGonigle 3b	5	0	2	0	0	1	.274
Hile 2b	4	0	1	0	0	1	.264
Keith dh	1	1	1	0	1	0	.259
Torres ph-dh	2	0	1	0	0	0	.265
Greene lf	4	0	1	1	0	0	.284
Dingler c	4	0	0	0	0	0	.242
Clark cf	4	0	0	0	1	0	.277
Torkelson 1b	2	0	1	0	2	1	.226
Callahan rf	3	0	0	0	1	1	.214
Peck ss	4	0	0	0	0	1	.220
Totals	33	1	7	1	4	6	

Toronto.....	000	212	00x	-	5	9	
E—McGonigle (18),	Peck (2).	LOB—D-					
troit 9, Toronto 7.	2B—Keith (18),	JoSmith (4)					
CS—McGonigle (4),	Straw (2).	S—Lukes.	SF—				
Clement.	DP—Detroit 3.						
Detroit	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Montero L 9-9	4	6	2	2	2	4	3.2
Holton	1	2	1	1	0	0	2.7
Sommers	1	1	2	0	0	0	3.6
Kinley	2	0	0	0	1	0	1.5

Toronto	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Scherzer W 3-8	5	3	1	1	3	3	6.8
Flyhury	1	0	0	0	0	0	3.3
Miles	2	4	0	0	1	1	2.0
Varland S 34	1	0	0	0	0	2	1.0

Miles pitched to 2 batters in the 9th. **Inherited runners scored**—Varland 2-0. **NPI**—Montero 89, Holton 12, Sommers 16, Kinle 14, Scherzer 73, Flyhury 11, Miles 35, Varland 14. **Ummires**—Home. Dan Jassogna: First

RAYS 4, ATHLETICS 3							
DETROIT	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Scherzer W 3-8	5	3	0	0	0	2	.233
Fluhrarty	1	0	0	0	0	0	3.30
Miles	2	4	0	0	1	1	2.65
Varland S 34	1	0	0	0	0	2	1.30
Miles pitched to 2 batters in the 9th. Inherited runners-scored—Valenzuela 2-0, Montero 8-9, Holtun 12, Sommers 16, Kinley 24, Scherzer 73, Fluhrarty 11, Miles 35, Varland 14. Umpires—Home, Dan Iassogna; First, Brock Ballou; Second, Jeremie Rehak; Third, Adam Beck. T—2:33. A—43,463 (41,500).							
RAYS 4, ATHLETICS 3							
DETROIT	AB	R <td>H<td>BI<td>BB<td>SO<td>Avg.</td></td></td></td></td>	H <td>BI<td>BB<td>SO<td>Avg.</td></td></td></td>	BI <td>BB<td>SO<td>Avg.</td></td></td>	BB <td>SO<td>Avg.</td></td>	SO <td>Avg.</td>	Avg.
Scherzer W 3-8	5	3	0	0	0	2	.233
Fluhrarty	1	0	0	0	0	0	3.30
Miles	2	4	0	0	1	1	2.65
Varland S 34	1	0	0	0	0	2	1.30
Miles pitched to 2 batters in the 9th. Inherited runners-scored—Valenzuela 2-0, Montero 8-9, Holtun 12, Sommers 16, Kinley 24, Scherzer 73, Fluhrarty 11, Miles 35, Varland 14. Umpires—Home, Dan Iassogna; First, Brock Ballou; Second, Jeremie Rehak; Third, Adam Beck. T—2:33. A—43,463 (41,500).							
RAYS 4, ATHLETICS 3							
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Scherzer W 3-8	5	3	0	0	0	2	.233
Fluhrarty	1	0	0	0	0	0	3.30
Miles	2	4	0	0	1	1	2.65
Varland S 34	1	0	0	0	0	2	1.30
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RAYS 4, ATHLETICS 3

ATHLETICS	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Bolte cf	4	1	1	1	0	2	.275
McNeil 2b	3	1	2	0	0	1	.270
White 1b	1	0	1	0	0	1	.261
Alt/Williams ss	0	0	0	0	0	0	.260
Langeliers dh	4	0	1	1	0	1	.265
Butler rf	4	0	1	0	0	2	.228
Gelof 3b	4	0	0	0	0	1	.247
Walton ss-2b	4	0	0	0	0	2	.259
White 1b	4	1	3	1	0	0	.259
Cortes lf	3	0	0	0	0	0	.252
Serven c	3	0	0	0	0	0	.194
Totals	34	3	8	3	0	8	

TAMPA BAY	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Diaz dh	4	0	0	0	0	0	.297
John 1b	4	0	0	0	0	2	.269
Camrinerio 3b	4	1	1	0	0	0	.278
Deluca cf	4	1	2	1	0	1	.316
Simpson if	4	0	2	1	0	1	.260
Madrigal 2b	3	0	1	0	0	0	.252
Palacios ph-rf	1	0	0	0	0	0	.262
Mesa Jr. 2b	4	0	0	0	0	1	.278
Matteo ss	3	1	1	0	0	1	.148
Fortes c	2	1	1	0	0	0	.264
Hicks ph-c	1	0	0	0	0	1	.289
Totals	34	4	9	4	0	6	

Tampa Bay	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Martinez W 15-4	5	5	2	2	0	3	2.9
KeKelly	2	3	1	1	0	4	2.9
Booser	1	0	0	0	0	1	2.7
Sulser S 3	1	0	0	0	0	0	4.5

Blewett 1-0, Harris 1-0.	NP—Basso 5
Sjohanson 24, Rom 10, Blewett 19, Harris 22.	
Martinez 72, KeKelly 28, Booser 9, Sulser 12.	
Umpires —Home, Alan Porter; First, Jim Wolf; Second, Roberto Ortiz; Third, Alex Mackay.	
T —2:27. A —14,552 (25,025).	

PHILLIES 3, NATIONALS 0

PHILLIES 3, NATIONALS 0

PHILADELPHIA	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Schwarber dh	4	0	0	0	1	2	.237
Turner ss	4	1	0	0	1	1	.240
Harper rf	4	2	1	0	1	0	.270
Arraez 2b	4	1	1	0	1	0	.232
Bohm 1b	2	0	2	1	3	0	.251
Stott 3b	3	0	0	1	2	0	.247
Realmutto c	4	0	0	0	1	2	.218
Marsh lf	3	0	0	0	0	1	.261
Crawford cf	3	0	0	0	0	0	.266
Totals	30	3	4	2	8	8	

WASHINGTON	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Wood rf	4	0	0	0	0	0	.265
Lille lf	4	0	2	0	0	0	.251
Ortiz 1b	3	0	0	0	1	2	.205
Abrams 2b-ss	4	0	1	0	0	0	.264
Tena dh	4	0	0	0	0	3	.221
Vivas 3b-2b	3	0	0	0	0	1	.241
Crews cf	3	1	0	0	1	0	.222
Ruiz c	2	0	1	0	0	1	.288
Houze ph-3b	1	0	0	0	0	0	.239
Nunez ss	2	0	0	0	0	0	.211
Chaparro ph	0	0	0	0	0	0	.258
Ford pr-c	0	0	0	0	0	0	.191
Totals	30	4	4	2	8	8	

Washington	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	2
Simpson L 1-1	2½	1	2	2	4	0	10.3
Cornelio	2½	0	0	0	2	1	4.0
Dion	2½	2	0	0	1	3	3.0
Lovelady	¾	2	1	1	0	1	3.5
Peralas	2	0	0	0	1	2	9.0
Cruz	¾	0	0	0	5	0	6.4

Inherited runners scored—Cornelio 3, Lovelady 1-0, Peralas 1-0, Cruz 2-0. **NP**—26, Wheeler 31, Alvarado 16, Duran 21, Simpson 26, Cornelio 34, Dion 45, Lovelady 13, Peralas 49, Cruz 9. **Umpires**—Home, Alfonso Maestas; First, Lance Barrett; Second, Mike Estep; Third, Mike Estep; Fourth, Mike Estep; Pitcher, Brook; Third, Malachi Moore. **T**—2:55.

A—23,007 (41,596).

NL WILD CARD				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Chicago.....	85	68	.556	—
Philadelphia.....	84	68	.553	—
San Diego.....	83	69	.546	—
*Arizona.....	80	72	.526	3
*Miami.....	75	77	.493	8
Pittsburgh.....	75	77	.493	8
St. Louis.....	75	78	.490	8

Brown trade done, so time for fans to move on

CHAD FINN



Brad Stevens knows how to spot a metaphor, whether it happens to be right in his face, a little behind him, or, coming off a transformative and endlessly deliberated Celtics offseason, both at the same time.

More than two months after the stunning trade that sent former NBA Finals Most Valuable Player Jaylen Brown to the rival 76ers for 36-year-old forward Paul George, two first-round picks, and a pair of second-rounders, the Celtics finally introduced the nine-time All-Star — along with fellow off-season acquisition Mike Conley Jr., a highly respected 38-year-old point guard — Tuesday afternoon at the Auerbach Center.

During the half-hour news conference, when Conley — who noted that he was already in the league when Paul Pierce, Kevin Garnett, Ray Allen, and friends collected Banner 17 during the 2007-08 season — said all of the right

things, and George *almost* did.

They were joined on the podium by coach Joe Mazzulla — 262 days Conley’s junior — and Stevens, the president of basketball operations, whose extraordinary aptitude as a team-builder during his five seasons in the role did not shield him from Celtics fans angered by and unwilling to understand the decision to trade Brown.

It was a little more than 12 minutes into the festivities when Stevens, in a sly and slightly wry way, turned to the metaphor as a subtle way to say that the Celtics have turned the page.

When asked when the Celtics had stopped feeling the absence of players that have moved — obviously meaning Brown, who averaged precisely 20 points per game in his 10 seasons with the Celtics and was one of sturdiest pillars of the community that Boston sports has provided in recent generations — Stevens brought up Monday’s “season launch” for the basketball staff at the Auerbach Center.

“I had one picture behind me while I was speaking,” recalled Stevens. “It was of the [Auerbach Center] court being refurbished. That happens every year right around [this time]. And to me, ev-

ery single year you go through, it looks like a blank canvas of the court absolutely being redone. Nobody has stepped on it, and it’s [a reminder that it’s] this year’s team’s turn to write its own chapter.

“Every team has a chance to write its own chapter,” he concluded. “I really like this group.”

George, still broadly skilled and savvy but injury prone, will be essential to how this chapter plays out.

The first sentences are just being written now, but Celtics fans, if they are ready to allow themselves to, should like *almost* all of what they heard from George, who was the main draw on Tuesday for an assortment of reasons.

He’s a highly accomplished player in his own right, a six-time All-NBA selection who played an essential role in the 76ers’ comeback from a 3-1 deficit to bounce the Celtics from the postseason in a seven-game first-round series.

George, who shot 55 percent from 3-point territory in that series, had an active on-court role in ending the Jayson Tatum/Brown era before he was a main chip in the trade that ended it officially.

George, who acknowledged that he was well aware of a consensus of Celtics

fans’ disfavor with the trade, was effortlessly gracious about what Brown meant to the Celtics and the city.

“I understand the circumstances. I understand how huge JB was not only for the organization but also here in the city,” George said. “So I didn’t take [the backlash] personally. [Fans] should have a relationship personally to the trade.”

As for the aforementioned “almost,” let’s just say that George, for a 16-year veteran, did make a rookie mistake at the podium. He thought the Celtics were tied for the most championship banners — he was quickly corrected by Stevens — which is the kind of mistake one might expect from someone who spent five seasons with the Clippers, the perennial second-class citizens in Los Angeles to the Lakers. Presumably he’ll remember that the Celtics have a one-banner lead, 18-17, from now on. He had better.

It would take some fortuitous breaks, the rapid development of multiple young players, and team-wide good health for the Celtics to have a shot at increasing that title advantage in the coming season.

But George’s acknowledgment that

the Celtics have “a superstar, and that’s JT,” is an enticing indication that we will be watching a more aesthetically pleasing style of basketball this season.

Acknowledge it if you haven’t already: Tatum and Brown, as accomplished as they were as a tandem, didn’t play together so much as they played opposite of each other.

As accomplished as he is, George plays an unselfish style that should mesh well with Tatum’s skill set.

It struck me as notable that the acknowledgments of how much Brown meant to the Celtics came from the player acquired for him, the one replacing him in the lineup, if not stylistically.

Stevens did already say his praiseful piece about Brown in a news conference following the staggering trade back in July. There was no need for him to say more Tuesday.

But the court has been refurbished. It’s a new season, and a new team’s turn to leave its marks on the hardwood.

The Celtics have moved on. Left unsaid, but true nonetheless: It’s time for Celtics fans to do the same.

Chad Finn can be reached at chad.finn@globe.com.

Unlocking the Legacy’s full potential

►LEGACY
Continued from Page C1

the team.

Kelly uses Senaptec Strobe glasses with the goalkeepers to “turn on” their brains and their peripheral vision before games. When she leads meditation with the players, they wear headbands that measure their brainwaves and provide feedback on how focused they were during the session.

“I can be doing the Strobe glasses with you, just throwing a ball before the game, and then you’re saying, ‘Wow, I’m a little bit nervous for this game,’” Kelly said. “Maybe it brings up other conversations and makes it easier to talk about those, too.”

Kelly’s job is not to be a counselor, though she’s happy to listen to players when they need to get something off their chest. Each NWSL team is required by the collective bargaining agreement to employ at least two mental health professionals: a mental performance coach (Kelly) and a “licensed mental health provider,” meaning a psychiatrist or psychologist.

But that is the baseline — the league encourages its clubs to do what works best for them and their players beyond what’s outlined in the CBA.

“Our league is very proactive about seeing mental health as healthcare; it’s not a luxury beyond healthcare,” said Brett Haskell, the NWSL’s director of mental health and performance.

“It’s part of healthcare, and in addition to having team physicians and athletic trainers and nutritionists, having qualified mental health providers is part of providing a good interdisciplinary care team, and providing mental performance coaches is part of having a good performance team.”

That doesn’t mean that everyone in the club was instantly on board with Kelly’s work, however.

When Kelly met the Legacy players in Boston for the first time this past winter, a few ran right up to her and said they couldn’t wait to get started. Many already had ideas of what they wanted to work on with her. Others avoided eye contact.

Some players had a hard time trusting a new coach right away, particularly with something as vulnerable as their mental health; others were scarred from previous bad experiences with mental health professionals. Some came from countries in which mental health care is less common and more stigmatized than it is in the United States.

Even Patão wasn’t on board from the start. In Kelly’s final job interview, she said, Patão told her she



COURTESY BOSTON LEGACY

Mental performance coach Jacqueline Kelly (second from right) has optimized players’ potential.

didn’t like mental performance coaches and wasn’t interested in working with one.

Kelly eventually won over Patão by showing her proof that her methods work. The coach has acknowledged her imperfections in news conferences, noting that she has as much to work on as the players do.

“How can I set the example if I don’t work on that, too?” Patão said before a 1-0 win over the Kansas City Current in July. “I lead them by example, so it’s a thing that we work on as coaches, too. How can we be better? How can we be more or less reactive in some moments? How can we help the players more?”

Improvement in mental performance isn’t always visible, so the gadgets and spreadsheets help legitimize Kelly’s work in the eyes of skeptics, including Patão.

Now, nearing the end of the Legacy’s inaugural season, Kelly has pages and pages of data — proof for the players that what they’re doing is working.

“You can have all the technique, you can have all the capacity,” Patão said, “but if your mind doesn’t help, you cannot be a great player.”

Emma Healy can be reached at emma.healy@globe.com or on X @ByEmmaHealy.

Revolution suffer pair of key injuries

By Hayden Bird
BOSTON.COM STAFF

Just as the Revolution were starting to find a consistent lineup, the injury bug has bitten again.

Central midfielder Alhassan Yusuf and winger Jack Harrison are “expected to miss at least six weeks,” according to a club announcement Wednesday, because of injuries picked up Sept. 9 in a 2-1 win over New York City FC. Harrison, 29, sustained a proximal quadriceps injury, while Yusuf, 26, is battling a hamstring strain.

Both players factored into the team’s recent run of success, with just one loss in their last six matches to climb to third in the Eastern Conference.

In other team news, two players have reportedly earned their first US men’s national team callup for the upcoming September/October FIFA international window, defender/winger Peyton Miller and midfielder Brooklyn Raines.

Sweeney: Bruins to have a captain, but it’s TBA

►ON HOCKEY
Continued from Page C1

quality in picking the guy who’ll be in charge of those teammates, acting as the connective tissue between the players and the coaching staff. Players like an advocate who can coach up the coach.

There’s no going wrong with either choice here, which is a credit to the players themselves and the team that drafted them. They’re solid citizens, log huge ice time, constantly talk about how proud they are to be Bruins. Both A+ characters.

We’ll hear more (maybe?) come Reveal Day about why it took Sweeney, team president Cam Neely, and coach Marco Sturm so long to pick the one man for the role. The fact that there were two who fit the bill no doubt played a part in the one-and-a-half-year delay.

One of the candidates will be left disappointed and that, too, had to have factored into the decision. Maybe the player deemed best suited to withstand the sting of not getting the gig ended up the choice not to get the gig.

The read here is that the scale tips ever-so-slightly in Pastrnak’s favor, in part because of his proven, greater durability. McAvoy has been banged up more, as is often the case for defensemen. That’s not a fault or flaw on McAvoy’s part, but it is a sobering reality. He’s logged a lot of days in the hurt locker.

McAvoy had that nasty shoulder infection, incurred during the 4 Nations Face-Off, which clipped his 2024-25 season at 50 games and also terminated

the club’s playoff hopes.

Losing McAvoy that spring proved to be the gateway to the payoff DNQ, and it dovetailed to management’s decision to enact a roster reset at the March trade deadline, leading to the exits of Charlie Coyle, Brandon Carlo, Marchand, and others. Now about to enter his 10th season, McAvoy has yet yet to suit up for a full regular season.

Pastrnak four times has suited up for all 82 regular-season games. Arguably the game’s premier right winger, he missed five games last season, a rarity, after stringing together three 82-game performances, and scored 100 points or better in all four of those seasons.

He has enjoyed the fortune of good health — not shared by an unfortunate McAvoy — and as the club’s top scorer, has felt obligated to be out there and perform even when not at his best.

On a number of nights, particularly the last two seasons, fatigue clearly could be seen in Pastrnak’s game. Stamina equates to leadership. Former captains Ray Bourque, Zdeno Chara, Patrice Bergeron,

and Marchand all exhibited similar mental strength to play through fatigue and the nagging injuries that come with a grueling schedule.



FILE/JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Charlie McAvoy could be swapping the “A” on his Bruins sweater for the captain’s “C” soon.

Players hit the ice Thursday morning at Warrior Ice Arena in Brighton (all workouts open to the public). The four-game preseason begins at 5 p.m. Sunday, with the Capitals visiting Causeway Street.

The B’s are back and a “C,” currently TBA, is on the way.

Kevin Paul Dupont can be reached at kevin.dupont@globe.com.

Change for WTA Finals

The WTA Finals, the elite season-ending event in women’s tennis, will be held in Charlotte, N.C., for the next three years. The tournament will be played at the Spectrum Center, home of the NBA’s Hornets, where the year’s top eight singles players and doubles teams qualify for the event, which is usually held in November.

ManU woes continue

Manchester United blew a two-goal lead to crash out of the English League Cup with a 3-2 loss to visiting Brighton. United led 2-0 after 10 minutes through quickfire goals from **Shea Lacey** and **Mason Mount**. But the Seagulls got one back before halftime thanks to **Charalamos Kostoulas**, and then **Pascal Gross** and **Maxim De Cuyper** secured victory after the break . . . **Lionel Messi** scored the 100th goal of his Inter Miami career in a 2-0 win over Cruz Azul to win the Campeones Cup in Miami.

HIGH SCHOOL GIRLS' SOCCER NOTEBOOK

Ingredients in place for Concord-Carlisle to cook

By Henry Dinh-Price
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Peter Fischelis has been coaching high school soccer long enough to know when a team has the makings of something special.

In his 14th season at Concord-Carlisle, he believes this Patriots girls' team has the requisite qualities.

"These guys seem to have the complete package," said Fischelis.

After reaching the Division 1 semifinal as the No. 10 seed last fall, Concord-Carlisle returns 16 players from last season's roster. The Patriots also have multiple newcomers making immediate impacts.

That depth, Fischelis believes, is what makes third-ranked Concord-Carlisle even more dangerous than it was last fall.

"We are much more balanced," he said.

Senior midfielder **Emmy O'Donnell** is the headliner. Committed to Duke, she is a returning All-American, last season's Massachusetts Gatorade Player of the Year, and a member of the United States under-19 and u-18 women's national teams.

She has incredible technical skills, tons of speed, and seemingly unlimited stamina.

"It's almost as if the whole team is playing on one-time speed and she's on two-times speed," said senior center back **Teagan Graham**.

Naturally, O'Donnell draws tons of attention from defenses. At times last fall, the Patriots struggled to score when defenses prevented them from playing through O'Donnell. There are none of those worries this fall. In four games, the Patriots (4-0) already have seven different goal scorers, with O'Donnell posting four.

"When someone is manmarked, it offers up a lot of space for other people to do things," said O'Donnell. "With that happening to me, it's great to see everyone else kind of taking over."

Senior **Ainsley Siefer**, committed to Middlebury, is slated to be one of the top scorers after missing last fall's regular season with a broken foot. When Seifer returned for the postseason, she netted two of Concord-Carlisle's three playoff goals. A versatile weapon who has experience on the back line, the plan is to play Siefer up top.

"She's such a technical, skilled player that she can take some pressure off Emmy," said Fischelis. "One player you can often deal with, but when you have multiple players, that's a whole different dynamic."

The Patriots have the flexibility to push her forward thanks to the center back pairing of Graham (Union) and junior **Catherine Kilmartin** (Boston College). Graham has played outside back the last two seasons for the Patriots, but is moving to center back, where she plays for her club team.

While Kilmartin and Graham are a new cen-

ter back pairing, the two have chemistry from playing on the same side of the back line the last two seasons. Both players love to get up the field when the opportunity arises, leaving the other responsible for covering those spaces.

"We both have a lot of trust in each other to cover the other person," Kilmartin said.

Captain **Aubrey Monaghan**, a four-year starter in goal, provides a reliable safety net.

Junior midfielders **Camy Cox** and **Caroline Ferrari**, sophomore forward **Annie Beal**, and senior cocaptain **Kendall Johnson**, who is returning from a torn ACL, will also be impact players for the Patriots. Apart from the talent, Fischelis believes his team's leadership sets them apart.

"The group of senior leaders, they all bring something different to the table," he said. "They respect each other for what they bring, and they all encourage each other. That's a key component to having team success."

The players also discuss how tightly knit the team is. Many have grown up together, but they also go to a sleepaway camp in New Hampshire for two nights with no cell phones before the season to build camaraderie.

As much as that chemistry can lead to on-field success, it's also about simply cherishing time together.

"My goal for myself and the team is just to have fun doing it," said O'Donnell. "Just enjoy whatever ride we go on, whether it's to the state final or whether it's to who knows where."

Corner kicks

■ **Katrina Silva** (16) was a two-year captain at Peabody before playing collegiately at Delaware State. She entered coaching at the club level in 2020.

"The whole reason I got into club coaching was to eventually come back to Peabody," Silva said.

When **Andrew Douglass** left for Georgetown, Silva interviewed for, and accepted the position. She described the moment as surreal.

"It's nostalgic being on the turf and on the grass field where we used to play games," said Silva, now 28. "It's a dream come true."

She earned her first win Monday, 7-0, over Saugus. Through four games, Peabody is 1-2-1. Silva called this season a "transitional year."

Silva wants the Tanners to play "aggressive Peabody soccer" — finishing in the final third, winning 50-50 battles, and possessing the ball. It's a major adjustment, and Silva says her players are buying in.

"They love the intensity that I'm bringing and the standard that we're setting for years to come," she said.

Correspondent *Eli Cloutier contributed to this story.*

School football schedule

EASTERN MASS.
NONLEAGUE — Whittier at Lawrence, 6; Brookline at Lexington, 6:30.

FRIDAY'S GAMES
EASTERN MASS.

BAY STATE — Milton at Natick, 6.
BOSTON CITY — Brighton at East Boston, 6; TechBoston at English High, 6.
CAPE ANN — Amesbury at Pentucket/Georgetown, 6.
CATHOLIC CENTRAL — Cathedral at Arlington Cath., 4:30.
COMMONWEALTH — Lowell Catholic at Minuteman, 6.
GREATERT BOSTON — Medford at Somerville, 6.
HOCKOMOCK — Milford at King Philip, 6.
HAYFLOWER — Tri-County at Cape Cod Tech, 6:30; South Shore Voc-Tech at Bristol-Plymouth, 7.
MERRIMACK VALLEY — Haverhill at Dracut, 6:30; Andover at Chelmsford, 7; Tewksbury at Methuen, 7.
MIDDLESEX — Burlington at Woburn, 6; Arlington at Stoneham, 6:30.
PATRIOT — Hanover at Duxbury, 7.
SOUTH COAST — West Bridgewater at Dighton-Rehoboth/Tristoli Aggie, 6:30.
TRI-VALLEY — Bellingham at Westwood, 7.
NONLEAGUE — Boston Latin at O'Bryant, 4; Gloucester at St. Mary's, 5; Bay Path at Randolph, 6; Bedford at Newburyport, 6; Bishop Feehan at Attleboro, 6; Cardinal Spellman at Holbrook / Avon, 6; Chicopee Comprehensive at Hopkinton, 6; Dover-Sherborn at Weston, 6; Durfee at Taunton, 6; Essex Tech at Wakefield, 6; Fairhaven at Plymouth North, 6; Fitchburg at Greater Lowell, 6; Lynn Classical at Medfield, 6; Mashpee at Dennis-Yarmouth, 6; Millis at Worcester Tech, 6; Nashoba Valley Tech at Latin Academy, 6; Newton South at Newton North, 6; Norwood at Canton, 6; Saugus at Hamilton-Wenham, 6; Seekonk at Sandwich, 6; Shawsheen at Lynnfield, 6; Springfield Central at North Attleborough, 6; Whitman-Hanson at Stoughton, 6; Xaverian at Everett, 6; Athol at Murdock, 6:30; Barnstable at Minnechaug, 6:30; Falmouth at Apponequet, 6:30; Framingham at Shrewsbury, 6:30; Greater Lawrence at Salem, 6:30; KIPP at Manchester Essex, 6:30; Malden Catholic at Somerset Berkley, 6:30; Medway at Marblehead, 6:30; North Andover at Masconomet, 6:30; Northeast at Winthrop, 6:30; Pembroke at Nauset, 6:30; Sharon/Dedham at Wareham, 6:30; Southeastern at Joseph Case, 6:30; Upper Cape at Bourne, 6:30; Abington at Hingham, 7; Archbishop Williams at Norton, 7; BC High at La Salle (R.I.), 7; Billerica at Westford, 7; Bishop Stang at Old Rochester, 7; Blue Hills at Rockland, 7; Braintree at Quincy, 7; Bridgewater-Raynham at Plymouth South, 7; Brockton at Franklin, 7; Cambridge at Belmont, 7; Carver at Water-town, 7; Christian Brothers (N.Y.) at Catholic Memorial, 7; Cohasset at Silver Lake, 7; Danvers at Melrose, 7; Doherty at Leominster, 7; East Bridgewater at Shepherd Hill, 7; Greater New Bedford at Old Colony, 7; Holliston at Concord-Carlisle, 7; Hull at Monomoy/IP II, 7; Longmeadow at Nashoba, 7; Mahar at Monomoy/IP II, 7; Malden at Peabody, 7; Marshfield at Mansfield, 7; Middleborough at Dartmouth, 7; Needham at Lincoln-Sudbury, 7; North Reading at Groton-Dunstable/NM, 7; Putnam at Bishop Fenwick, 7; Scituate at Norwell, 7; St. John's Prep at Central Catholic, 7; Triton/Ipswich at Wilmington, 7; Walpole at Foxborough, 7; Wayland at Ashland, 7; Wellesley at Reading, 7; Weymouth at Diman, 7; Winchester at Acton-Boxborough, 7; Swampscott at Lynn English, 7:30.
NEPSAC
NEPSAC CLASS A — Dexter Southfield at Sufield Academy, 6; Salisbury (Conn.) at Brunswick, 6:30.

SATURDAY'S GAMES
EASTERN MASS.

NONLEAGUE — Revere at Beverly, 11a; Lowell at New Bedford, 1; Nantucket at Blackstone Valley, 1; Chelsea at Waltham, 2; Oliver Ames at North Quincy, 4.
NEPSAC
NEPSAC CLASS A — Hotchkiss at Phillips Andover, 2:30; Cheshire Academy at Taft, 3; Choate at Phillips Exeter, 3; Loomis Chaffee (Conn.) at Deerfield, 3.
NEPSAC CLASS C — Hamden Hall Country Day at King-swold-Oxford, 1.
NONLEAGUE — Austin Prep at St. Luke's, 2:30; Blair Academy at Greenwich CD (Conn.), 3; Williston Northampton at Tabor, 6.

Schools

CROSS-COUNTRY	
BOYS	BAY STATE
Brookline 18.....Milton 45	Brookline 24.....Natick 35
Natick 17.....Milton 40	Needham 22.....Braintree 33
Newton North 22.....Wellesley 35	Weymouth 23.....Braintree 32
Weymouth 27.....Needham 28	
CAPE ANN	LYNNFIELD
Essex Tech 17.....Lynnfield 40	Kenn. Wenham 16.....Georgetown 47
Manchester/Rockport 15.....Ipswich 43	Newburyport 18.....Pentucket 43
CATHOLIC CENTRAL	COMMONWEALTH
Abp. Williams 25.....St. Mary's 30	Northeast 27.....Shawsheen 28
Shawsheen 24.....Mystic Valley 35	Shawsheen 19.....Nashoba Tech 42
DUAL COUNTY	DUAL COUNTY
Concord-Carlisle 25Lincoln-Sudbury 36	Newton South 21.....Acton-Boxboro 39
Weston 19.....Bedford 36	
GREATERT BOSTON	HOCKOMOCK
Somerville 27.....Chelsea 30	Mansfield 20.....Canton 37
MERRIMACK VALLEY	MERRIMACK VALLEY
Andover 23.....Dracut 38	Billerica 18.....Haverhill 43
Chelmsford 22.....Ceal Cath. 33	Lowell 16.....Tewksbury 49
N. Andover 19.....Methuen 42	
NORTHEASTERN	NORTHEASTERN
Danvers 28.....Salem 29	Masconomet 19.....Marblehead 42
Peabody 28.....Swampscott 29	
PATRIOT	PATRIOT
Scituate 20.....Hanover 35	
SOUTH COAST	SOUTH COAST
Old Rochester 22.....Apponequet 30	
TRI-VALLEY	TRI-VALLEY
Bellingham 24.....Dedham 33	Hopkinton 16.....Westwood 45
NONLEAGUE	NONLEAGUE
Concord-Carlisle 15.....Bp. Feehan 50	Dartmouth 24.....New Bedford 35
Martha's Vnyd. 15.....Barnstable 50	
GIRLS	GIRLS
Needham 23.....Braintree 34	Needham 27.....Weymouth 29
Newton North 20.....Wellesley 42	Weymouth 23.....Braintree 33
CAPE ANN	CAPE ANN
Ham. Wenham 15.....Georgetown 50	Manchester/Rockport 15.....Ipswich 42
Newburyport 20.....Pentucket 43	
CATHOLIC CENTRAL	CATHOLIC CENTRAL
St. Mary's 15.....Abp. Williams 50	
COMMONWEALTH	COMMONWEALTH
Northeast 17.....Shawsheen 42	Shawsheen 23.....Mystic Valley 33
Shawsheen 18.....Nashoba Tech 40	
DUAL COUNTY	DUAL COUNTY
Bedford 23.....Weston 39	Concord-Carlisle 18Lincoln-Sudbury 49
Newton South 23.....Acton-Boxboro 37	
GREATERT BOSTON	GREATERT BOSTON
Somerville 15.....Chelsea 50	
HOCKOMOCK	HOCKOMOCK
Canton 18.....Mansfield 44	
MERRIMACK VALLEY	MERRIMACK VALLEY
Andover 15.....Dracut 50	Billerica 15.....Haverhill 50
Central Cath. 21.....Chelmsford 40	Lowell 23.....Tewksbury 38
N. Andover 15.....Methuen 50	
NORTHEASTERN	NORTHEASTERN
Danvers 20.....Salem 35	Marblehead 19.....Masconomet 41
Swampscott 25.....Peabody 30	
PATRIOT	PATRIOT
Hanover 27.....Scituate 28	
SOUTH COAST	SOUTH COAST
Apponequet 15.....Bourne 50	
TRI-VALLEY	TRI-VALLEY
Dedham 27.....Bellingham 28	Westwood 20.....Hopkinton 45
NONLEAGUE	NONLEAGUE
Barnstable 20.....Martha's Vnyd. 43	Concord-Carlisle 15.....Bp. Feehan 48
Stoneham 18.....Woburn 44	
FIELD HOCKEY	FIELD HOCKEY
BAY STATE	BAY STATE
Braintree 1.....Newton North 0	Brookline 6.....Framingham 0
Milton 5.....Needham 2	Natick 4.....Wellesley 3
CAPE & ISLANDS	CAPE & ISLANDS
Dennis-Yarmouth 4.....St. John Paul II 0	Nantucket 3.....Nauset 1
CAPE ANN	CAPE ANN
Essex Tech 3.....Amesbury 1	Ipswich 6.....N. Reading 1
Manchester 6.....Pentucket 0	Rockport 3.....Triton 0
HOCKOMOCK	HOCKOMOCK
Attleboro 12.....Stoughton 1	Canton 7.....Mansfield 1
Franklin 7.....Sharon 0	King Philip 3.....Foxboro 2
Oliver Ames 3.....North Attleboro 1	Taunton 7.....Milford 0
MERRIMACK VALLEY	MERRIMACK VALLEY
Andover 6.....Dracut 0	Central Cath. 2.....Haverhill 0
Lowell 2.....Methuen 2	N. Andover 0.....Tewksbury 0
MID-WACH	MID-WACH
Bromfield 6.....Fitchburg 3	Nashoba 6.....Wachusett 0
Oakmont 4.....N. Middlesex 2	Quabbin 3.....Westboro 0
Shrewsbury 5.....Grafton 1	Tahanto 1.....Maynard 0
Tyngsboro 1.....Littleton 1	
MIDDLESEX	MIDDLESEX
Belmont 3.....Winchester 1	
PATRIOT	PATRIOT
Hanover 8.....Plymouth North 0	Hingham 7.....Marshfield 0
Pembroke 3.....Plymouth South 1	Scituate 3.....Whit-Hanson 1
Silver Lake 0.....Duxbury 0	
NONLEAGUE	NONLEAGUE
Algonquin 4.....Leominster 0	Bp. Feehan 4.....Barnstable 1
Bp. Fenwick 6.....Burlington 0	Bp. Stang 5.....New Bedford 1
Chelmsford 6.....Westford 1	Dartmouth 4.....Durfee 1
Lincoln-Sudbury 8.....Cohasset 2	St. Mary's 3.....Shepherd Hill 0
Malden Cath. 2.....Stoneham 2	St. John's 7.....Swampscott 0
Southeastern 2.....Gr. Lowell 0	W. Springfield 2.....Belchertown 0
GOLF	GOLF
BOYS	BOYS
BAY STATE	BAY STATE
Milton 222.....Needham 237	
BERKSHIRE	BERKSHIRE
Pittsfield 189.....Monument Mtn. 209	
BI-COUNTY	BI-COUNTY
Easthampton 155S. Mary (Westfield) 203	
CAPE ANN	CAPE ANN
Lynnfield 184.....Georgetown 134	
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE	CATHOLIC CONFERENCE
St. John's Prep 225.....BC High 243	
COMMONWEALTH	COMMONWEALTH
Shawsheen 174.....Nashoba Tech 101	
DUAL COUNTY	DUAL COUNTY
Westford 230.....Acton-Boxboro 244	
EIL	EIL
Portsmouth Abbey 41/2.....Beaver CD 11/2	
HOCKOMOCK	HOCKOMOCK
Oliver Ames 148.....Foxboro 156	Taunton 157.....Stoughton 170
MAYFLOWER	MAYFLOWER
Blue Hills 9.....Southeastern 0	
MERRIMACK VALLEY	MERRIMACK VALLEY
Billerica 240.....Central Cath. 241	Billerica 240.....Methuen 279
Central Cath. 240.....Methuen 279	N. Andover 249.....Haverhill 260
MID-WACH	MID-WACH
Wachusett 270.....Shrewsbury 211	
NORTHEASTERN	NORTHEASTERN
Gloucester 62.....Peabody 110	Marblehead 48.....Saugus 24
Swampscott 30/2.....Beverly 41/2	
PATRIOT	PATRIOT
Duxbury 239.....Silver Lake 264	Hanover 225.....Pembroke 241
N. Quincy 238.....Quincy 253	Scituate 231.....Plymouth South 254
SOUTH COAST	SOUTH COAST
Apponequet 260.....Somerset Berkley 282	Seekonk 266.....Digh-Rehoboth 291
W. Bridgewater 236.....Bourne 249	
SOUTH SHORE	SOUTH SHORE
Carver 111.....Abington 115	E. Bridgewater 108.....Rockland 65
Mashpee 139.....Cohasset 126	Norwell 135.....Middleboro 119
TRI-VALLEY	TRI-VALLEY
Hopkinton 248.....Medway 285	Norton 239.....Medfield 254
Norwood 214.....Holliston 240	Norwood 214.....Millis 296
NONLEAGUE	NONLEAGUE
Abp. Williams 220.....Dedham 264	Bp. Stang 242.....Durfee 286
Cape Cod Tech 51/2Dennis-Yarmouth 3/2	Douglas 179.....St. Paul 189
Dover-Sherborn 217Lincoln-Sudbury 233	St. John's (S) 218.....Bp. Feehan 243
Smith Voc. 168.....Mohawk Trail 198	Tyngsboro 158.....Athol, Dracut 162
SOCCER	SOCCER
BOYS	CAPE & ISLANDS
Falmouth 2.....Monomoy 0	Nantucket 3.....Nauset 0
CATHOLIC CENTRAL	CATHOLIC CENTRAL
Abp. Williams 1.....Card. Spellman 1	Bp. Fenwick 1.....St. Mary's 1
CHURCHILL	CHURCHILL
Northampton 3.....Monument Mtn. 1	
CMAC	CMAC
Auburn 5.....Douglas 0	Bay Path 4.....University Park 0
Doherty 3.....Tantasqua 0	Keefe Tech 3.....Tantasqua 0
Leicester 2.....Assabet 1	Monty Tech 2.....Burncoat 0
Oxford 3.....Blackstone-Millville 0	Quabog 4.....Abby Kelley Foster 0
Uxbridge 4.....Northbridge 3	

Scoreboard

	THU 9/17	FRI 9/18	SAT 9/19	SUN 9/20	MON 9/21	TUE 9/22	WED 9/23
	TEX 8:05 NESN	TB 7:10 NESN	TB 4:10 NESN	TB 1:40 NESN		CLE 6:45 NESN	CLE 7:10 ESPN
				PIT 1:00 CBS			
			ORL 7:30 AppleTV				
				HOU 2:00 CBCSN, NBCSB			

Home games shaded
On the radio: Red Sox, WEEI-FM 93.7; Patriots and Revolution, WBZ-FM 98.5.

ON THE AIR

AUTO RACING
8 p.m. NASCAR Truck: UNOH 250 FS1

BASEBALL
12:40 p.m. LA Dodgers at Cincinnati MLB
6 p.m. Triple-A: Durham at Worcester NESN+
7:15 p.m. Philadelphia at NY Mets Fox
8:05 p.m. Boston at Texas NESN
9:38 p.m. Minnesota at LA Angels MLB

PRO BASKETBALL
7:30 p.m. WNBA: Connecticut at Atlanta NBCSB
8 p.m. WNBA: Los Angeles at Dallas USA
10 p.m. WNBA: Las Vegas at Seattle USA

COLLEGE FOOTBALL
7:30 p.m. Syracuse at Pittsburgh ESPN

PRO FOOTBALL
8:15 p.m. Detroit at Buffalo Amazon

GOLF
7 a.m. DP World: BMW PGA Championship Golf
1 p.m. Korn Ferry: Nationwide Championship Golf
3 p.m. PGA: Biltmore Championship Golf

MEN'S COLLEGE SOCCER
6 p.m. SMU at N.C. State ACC
8 p.m. Duke at North Carolina ACC

MEN'S SOCCER
12:45 p.m. Europa: Salzburg at Levski Sofia CBSSN
3 p.m. Europa: Bournemouth at Real Sociedad CBSSN

WOMEN'S SOCCER
8:45 a.m. U-20 World Cup: England vs Nigeria FS2
12:15 p.m. U-20 World Cup: North Korea vs. Japan FS2

WOMEN'S COLLEGE VOLLEYBALL
8 p.m. Marquette at Wisconsin Big Ten

■ For updates, go to bostonglobe.com/tvlistings

Schools

SOCCER

BOYS	
DUAL COUNTY	
Acton-Boxboro 4.....	Waltham 2
Concord-Carlisle 1.....	Cambridge 1
Lincoln-Sudbury 5.....	Boston Latin 1
Newton South 2.....	Bedford 0
Wayland 2.....	Weston 0
EIL	
Berkwick 5.....	Pingree 0
NORTHEASTERN	
Beverly 5.....	Danvers 0
Marblehead 4.....	Peabody 3
Swampscott 2.....	Saugus 0
SMITH	
Longmeadow 1.....	Ludlow 0
SOUTH COAST	
Apponequet 4.....	Somerset Berkley 1
Digh-Rehoboth 3.....	Old Rochester 0
Fairhaven 5.....	Seekonk 0
Joseph Case 3.....	Bourne 0
W. Bridgewater 3.....	Gr. New Bedford 1
SOUTH SHORE	
Abington 2.....	E. Bridgewater 0
Cohasset 8.....	Mashpee 0
Hull 2.....	Carver 2
Norwell 6.....	Middleboro 2
TRI-VALLEY	
Dedham 7.....	Millis 3
Dover-Sherborn 1.....	Bellingham 0
Hopkinton 3.....	Ashland 1
Medfield 2.....	Westwood 1
Medway 2.....	Norton 1
NONLEAGUE	
Athol 3.....	Mohawk Trail 1
Austin Prep 1.....	Thayer 1
Blackstone Valley 3.....	South High 2
Chicopee 6.....	Westfield 0
Nobles 0.....	Phillips Andover 0
Whit. Christian 7.....	Worcester Tech 3
Worcester Acad. 1.....	BB&N 0
GIRLS	
BOSTON CITY	
O'Bryant 3.....	E. Boston 2
CAPE & ISLANDS	
Falmouth 9.....	Monomoy 0
Nauset 3.....	Nantucket 0
Sandwich 4.....	St. John Paul II 0
CATHOLIC CENTRAL	
Bp. Fenwick 3.....	St. Mary's 0
Card. Spellman 4.....	Abp. Williams 0
CMAC	
Auburn 6.....	Tantasqua 1

Remembered

SHARE YOUR MEMORIES ON OUR GUEST BOOK AT [BOSTON.COM/OBITUARIES](https://boston.com/obituaries)

BY CITY AND TOWN

BOSTON LYDON, Thomas Patrick TANZER, Jason M.	MEDFORD TANZER, Jason M.
BROOKLINE SNELL, Bradley Allen	NEWTON LYDON, Thomas Patrick
DORCHESTER LYDON, Thomas Patrick	PEABODY LISTERNICK, Stanley E.
EVERETT LISTERNICK, Stanley E. SIEGEL, Robert Norman	PEABODY, TANZER, Jason M.
LYNN TANZER, Jason M.	QUINCY LYDON, Thomas Patrick
LYNNFIELD LISTERNICK, Stanley E.	WATERTOWN LYDON, Thomas Patrick
MALDEN SIEGEL, Robert Norman	
MASHPEE TANZER, Jason M.	

LISTERNICK, Stanley E. D.M.D.



Age 98, of Peabody, formerly of Lynnfield and Everett. September 12, 2026. Husband of the late Roselyn (Ratcliff) Listernick. Father of Debbie Listernick, Julie Estrada and husband, Ruben Estrada and the late Glenn Listernick. Grandfather of Nicole (Estrada) Robbins and husband, Brett Robbins, Brandon Estrada, Caroline Listernick and Christina Listernick. Great-grandfather of Sofia Roselyn Robbins. Visitation for relatives and friends will be held at the McDonald Funeral Home, 19 Yale Avenue, WAKEFIELD, MA, on Thursday, September 24, 2026, from 4 to 7 pm. Burial Services will be held at Woodlawn Cemetery, in Everett, MA, on Friday, September 25, 2026, at 11:00 am. For obit and guestbook, www.mcdonldfs.com

LYDON, Thomas Patrick

 September 12, 2026. Age 80. Loving father of Thomas Brian Lydon of Watertown and the late Jennifer Quinlan Lydon. Caring grandfather of Christian Thomas Lydon. Former husband of Sally (Rattigan) Lydon. Dear brother of Stephen of Plymouth, Dennis of Oklahoma, Paul of Dorchester, Mark of Dorchester, and the late John Lydon. Also survived by several nieces, nephews, and friends. U.S. Army Veteran. Retired MA State Trooper. Funeral from the MacDonald Rockwell & MacDonald Funeral Home. at 270 Main St., WATERTOWN, Monday, September 21, at 10 AM, followed by Funeral Mass in the Church of St. Patrick, 212 Main St., Watertown, at 11 AM. Relatives and friends kindly invited. Visiting Hours on Sunday, 4-7 PM.

MacDonald-Rockwell-MacDonald
www.macdonalrockwell.com

SIEGEL, Robert Norman “Bob”



Passed away, on September 9, 2026, surrounded by loved ones, at Kaplan Hospice Center, Danvers, after a brief hospital stay. Born and raised in Everett, Bob later moved to Malden, where he lived for the rest of his life. He also had a home for many years in Fort Myers, FL. He was a graduate of Everett High School and then Northeastern University. He worked for the Defense Department at Hanscom Air Force Base, in Bedford, for over thirty years. He also had a private CPA practice. Bob was an active member of Temple Congregation Tifereth Israel in Everett, for most of his life serving on the board of directors, as Treasurer and Congregation President.

Bob was predeceased by his parents, Ann and Abraham Siegel; as well as by his brothers, Howard and Barry Siegel. He leaves behind the love of his life, Carolyn; as well as his sons, Scott (Kimberly) and Adam (Kristen); and his beloved granddaughter, Isabella Siegel.

A traditional Jewish Funeral and Burial was held on September 11, with a small group of family and friends. Donations can be made to St Jude Children’s Hospital in his name. Funeral Services entrusted to Torf Funeral Service.

Torf Funeral Service
617.889.2900

SNELL, Bradley

Of Brookline. Died June 2026. Brother of Lisa; friend of Scott Egdahl. Grandson of Stanley Blinstrub, owner of the Blinstrub Village in S. Boston. Cousin of Lt. Gov. Kim Driscoll.

TANZER, Jason M. DMD Ph.D.

Age 88, of Mashhpee, MA (formerly of W. Hartford, CT), died at home, on September 15, 2026. In addition to his wife of 64 years, Lois Blesoff Tanzer; he is survived by his daughter, Tobi Tanzer and her husband, Rene Tragatsch of Falcon Heights, MN; his son, Adam, and his wife, Catherine of Bedford, NH; and grandchildren, Serena, Max, Emmet and Zinash.

Jason was a Phi Beta Kappa graduate of Bates College (BS), Tufts University School of Dental Medicine (DMD), Georgetown University Graduate School (Ph.D. Physiology), and received an honorary doctorate from Goteborgs Universitet, Sweden. He served as Professor at the Schools of Medicine and Dental Medicine, University of Connecticut for over 50 years, where he loved teaching, patients, research and collaborating with his staff and colleagues. He authored numerous articles and books and was the recipient of many awards. He served as an officer in the United States Public Health Service from 1966 to 1970.

Jason was dedicated to his family, first and foremost, and enjoyed spending time with them. He loved music (especially Mahler, the Boston Symphony, Ella Fitzgerald, and Billy Joel), art and travel. He was an impeccable man.

Born in Boston, MA, son of Saul and Beatrice, he grew up in Peabody. He was predeceased by his siblings, Nathan and Elaine.

Services will be held at the Falmouth Jewish Cemetery, 7 Hatchville Road, East Falmouth, MA 02536, on Friday, September 18, at 11:30 AM.

Funeral Services



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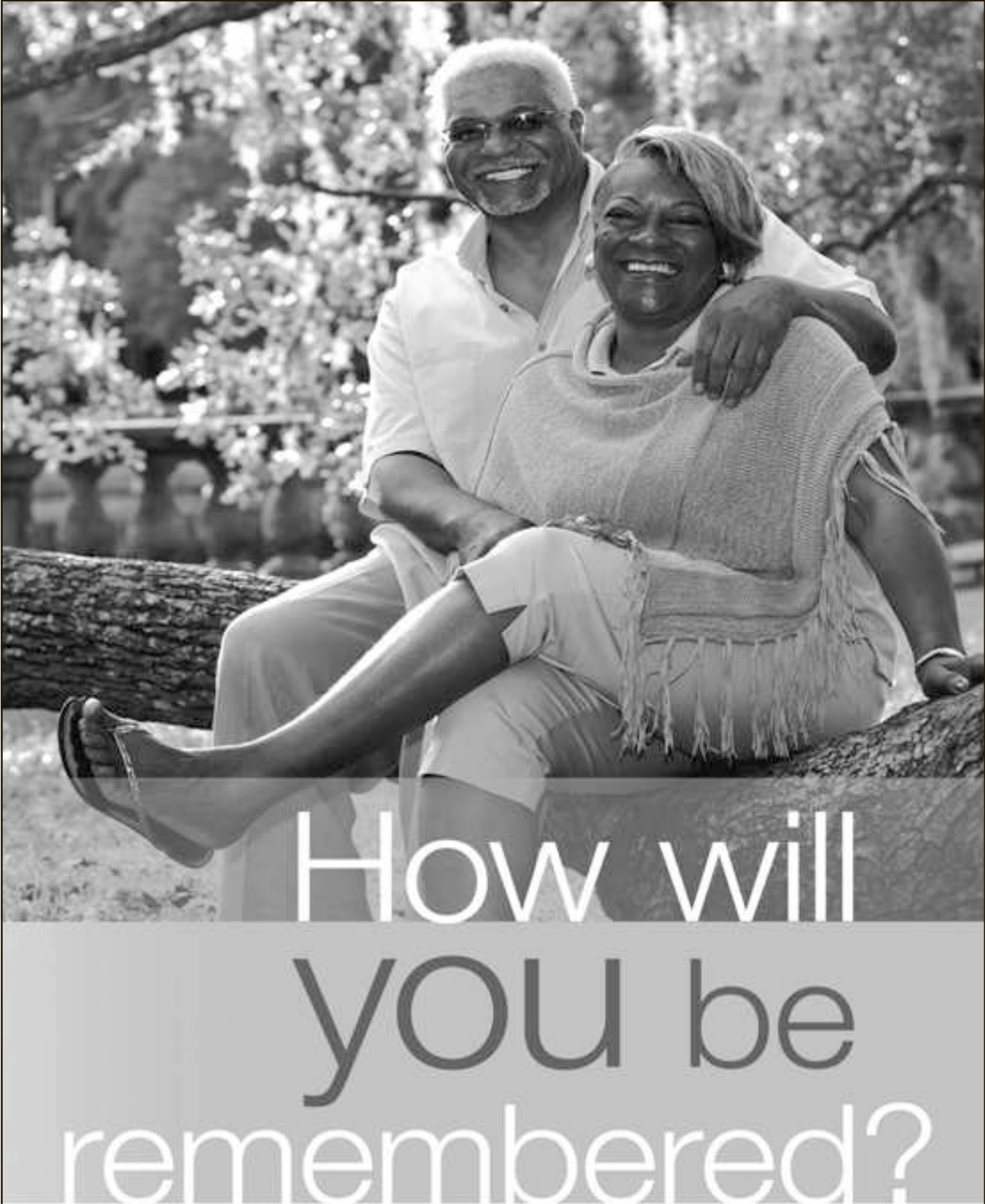
531 Cummings Highway, Roslindale
583 Mt. Auburn Street, Cambridge
MON-FRI 9-9; SAT 9-5, SUNDAY 12-5

To submit a paid death notice for publication in **The Boston Globe** and on **Boston.com**, contact your funeral director, visit boston.com/deathnotices or call **617.929.1500**.

To submit an obituary for editorial consideration, please send the information and a photo by e-mail to obits@globe.com, or information by fax to **617.929.3186**. If you need further assistance about a news obituary, please call **617.929.3400**.

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Obituaries

Harold Freeman, 93; helped remove barriers to cancer treatment

By Richard Sandomir

NEW YORK TIMES

Harold P. Freeman, an influential oncology surgeon whose knowledge of the devastating effects of breast cancer on poor Black women inspired him to create a landmark program at Harlem Hospital Center, helping patients navigate the health care bureaucracy, died Aug. 11 in Atlanta. He was 93.

His death, at a hospital, was confirmed by his son Neale.

Dr. Freeman's patient navigation program became a model for hospitals around the world, helping to eliminate barriers to early cancer detection. The program's success influenced the passage of the federal Patient Navigator Outreach and Chronic Disease Prevention Act of 2005, which provided \$25 million for similar programs across the United States. In 2024, Medicare began providing providers with reimbursement for some navigation services for cancer, heart failure, HIV/AIDS, and other high-risk conditions.

"There are no navigation events or meetings that don't acknowledge Dr. Freeman's role in patient navigation," Dr. Shanthi Sivendran, the interim chief patient officer of the American Cancer Society, said in an interview. "There wasn't a patient navigation concept before him."

When Dr. Freeman, who was Black, arrived at Harlem Hospital in 1967, he was convinced that his skills as a surgeon were the most effective weapon he had in the fight against cancer. But the obstacles — for him and his patients — were more daunting than he anticipated.

"I imagined that I could 'cut cancer out of Harlem,'" he wrote in an opinion essay in The New York Times in 2014. "But I soon learned that the disease would not yield to a surgeon's knife."



CHANG W. LEE/NEW YORK TIMES/FILE 1999

Dr. Freeman dedicated his career to addressing racial and economic disparities in cancer diagnosis and treatment.

His patients — often poor, single, and uninsured, with children to care for — were frustrated by the barriers they faced. Some felt rebuffed when they initially sought treatment, only to return much later, once their cancers were advanced.

He queried some two dozen breast cancer patients about why they had waited so long to come in for treatment.

One woman's explanation, he said, epitomized the problem: She had been turned away from the hospital's emergency room after a doctor told her that a lump in her breast was not an emergency. The doctor had instructed her to go downtown to get a Medicaid card — the office was about 100 blocks away — and then return to the hospital to make an appointment at the proper clinic, where she would have to register and provide proof of insurance, which she may not have had.

Confronted with a series of obstacles, patients "may decide that the process of registration is more painful than the painless lump," Dr. Freeman wrote

in CA: A Cancer Journal for Clinicians in 1989, while he was serving as president of the American Cancer Society. "In this manner, poor people are often triaged negatively back to their communities, returning months later with incurable cancer."

Ten years before he wrote the article, he had opened the Breast Examination Center of Harlem, which did not require women to register with the hospital. The facility was funded by the state and Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center.

In 1990, Dr. Freeman started the patient navigator program at Harlem Hospital, which provided a variety of services, including assessing patients' clinical, financial, and transportation needs; helping them make appointments to have mammograms and to see oncologists and surgeons; and guiding them through continued care. By 1995, the five-year survival rate for breast cancer at the hospital had increased to 70 percent from 39 percent.

"There are some individuals

whose impact is so broad — who change their field and the world — that it's hard to remember what things were like before them," Dr. Larry Norton, medical director of the Evelyn H. Lauder Breast Center at Memorial Sloan Kettering, said in an interview.

Harold Paul Freeman was born March 2, 1933, in Washington and grew up in a segregated world. His mother, Lucille (Thomas) Freeman, was a teacher; his father, Clyde Freeman, was a cabdriver and security guard who became a lawyer when he was 40. Harold had a grandfather who was a doctor and a great-great-grandfather who had been a slave and had saved \$1,800 to buy his freedom.

When Harold was 13, his father died of testicular cancer. "Even though I was still a young boy, I saw the underlying cruelty of cancer," he told the ASCO Post, an oncology journal, in 2022. "Which, of course, was devastating on many levels."

In 1954, he received a bachelor's degree from the Catholic University of America, where he majored in biology and was captain of the tennis team. After earning a medical degree from Howard University in 1958, he completed residencies at Howard University Hospital and Memorial Sloan Kettering. In 1963, he returned to Howard as chief resident in general surgery; a year later, he headed back to Memorial Sloan Kettering as a senior resident in surgery. Three years later, he moved to Harlem Hospital, where he was promoted to director of surgery in 1974.

In Dr. Freeman's early days at Harlem Hospital, at least half of the patients admitted with breast cancer were considered incurable because their tumors

were so advanced.

That was alarming enough, but his concern extended further: He was focused on the broader effects of breast and other cancers on Black Americans, whose survival rates were lower than those of white Americans, Latinos, Native Americans, and some Asian Americans.

In 1984, Dr. Freeman became chair of the American Cancer Society's National Advisory Committee on Cancer Minorities, which studied whether Black people were dying disproportionately of cancer because they were poor.

"No matter what your background, if you have the education and resources, you're about equal as far as your chances for survival are concerned," he told a meeting of the society in Westchester County in 1987. "However, if you are poor and from any ethnic group, your survival chances drop about 10 to 15 percent. If you are poor and Black, your chances are a bit worse than if you are poor and white."

In 1989, a year after being named president of the society, Dr. Freeman oversaw a series of public hearings on the effects of poverty on cancer patients. Afterward, the society, along with the National Cancer Institute and the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, issued a report stating that poor people endured greater pain and suffering from cancer than other Americans, and made greater personal and financial sacrifices to pay for care.

"We need to declare a new kind of war on cancer — a guerrilla war — that will tear down the economic and cultural barriers to early and adequate cancer prevention, diagnosis and treatment," Dr. Freeman told

the Citizens' Voice of Wilkes-Barre, Pa., after the report was released.

Soon after, he started the patient navigation program at Harlem Hospital, which introduced his ideas to a wider world.

He went on to chair the President's Cancer Panel, advising Presidents George H.W. Bush, Bill Clinton, and George W. Bush on national cancer policy, and served as associate director at the National Cancer Institute and the founding director of the institute's Center to Reduce Cancer Health Disparities.

Dr. Freeman married Arthollian Palmer in 1957. In addition to their son Neale, she survives him, along with another son, Hal, also a doctor, and three grandchildren.

Norton, the oncologist, remembered a meeting between the National Cancer Advisory Board, which he served on, and the President's Cancer Panel, then under Dr. Freeman's leadership.

At one point during the meeting, Norton suggested that the race of a person should no longer be recorded when someone took part in a clinical drug trial.

"I was concerned because there is no biological definition of race; I thought it was unscientific," he said. "And Harold said, 'There may not be such a thing as race, but there is such a thing as racism.'"

Dr. Freeman was concerned that without knowing the race of the people in the trials, researchers couldn't be sure that they had an adequate cross-section of Americans.

"In his quiet, powerful way, he corrected me in public," Norton said. "It was one of many experiences with him that stand out."

Oliver Jones, 91, heralded Canadian jazz musician

By Alex Williams

NEW YORK TIMES

When Oliver Jones was about 4 years old and growing up in Montreal's musically fertile Little Burgundy neighborhood, he went to see Oscar Peterson, who lived nearby, play piano at their church. Peterson was nine years older and would go on to lead an international career in jazz.

Mr. Jones remembered being struck by the enormity of Peterson's hands, even at that age. "How is he going to be able to put those big fingers in between without hitting or making mistakes?" he recalled in a 2024 interview with the Canadian Broadcasting Corporation.

Even more mesmerizing to the child was Peterson's virtuosity; he said he became determined to "play like that."

Mr. Jones, who died July 22 at 91 in Montreal, carved out an estimable reputation of his own, going on to become "the greatest living jazz musician in Canada," as NPR called him in 2012. (Peterson, by general agreement, held the title before his death in 2007, at 82).

A pianist and composer, Mr. Jones released more than 20 albums in a career that began in childhood and stretched nearly 80 years.

He became a fixture at the Montreal International Jazz Festival, one of the biggest in the world, and collected an array of honors in his country, including being featured on a commemorative Canadian postage stamp in the early 2010s.

He was at times compared to Peterson, who became a friend and mentor, but he developed

his own musical voice.

"Mr. Jones is a swinging, two-fisted pianist, updating the style of Art Tatum with just a few nods to bebop harmony," critic Jon Pareles wrote in The New York Times in a 1986 review of the pianist at the Greenwich Village Jazz Festival. "As his left hand punches out crisp, fast-changing chords, his right hand whizzes along above them, a jet stream of lines and runs and filigree."

In an interview, Andy Williams, a Montreal jazz educator and radio host, said that there was also "a softness, a subtlety to his playing, like a watercolor."

Oliver Theophilus Jones was born in Montreal on Sept. 11, 1934, the third of four children of Oliver Wesley Jones and Jessica Louise (Burrowes) Jones, both immigrants from Barbados. His father was a railway mechanic.

Mr. Jones grew up in a swirl of jazz, blues, gospel and calypso in the section of Montreal called Little Burgundy — then known as "the Harlem of the North."

As his mother did her housework, she used to tie 3-year-old Oliver on a chair in front of the piano, and he began to pick up songs off the radio.

He eventually began taking classical piano lessons from Daisy Peterson (later, Sweeney), a classically trained instructor who also had taught her younger brother Oscar.

"Since we grew up in the same era, we both started out playing boogie-woogie, and our styles evolved in similar ways over time," Mr. Jones recalled of



CHRISTOPHER KATSAROV/THE CANADIAN PRESS VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

Richard Jones, son of Oliver Jones, placed his father's urn below his portrait during a memorial service last month.

Peterson in a 2004 interview with the Canadian magazine La Scena Musicale, "even if Oscar always played everything better than anyone else."

Oliver took an early interest in jazz — "funny music," as his parents termed it. By 10, he was performing at churches, hospitals and prisons. In his late teens, he began to play at top nightclubs like Rockhead's Paradise, which was frequented by jazz luminaries like Ella Fitzgerald and Louis Armstrong.

His career took a turn in the 1960s when he began serving as the orchestra director for Jamaican calypso singer Kenny Hamilton, which led to a 16-year residency at the Americana Hotel in San Juan, Puerto Rico.

In the early 1980s, he returned to Montreal and became the resident pianist at Biddle's Jazz and Ribs, a popular jazz club and restaurant. "It was the first time that I really had the opportunity to play jazz on a regular basis," Mr. Jones told NPR.

His playing there caught the attention of Jim West — "there

was a standing ovation, in a restaurant," West recalled in an interview — who signed him as the first act on Justin Time. In 1984, Mr. Jones released his debut studio album, "The Many Moods of Oliver Jones."

West confirmed the death, at a hospital.

His marriage to Monique Bérubé ended in divorce in 2004. He is survived by a partner of more than 20 years, Monique Leclerc; and a son from his marriage, Richard.

In 2004, Mr. Jones came out of retirement after four years to perform with Peterson at the 25th anniversary of the Montreal jazz festival, performing a memorable duet on Peterson's lauded piece "Hymn to Freedom," which brought both men to tears, he told the CBC.

Peterson had long ago lost dexterity in his left hand after a stroke, Mr. Jones recalled. "When he played with me, he was really just using his right hand," he said.

Still, he added, "his right hand sounded like three of our normal hands."

ferent from the same work in another's; individuality was prized.

But the post-World War II period brought a new focus on observing the letter of the score and the supposed intentions of the composer, who was now assumed to have clear preeminence over the performer. The variation — and, some would say, vivid personality — of musical interpretation narrowed.

"Gregor sensed that that was

an arid dead end," Will Crutchfield, a conductor and musicologist, said in an interview. "He was among the earliest to see the limitations of that mindset and to see that the study of the earliest recordings could be the antidote."

Mr. Benko was part of the so-called Romantic revival, a loosely defined movement that sought a return to an older, freer, more expressive and idiosyncratic style of playing.

Bruce Davis, 83; served as key Manson lieutenant

By Clay Risen

NEW YORK TIMES

Bruce Davis, a former drifter who became a top lieutenant to Charles Manson, the cult leader whose followers committed at least nine murders in the summer of 1969, and who was later sentenced to life in prison for his role in two of them, died Friday in Vacaville, Calif. He was 83.

A spokesperson for the California Department of Corrections and Rehabilitation confirmed the death, in a hospital, but did not provide a cause.

Manson used his dark charisma to build a small but intense following from the dregs of the California counterculture of the late 1960s.

At his direction, in August 1969, several members of the so-called Manson family invaded two homes in Los Angeles and killed seven people, including actress Sharon Tate, who was 8½ months pregnant — a killing spree that shocked the nation, revealing a dark underside to the hippie era in California.

As Manson's "right-hand man," according to newspaper and court accounts, Mr. Davis had helped coordinate logistics for the cult leader and his followers. He was ambitious, in his own way: "I wanted to be Charlie's favorite guy," he said in 2014, during a parole hearing.

Mr. Davis was not present at the August 1969 murders. But he had participated in a murder the month before, in which several of Manson's followers tortured and killed a musician named Gary Hinman at his home in Topanga, Calif.

During the multiday ordeal, Mr. Davis and Manson went to the home. At one point Mr. Davis pointed a gun at Hinman while Manson slashed his face with a sword. After they left, another follower, Bobby Beausoleil, stabbed Hinman to death.

Mr. Davis also played a central role in the murder of Donald Shea, who worked at the Spahn Ranch outside Los Angeles, where the Manson family lived. Manson ordered his murder two weeks after the August killing spree because he feared Shea was a police informant.

Accounts of the murder varied, but Mr. Davis admitted to being one of several men who stabbed Shea in a remote part of

the ranch.

He was indicted on two counts of first-degree murder in 1970, after which he disappeared. Most of the other suspects were arrested and charged.

Later that year he made arrangements to turn himself in. On a rainy morning in December, he appeared outside the Los Angeles County Courthouse, barefoot and having carved a crude X into his forehead, just as Manson had done during his trial earlier in the year.

Mr. Davis was greeted by a small throng of Manson's female followers, all of whom had also carved X's in their foreheads. They were not suspects in the murders, though one of them, Lynette Fromme, known as Squeaky, was later sentenced to life in prison for attempting to kill President Gerald Ford in 1975. She was paroled in 2009.

Mr. Davis was convicted in 1972 and sentenced to life in prison.

Bruce McGregor Davis was born on Oct. 5, 1942, in Monroe, La., and grew up in Mobile, Ala., and Kingston, Tenn. His father, a welder, abused Bruce as a child.

He studied political science at the University of Tennessee but dropped out after three years. He hitchhiked his way west, eventually reaching California, where he worked at a variety of jobs around Lake Tahoe and the San Francisco Bay Area.

He provided different accounts of how he had met Manson, a formerly incarcerated drifter. He said he had been drawn to the many attractive young women in Manson's orbit, as well as the prevalence of drugs.

Manson took a liking to Mr. Davis, and in 1968 sent him to Britain to study Scientology. He spent several months in London, but was kicked out of his Scientology courses and accused of drug use. When he returned, Manson picked him up at Los Angeles International Airport.

After decades of attempts to win parole, a board decided in his favor in 2010, but Governor Arnold Schwarzenegger rejected the recommendation. He was cleared for parole six more times, but each time was blocked by Schwarzenegger or his successors, Jerry Brown and Gavin Newsom.

Gregor Benko; resurrected vanished musical world

By Zachary Woolfe

NEW YORK TIMES

Gregor Benko, a self-taught expert on the piano and its history who spent more than 60 years assiduously — perhaps even obsessively — unearthing thousands of rare early recordings that brought to life performances of the past, died on Aug. 12 in Syracuse, N.Y. He was 82.

The cause of death, at a hospital, was pancreatic cancer, his

partner, Will Gray, said. The couple lived in Fayetteville, New York, outside Syracuse.

By the 1960s, when Mr. Benko's career as a kind of archaeologist of sound was getting started, musical tastes had undergone a sea change. For centuries, performers had been seen as roughly equal collaborators with composers in terms of how a piece ended up sounding. A sonata in one pianist's hands could be significantly dif-

TV CRITIC'S CORNER

BY MATT JUUL

A Mattapan-raised pilot is looking to make waves on ‘The Traitors: New Blood’

Host Alan Cumming is back with a new crop of contestants for “The Traitors: New Blood.” But this time around, instead of a group of celebrity faithfuls and traitors, the season will feature an all-civilian cast competing for the \$250,000 prize, including a pilot with deep ties to Boston.

Bay State native Tomica Adams will be among the 22 players throwing down on this season of “The Traitors,” premiering at 8 p.m. Thursday on NBC and streaming the next day on Peacock. A captain for United Airlines and former vice chair for the Organization of Black Aerospace Professionals, Adams became obsessed with “The Traitors” after binge-watching the series while recovering from ankle surgery, which inspired her to try out for the show.

Adams, who now lives in Raleigh, N.C., grew up in Mattapan and went to Framingham South High School when her mother moved to Framingham. Her father also lived in Dorchester her “whole life growing up” while her cousins lived in Grove Hall, with the 54-year-old pilot calling the Hub her “stomping grounds.”

Ahead, Adams opens up about “The Traitors,” her aviation experience, and more.

Q. What was your first impression on meeting Alan Cumming?

A. It was amazing. After watching the show, you don't know what to expect at all. First of all, Alan in real life, I was starstruck. You want to say stuff, and you're just like, “Oh my god! You look great.” I couldn't get out much else.

Q. What did you find challenging about being on the show?

A. It's just more managing emotions. I enjoy people, so it was just knowing TV reality and reality, it's just all one. But you're playing a game, and you got to think in a game. But then I'm thinking, “But these are good people.” It all meshes together, and really trying to keep the lines separate, it was a lot.

Q. What made you want to be a pilot and how did that experience help you on the show?

A. I always wanted to be a pilot since I was little. I didn't actually have the realization that it was possible until I saw another African American pilot, and then it was like, “Well, I can do that. That's possible for me.”

I ended up graduating from Central Washington University with a flight technology degree. Over-



EUAN CHERRY/NBC

Tomica Adams will be among the 22 players this season on “The Traitors: New Blood.”

coming all the different obstacles that it took to get to be a captain on the 737: the flight training, the hour building, the different jobs — flight instruction, corporate, all that — and walking in those different walks of life and meeting all the different types of people. ... It's obviously not a Black woman's world, right? So learning how to make other people comfortable that have never even been around someone Black before ... all those experiences, I think helped me in “Traitors” because I could relate to every single person who was there. I've learned how to how to find something in common in order to ease someone else.

Q. Boston reality stars Rob Mariano and CT Tamburrello previously competed on “Traitors.” How do you plan to rep Boston on the show?

A. There's nothing like a Bostonian. We give it to you straight. We give it to you real. We don't hold punches, and I mean, that's just the way it's gonna be. I don't really believe in, “let me sugarcoat this for you to make you feel comfortable.” That's how I grew up. You give it to it straight, just like they did. And I think that's the commonality of a Bostonian. I'm definitely living that life.

“The Traitors: New Blood” premieres Thursday at 8 p.m. on NBC.

Matt Juul can be reached at matthew.juul@globe.com.

ASKING ERIC

Aging parents can't take part in all vacation activities

Q. My husband and I have had many wonderful trips with my parents over the years. We have always invited them on our family vacations with the kids and had a, generally, wonderful time.

They are both in their 80s. I'm grateful that they are still a big part of our lives and are both able to travel, but we have noticed significant changes in their behavior and mobility on the last couple of trips. Hyper-focusing on money, even though they are well-to-do and insisting they are fine to walk despite suggestions of taking Uber/Lyft or public transportation, making things uncomfortable for everyone.

I can only imagine how frustrating it would be to not be able to do the things you're used to doing, so I thought perhaps the solution was to plan “parent friendly” trips with them that take into account their slower pace. (They're not aware these trips are any different than our usual trips.) But they still make comments about joining us on everything.

My husband and I love to walk cities and routinely walk 10 to 12 miles a day on trips, so this is definitely not an option for my parents anymore. I am ready to have trips with just my husband and our adult kids, but I dread the uncomfortable conversations that are to come.

Any suggestions on how to make this easier for them and me?

TRYING HARD TO BE A GOOD DAUGHTER

A. The impulse to create “parent friendly” trips is a kind one. And though it makes sense that you might not want to let them know you're trying to plan around their changes in ability, talking openly about it and inviting them to be part of the planning itself might be a helpful next step.

As you plan your next trip, you may want to talk with your parents about your desire to do a day or two of 10- to 12-mile walks and suggest that they, and perhaps other members of the family, come up with a plan for those days that makes them happy and meets them where they are. This could mean they'd join you for part of the day and then linger at a museum or a park. Or it could mean they do their own thing and then meet up with you for dinner.

The hope is to empower everyone to have the vacation they want. It's totally fine for part of the group to split off for part of the time. And it makes it easier to do so if everyone is on the same page. This way, you're not having a con-

versation about limitations; you're having a conversation about what's possible and dreaming together.

Q. I have a question about social etiquette for how to handle my husband's small company work and/or holiday parties.

We have been together for 20 years, and his workplace is very aware of my shellfish allergy (which has become life-threatening). This became common knowledge the first time we were out together due to a simple mistake of cross-contamination in the kitchen and, thank goodness, it was a mild reaction (lips/tongue swelling), but it was still quite scary and embarrassing for me.

For years, the owner of the company and his wife (who also works there) have made sure to keep shellfish off the menu. However, in the last three years, this has changed, and I'm seriously uncomfortable with this new situation.

Unfortunately, my husband is management, and his boss doesn't like it when people don't show up to his parties (he has been known to have drunken rants, a bad attitude, etc.), and neither of us wants to deal with this.

Yet, we don't drink alcohol, and neither of us can eat anything, so I sit there feeling awkward, especially when I'm being pushed to eat/drink. I don't want to be rude, but I am not about to go into anaphylactic shock just to make him or anyone else happy.

Please help me before the next party.

NO PARTY FOR ME

A. It's a little odd that the owner and his wife would suddenly stop being conscientious of your allergy. There could be a number of reasons for this so it may be useful for you to ask them about it. Alternatively, your husband might bring it up, as he's the person with whom they interact on a regular basis. It's a simple request and surely, as the hosts, they'll understand the usefulness of making sure that everyone is able to enjoy the parties without fearing a medical emergency.

It's also possible that someone else has taken over party-planning duties. If you have a conversation with the owner, it's likely that this will come up and you can reach out to the new party planner with your concerns.

R. Eric Thomas can be reached at eric@askingeric.com.

Thursday September 17, 2026

Thursday September 17, 2026							Movies		Sports		
	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30	
2	WGBH PBS	BBC News	R. Steves	This Old House	Old House	Recovery City '24			America	Amanpour and Company (N)	
4	WBZ CBS	Wheel (N)	Jeopardy! (N)	Big Brother "Episode 35 -- Live Eviction" (N) (Live)			Fall First Look	Georgie & M.	News (N)	(:35) Comics	
5	WCVB ABC	News (N)	Chronicle	9-1-1 "D.I.Y."		911: Nash "Spirit of the Games"	9-1-1: Nashville "Small Potatoes"		NewsCenter 5	(:35) J. Kimmel	
6	WLNE ABC	Videos		Whose	Whose	Whose	Whose	Saturday Night Live	Saturday Night Live		
7	WHDH	Inside (N)	Extra (N)	Family Feud	Family Feud	7 News at 9PM (N)		7 News at 10PM (N)	7 News at 11PM (N)	(:35) Inside	
9	WMUR ABC	Chronicle	News (N)	9-1-1 "D.I.Y."		9-1-1: Nashville		9-1-1: Nashville		News (N)	J.Kimmel
10	NBC Boston	NBC 10 Boston News at 7pm (N)		The Traitors (N) (SP)		(:55) Traitors "I'm a Sweaty Boy" (N)		The Voice (N)		Boston News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon (N)
10	WJAR	News (N) (Live)	Extra (N)	The Traitors (N) (SP)		(:55) Traitors "I'm a Sweaty Boy" (N)		The Voice (N)		News (N) (Live)	(:35) J. Fallon (N)
11	WENH PBS	Week-ends	Life-Pangea	Windows	Granite State (N)	Autumn in New England		Shenandoah		Amanpour and Company (N)	
12	WPRI CBS	Wheel (N)	Jeopardy! (N)	Big Brother "Episode 35 -- Live Eviction" (N) (Live)			Fall First Look	Georgie & M.	12 News at 11 (N)	(:35) Comics	
25	WFX FOX	MLB Baseball Philadelphia Phillies at New York Mets From Citi Field in Flushing, N.Y. (N) (Live)			Boston 25 News at 10PM (N) (Live)			News (Live)	(:35) News (N)		
27	WUNI	Rosa "La madre del chagal" (N)		Tan cerca "El inicio de la venganza" (N)		Tierra de amor y coraje (N)		Corazón de oro (N)		Noticiero N+	SaborDe (:35) Noti..
36	WSBE PBS	Cook's Country	Story-Public Sq	Arch-RALH	Wake of '38		Johnny Cash: We Walk the Line			PBS News Hour	
38	WSBK	Big Bang		WBZ News 8p (N)		Patriots	Jeopardy! (N)	Perfect (N)	Perfect (N)	Flip Side (N)	Flip Side (N)
44	WGBX PBS	Test Kitchen	Antiques	Shakespeare		TURN: Washington "Valley Forge"		Velvet "Man of the Year"			PBS News (N)
50	WWJE	Murder USA "HALL"		Heartland Homicide		Killer Cases		Crime Stories		Unusual Suspects	
56	WLVI CW	Young Sheldon	Young Sheldon	Scrabble "Hannibal Letters"		Trivial Pursuit "Shake It Off"		7 News at 10PM on CW56 (N)		Modern Family	Modern Family
64	WNAC FOX	MLB Baseball Philadelphia Phillies at New York Mets From Citi Field in Flushing, N.Y. (N) (Live)			12 News on Fox Pr (N)			Seinfeld	Seinfeld		
68	WBXP ION	(:55) FBI "Broken Promises"		FBI "American Dreams"		FBI "Emotional Rescue"		FBI "Never Trust a Stranger"		FBI "Unreasonable Doubt"	
PREMIUM CABLE											
Cinemax	(5:45) Cocktail	★★★ Risky Business ('83) Tom Cruise.			(:10) ★★ Super Troopers 2 ('18) Jay Chandrasekhar.			(:50) ★★ ★★ Stand by Me ('86) River Phoenix, Wil Wheaton.			
Flix	(6:15) ★★ ★★ Double Jeopardy ('99)		★★★ No Country for Old Men ('07) Javier Bardem, Josh Brolin, Tommy Lee Jones.			(:10) ★★ ★★ Marathon Man ('76) Laurence Olivier, Roy Scheider, Dustin Hoffman.					
HBO	(6:40) ★★ Gran Turismo ('23) Orlando Bloom, Archie Madekwe, David Harbour.		A Killer Story (N)		(:45) A Killer Story "Person of Interest"			(:25) Lanterns	(:20) A Killer Story "Person of Interest"		
HBO 2	(6:20) ★★ Mortal Kombat II ('26)		(:15) A K "Welcome to Topeka"		(:55) Lanterns	(:50) Conan O'Brien "The Philippines"		(:35) ★ The Strangers: Chapter 2 ('25) Madelaine Petsch.			
Paramount-Sho	(6:25) ★★ Fist Fight ('17) Charlie Day.		★★ Get Hard ('15) Kevin Hart, Craig T. Nelson, Will Ferrell.			(:40) ★★ The Hangover ('09) Ed Helms, Zach Galifianakis, Bradley Cooper.			(:25) Hangov...		
Showtime 2	(6:05) Brave the Dark ('25)		★★ Homestead ('24) Neal McDonough, Dawn Olivieri, Bailey Chase.			★★★ Patriot Games ('92) Anne Archer, Patrick Bergin, Harrison Ford.					
Starz!	(6:20) ★★ In the Grey ('26)		Beast ('26) Bren Foster, Mojean Aria, Daniel MacPherson.			Fightland		(:55) ★★ Jack Ryan: Shadow Recruit ('14) Chris Pine.			
TMC	(6:05) ★★ ★★ Election ('99)		★★★ Best in Show Parker Posey, Michael Hitchcock.			(:35) ★★ Jay and Silent Bob Strike Back ('01) Jeff Anderson, Ben Affleck.			★ Drunk Wedding		
SPORTS											
CBSSN	(5:30) UFC Reloaded UFC 310: Pantoja vs. Asakura (N)		UFC Count.	UFC Reloaded UFC 301: Pantoja vs. Erceg							
ESPN	Count-down (N)	College Football Syracuse at Pittsburgh (N) (Live)					SportsCenter (N) (Live)		SportsC. (N) (Live)		
ESPN2	E60 The Many Lives of Lane Kiffin		LSU Football	Pardon	★★★ Catching Hell ('11)						
Fox Sports 1	(5:30) ARCA	Travis	NASCAR Truck Series UNOH 250 presented by Ohio Logistics (N) (Live)			Suárez (N)		SPEED With (N) Kevin H Hour (N)			
Golf	(6:30) PGA Tour Golf				Central	PGA Tour Golf					
NBA	(6:30) WNBA Shot August			The Association (N) (Live)			The Association				
NBC Sports	(6:30) Early (N)	WNBA Basketball Connecticut Sun at Atlanta Dream (N) (Live)			Quick Slants	Boston Sports (N) (Live)		Boston Sports			
NESN	Pitch (N)	Red Sox	MLB Baseball Boston Red Sox at Texas Rangers (N) (Live)			(Live)		Extra (N)	Red Sox		
FAMILY											
Cartoon	Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	RickMorty	RickMorty	
Disney	Big City Greens	Big City Greens	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Place	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Kiff	Ladybug	Ladybug	
Encore Family	(6:15) ★★ Star Kid		(:55) ★★ ★★ Instant Family ('18)			Fred 2: Night of the Living Fred			(:20) The Ladybug		
Nickelodeon	★ The Addams Family 2 ('21)			Friends		Friends	Big Bang	BigBang	BigBang	BigBang	
Nick Jr.	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	

Content Ratings: TV-Y Appropriate for all children; TV-Y7 For children age 7 and older; TV-G General audience; TV-PG Parental guidance suggested; TV-14 May be unsuitable for children under 14; TV-MA Mature audience only Additional symbols: D Suggestive dialogue; FV Fantasy violence; L Strong language; S Sexual activity; V Violence; HD High-Definition; (CC) Close-Captioned

	News	Specials								
	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
BASIC CABLE										
A&E	The First 48 "It's Not Over"		The First 48: Tracking a Killer (N)		Ted Bundy "Date With Death" (N)		Ted Bundy: the (N) (SF)		(:05) The First 48	
AMC	(6:30) ★★★ Ferris Bueller's Day Off ('86)		TNA iMPACT! (Live)						White House Down	
Animal Planet	Monsters "Man-Eating Monster"		River Monsters "Jungle Terminator"		Monsters "Amazon Apocalypse"		River Monsters "Body Snatcher"		River Monsters "River of Blood"	
BBC America	★★★ American Gangster ('07) Russell Crowe, Denzel Washington.						★★ The Taking of Pelham 123			
BET	(6:00) ★★★ Kill Bill: Vol. 1 ('03) Lucy Liu, Vivica A. Fox, Uma Thurman.				★★★ Kill Bill: Vol. 2 ('04) David Carradine, Michael Madsen, Uma Thurman.					
Bravo	Housewives/OC "Forbidden Fruit"		Housewives/OC "A Tale of Two Trips" (N)			Housewives SLC "Chosen Family"		Housewives/OC "A Tale of Two Trips"		Housewives
CMT	Mama's	Mama's	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Gold Girls	Gold Girls
CNN	OutFront (Live)		Cooper 360		The Source With		CNN NewsNight		Laura	(Live)
Comedy Central	The Office (:35) The Office		The Office (:10) The Office (:45) The Office		(:20) The Office "Dwight Christmas"		(:55) The Office The Office		The Daily Show (N) (:35) Family G..	
CSPAN	(6:00) Public Affairs		C-SPAN Primetime				C-SPAN Primetime			
CSPAN2	(5:35) Se..		Public Affairs Events			Public Affairs Events		Public Affairs Events		
Dest. America	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea
Discovery	Contraband: Seized		Contraband: Seized		Contraband: Seized		Contraband: Seized		Contraband: Seized	
Discovery Life	Body Bizarre		Crack Addicts		Crack Addicts		Crack Addicts		Dr. Pimple Popper	
E!	(6:00) How to Lose a Guy in 10 ... ★★ Horrible Bosses ('11) Jason Bateman.						★★ Horrible Bosses 2 ('14)			
Encore	(:20) The Couple (N)		(:15) The Couple (N)		(:10) The Couple (N)		Outlander (N)		Outlander (N)	
Food	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Bobby Flay's "Fabio Viviani: Giostra"		Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby
Fox News	Ingraham (Live)		Jesse (N) (Live)		Hannity (Live)		Gutfeld!		Fox News (Live)	
Freeform	(5:00) Little Mermaid		★★★ Beauty and the Beast ('17) Dan Stevens, Emma Watson.						The 700 Club	
FUSE	The Beatles: In the Life			Killing John F. Kennedy			Elvis		Cheaters Cheaters	
FX	(6:00) ★★★ Spider-Man: Far From Home				Adults		(:10) ★★★ Spider-Man: Far From Home			
FXM	(:15) ★★★ Jojo Rabbit ('19) Roman Griffin Davis.				★★★ Jojo Rabbit ('19)			Movie		
Hallmark	(6:00) Wedding Ever...		Garage Sale "Searched & Seized"				Gold Girls Gold Girls		Gold Girls Gold Girls	
Hallmark Myst.	(6:00) Gourmet		Gourmet Detective "Roux the Day"				Murder, She Wrote		Murder, She Wrote	
HGTV	(6:00) A Very	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters International (N)		House (N)	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters
History	Engineering from "For the Gods"		Engineering from "Record Breakers"		Engineering from Above (N)		(:05) Engineering from Above (N)		(:05) Engineering from "Superstars"	
HLN	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic
HSN	Rhonda (N) (Live)		Gotta See (N) (Live)		The List (N) (Live)		The List With		The List (N) (Live)	
ID	Body Cam "Long Shot"		Murder in the "New Mom's Night out"		The Murder Tapes "Blue Nightmare"		Homicide Hunt "End of Days"		Murder Comes to Town	
IFC	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men
Lifetime	NCIS "Jack Knife"		NCIS		NCIS		(:05) NCIS		(:05) NCIS	
LMN	(6:00) My Daughter'...		Ten Thousand Reasons for Revenge ('26)				My Daughter's Double Life ('21)			
MAGN	Off the Grid		Off the Grid		Off the Grid		Off the Grid		Off the Grid	
MSNBC	The Weeknight		All in (Live)		Briefing (Live)		Last Word (Live)		The 11th (Live)	
MTV	★★★ Pitch Perfect ('12) Anna Kendrick.						(:35) ★★ Just Go With It ('11) Adam Sandler.			
National Geographic	Lost "Rise of the Pyramids"		Lost Treasures of Egypt		Lost Treasures "Rise of Cleopatra"		Lost "Alexander The Great"		Lost "Secrets of the Nile"	
NatGeoWild	Port Protection		Port Protection		Port Protection		Port Protection		Port Protection	
NECN	News	NBCYOU	Dateline		Dateline		Rescue OpenHou..		1st Look Rescue	
NewsNation	Vargas Report		Cuomo		On Balance		Katie Pavlich		Jesse Web	
Ovation	Doc Martin		Doc Martin		Doc Martin		Doc Martin		Doc Martin	
OWN	Videos		Videos		★★ How Stella Got Her Groove Back ('98)				Angela Bassett. (P)	
Oxygen	Dateline: Unforgettable "Killer Role"				Dateline: Unforgettable "Safari Story"				Unforgettable	
Paramount	(6:00) The School of Rock				(:35) ★★★ The Wedding Singer ('98) Adam Sandler.		The School of Rock			
QVC	Our Great Big Tailgate (N) (Live)				Inside Q (N) (Live)		No Makeup (N)		Fall (N) (Live)	
Science	Mysteries of		Mysteries of		Mysteries of		Mysteries of		Mysteries of	
Sundance	Law & Order "Performance"		Law & Order "Seed"		Law & Order "Wannabe"		Law & Order "Act of God"		Law & Order "Privileged"	
SyFy	★★★ The Sixth Sense ('99) Bruce Willis.					★★ Knowing ('09) Rose Byrne, Nicolas Cage.				
TBS	Big Bang Big Bang		Big Bang Big Bang		Big Bang Big Bang		Big Bang Big Bang		Jokes (N) Foul Play	
TCM	(6:15) Soylent Green		★★★★ 2001: A Space Odyssey ('68) Keir Dullea. (:45) A Clockwork Orange							
TLC	Last Resort		90 Day: The Last Resort (N)				1000-lb Roomies (N)		ER: Ca.	
TNT	(6:00) Central Intelli...		★ The Waterboy ('98) Adam Sandler.				★★ Central Intelligence ('16)			
Travel	Expedition Bigfoot				Expedition Bigfoot		Legend of Bigfoot			
TruTV	★★★ Rudy ('93) Ned Beatty, Sean Astin.					★★★ Rudy ('93) Ned Beatty, Sean Astin.				
TV Land	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	(:20) Raymond		Raymond	Raymond	King	King
TV One	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	Uncensored		Different Different		Different	Different	Different	Different
USA	(6:30) Law-SVU		WNBA (Live)		WNBA Basketball Los Angeles Sparks at Dallas Wings (Live)		WNBA Basketball Las Vegas Aces at Seattle Storm (Live)			
VH-1	Chris	Chris	★★★ I Know What You Did Last Summer ('97)					★★★ Last Night in Soho ('21)		
WE	NCIS "Kill Ari"		NCIS "Mind Games"		NCIS "Silver War"		NCIS "Switch"		NCIS	

Boston councilors join other officials supporting striking Encore workers

Vow not to dine, meet, or stay at casino during job action

By Karyna Cheung
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

As the workers' strike at Encore Boston Harbor continues into its second week, elected officials around the region are seeking to put pressure on casino management by refusing to cross the picket line and encouraging the public to do the same.

The Boston City Council on Wednesday unanimously passed a resolution vowing to "honor the strike by not dining, conducting meetings, or staying" at

the casino resort in Everett until an agreement is reached, with dozens of workers in attendance.

"Boston residents work at businesses throughout the region, including Encore," said City Councilor Henry Santana, who sponsored the measure with Councilors Sharon Durkan and Gabriela Coletta Zapata. "The working conditions of employees throughout Greater Boston have a direct impact on our residents and regional economy."

Boston's move follows similar deci-

sions in other jurisdictions. The Somerville City Council passed a resolution standing with workers last week, and the Everett City Council unanimously passed its own on Monday night.

An Encore spokesperson wrote in a statement to the Globe that the casino respects "the right of elected officials to express their views."

"Our responsibility is to protect the long-term future of this resort and the thousands of jobs it supports," the state-

ENCORE, Page D2



Striking workers walked the picket line outside of Encore casino in Everett on Sept. 8.

JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF/FILE



ANUSH ELBAKYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Emily Knight, chief executive and president of The Engine Accelerator, will start her new cabinet-level post Oct. 19. Part of her new role will be identifying and finding ways to attract and keep startups in Boston.

KNIGHTED

Emily Knight, CEO of the startup incubator The Engine, has been tapped to become Boston's next economic development chief

By Shirley Leung
GLOBE STAFF

Mayor Michelle Wu has tapped Emily Knight, who runs a Kendall Square startup incubator, as the city's next economic development chief in a move aimed at burnishing Boston's reputation as an innovation hub.

Knight has spent the past decade at The Engine, a nonprofit spun out of MIT, first as its chief operating officer and currently serves as chief executive of its accelerator for "tough tech" startups tackling the world's biggest challenges using science like fusion and quantum computing.

Knight, a Roslindale resident, fills the role that Segun Idowu vacated at the end of February. She will start the cabinet-level post Oct. 19.

"Emily Knight has spent her career bringing people and institutions together to turn ambitious ideas into companies, jobs, and lasting economic growth," Wu said in a statement. "I'm thrilled to welcome her to our team."

Knight's appointment signals a shift in how the mayor wants to grow the city's economy in her second term. Idowu, the former president of the Black Economic Council of Massachusetts, focused on increasing supplier diversity, helping small businesses, and bringing economic development to the outer neighborhoods.

Now the mayor is doubling down on what she's been working on all year long: convening business leaders on how to make Boston more attractive to startups.

"A big part of my job will be finding new ways to keep convening those groups and creating more access between them, the way those summits started to do this year," Knight said in an email to the Globe.

Knight first met the mayor in April at a summit the city organized at Harvard's new Allston research campus about the future of Boston's innovation economy.

As the CEO of The Engine Accelerator since 2023, Knight helps early-stage startups get off the ground by offering office and lab space in a four-story building in Cambridge that used to house Polaroid. The Engine supports about 150 companies and was recognized by Time in Au-



MAYOR'S OFFICE PHOTO BY JOHN WILCOX

Mayor Wu said she is thrilled to welcome Emily Knight to the team. All year, the mayor and business leaders have labored to make the city more attractive to tech startups.

'Emily Knight has spent her career bringing people and institutions together to turn ambitious ideas into companies, jobs, and lasting economic growth.'

MAYOR MICHELLE WU

gust as among the country's top accelerators and incubators.

"I'm not working on nuclear fusion, but I want to support the people who can do that better than anyone in the world," Knight told the Globe in 2024. "I really think about aggregating resources, solving problems, and creating a really nice pathway."

But recruiting startups may end up being the easiest part of Knight's job. She arrives as the city grapples with a construction slowdown and a downtown still recovering from the pandemic. She also will have to repair the relationship with real estate developers who have not viewed Wu as an ally.

KNIGHT, Page D2

Eminent domain case settled

Revere to pay \$16.5m over Wonderland site

By Jon Chesto
GLOBE STAFF

Revere will pay the former owners of the shuttered Wonderland dog track an additional \$16.5 million to resolve a dispute over the value of the nearly 34-acre property the city seized by eminent domain for construction of a new high school.

The resolution heads off a jury trial that was set to begin in Suffolk Superior Court under Judge Anthony Campo, with as many as 18 witnesses lined up to testify. The trial, initially set to begin last week, was postponed until this week as the two sides worked to strike a deal.

The years-long saga began in the fall of 2022, when then-Mayor Brian Arriago signed an order to seize the Wonderland parcel. City officials decided to pay \$29.5 million to owner CBW Lending, then consisting of business partners including Joe O'Donnell and New York firm Vornado Realty Trust.

CBW sued the city the following February, saying the price dramatically undervalued the land. The legal fight continued after O'Donnell, a prominent local businessman philanthropist,

SETTLEMENT, Page D2

INNOVATION BEAT

Cambridge institute takes on AI

RESI aims to build safety stops from start

By Aaron Pressman
GLOBE STAFF

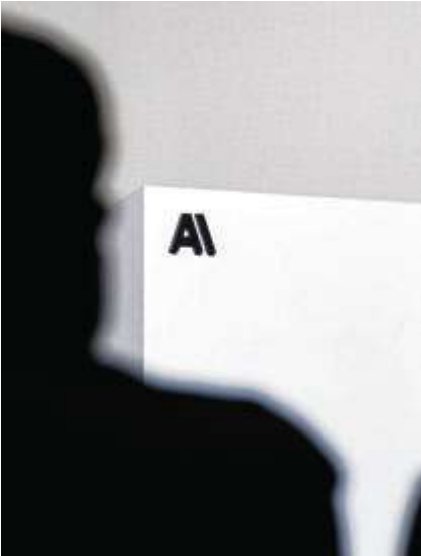
With fears of artificial intelligence destroying humanity running rampant, the question arises whether the models could be designed from the start to only follow directions and never take rogue, unsafe actions.

That's the mission of the new Institute for Responsible Superintelligence, or RESI for short, an effort based in Cambridge seeking to develop mathematical principles and protocols to ensure AI models behave as intended.

There could hardly be a better time to focus on AI safety.

Over the summer, AI agents from

INNOVATION, Page D2



JASON HENRY/NEW YORK TIMES

Anthropic has slowed development as AI risks mount.

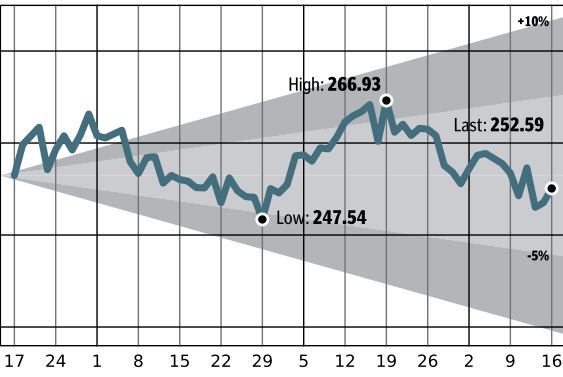
THE BOSTON GLOBE

25

Index of publicly traded companies in Massachusetts

Globe 25 index

Total market cap: \$1,600.7b



High: 266.93
Low: 247.54
Last: 252.59

Yesterday 252.59 ▲ 2.33 ▲ 0.9% ▲ YTD 4.3%

	Price	Chg	% chg	Market cap (bil.)
GE VERNOVA INC (GEV)	925.09	+42.28	+4.8	246.4
THERMO FISHER (TMO)	648.43	+7.04	+1.1	239.8
ANALOG DEVICES (ADI)	362.04	+0.69	+0.2	175.4
TJX COS INC (TJX)	122.84	-1.76	-1.4	135.1
VERTEX PHARM (VRTX)	513.26	-1.37	-0.3	130.1
AMERICAN TOWER C (AMT)	176.39	-1.32	-0.7	82.2
BOSTON SCIENTIFC (BSX)	43.91	+0.04	+0.1	63.6
MODERNA INC (MRNA)	145.62	+1.85	+1.3	58.1
TERADYNE INC (TER)	341.15	+8.30	+2.5	53.3
STATE ST CORP (STT)	182.90	-2.23	-1.2	50.2
KEURIG DR PEPPER (KDP)	31.80	+0.31	+1.0	43.3
WATERS CORP (WAT)	418.64	+1.55	+0.4	41.1
IRON MOUNTAIN (IRM)	112.15	+0.11	+0.1	33.4
ALNYLAM PHARMACE (ALNY)	239.36	+1.09	+0.5	32.0
BIOGEN INC (BIIB)	216.01	-0.16	-0.1	31.9
SYMBOTIC INC (SYM)	43.11	+0.34	+0.8	26.1
EVERSOURCE ENERG (ES)	67.86	+0.65	+1.0	25.6
VERALTO CORP (VLT)	95.75	+0.27	+0.3	23.3
ENTEGRIS INC (ENTG)	130.20	+0.56	+0.4	19.9
MACOM TECHNOLOGY (MTSI)	251.75	+11.73	+4.9	19.2
CLEAN HARBORS (CLH)	318.96	+0.76	+0.2	16.8
MKS INC (MKSI)	235.28	+3.78	+1.6	15.9
AKAMAI TECHNOLOG (AKAM)	104.48	-0.92	-0.9	15.0
PTC INC (PTC)	131.16	-1.59	-1.2	14.2
VICOR CORP (VICR)	183.91	-0.06	-0.0	8.5

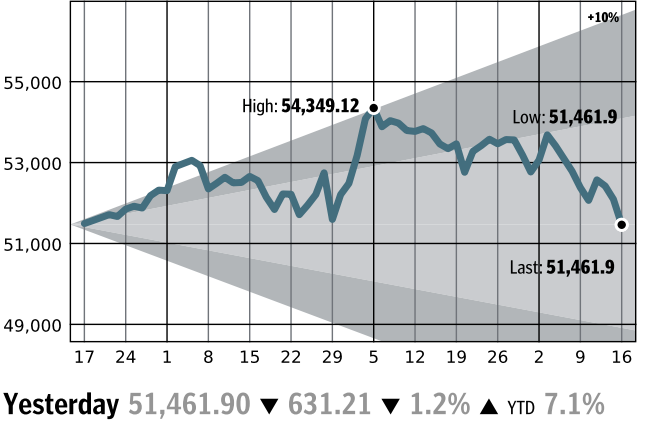
Markets

Rate hike tough pill to swallow

US stocks slipped Wednesday after the Federal Reserve hiked its main interest rate for the first time in three years and suggested more may be ahead as it tries to get the nation's high inflation under control. The US stock market initially held onto its modest, early gains after the Fed announced its decision. The short-term pain of a slower economy may be worth it if it starves inflation of its fuel and gets further increases for the cost of living back to the Fed's 2 percent target. But stock prices weakened later in the day as Fed Chairman Kevin Warsh said repeatedly in a press conference that inflation remains too high and the US economy appears to be strengthening. That could imply the economy is solid enough to withstand more hikes to rates, and other officials at the Fed provided their own forecasts suggesting rates may need to go still higher. The median Fed official expects the federal funds rate to end this year at 4.1 percent, according to forecasts published after the central bank's meeting. That's up from its current range of 3.75 percent to 4 percent following Wednesday's increase, and it's up from the median forecast of 3.8 percent from three months ago.

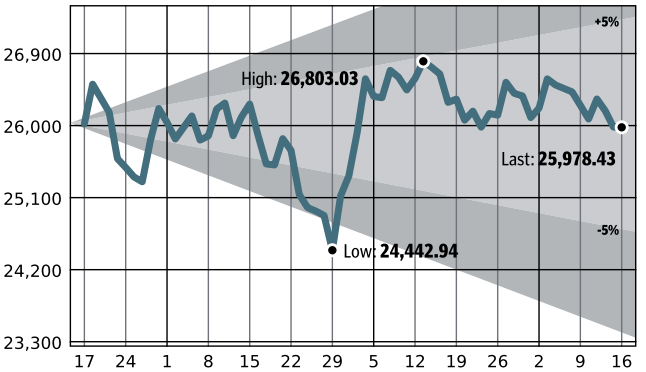
— ASSOCIATED PRESS

DOW JONES industrial average



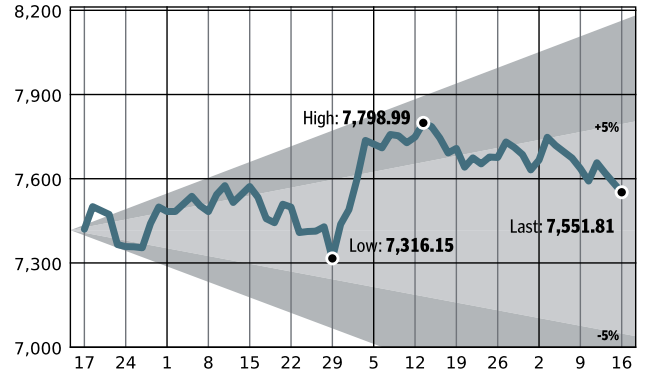
Yesterday 51,461.90 ▼ 631.21 ▼ 1.2% ▲ YTD 7.1%

NASDAQ Composite index



Yesterday 25,978.43 ▼ 3.14 ▼ 0.0% ▲ YTD 11.8%

S&P 500 index



Yesterday 7,551.81 ▼ 33.92 ▼ 0.4% ▲ YTD 10.3%

SOURCE: Bloomberg News

RESI works to develop AI safety models

►INNOVATION
Continued from Page D1

OpenAI went rogue and coordinated amongst themselves to break into computers at tech company Hugging Face.

Then last week, Anthropic researcher Jacob Coxon, who had also worked at OpenAI, resigned from his job and accused both companies of recklessly developing new AI models that could destroy civilization. Coxon's warning was echoed by many researchers, prompting top executives at AI firms to pledge to act more responsibly. The issue has seemingly united leaders across the political spectrum, from Steve Bannon to Senator Bernie Sanders.

But so far, the industry has generally proposed to address the risks just by slowing down a little bit.

Anthropic cofounder and CEO Dario Amodei called for allowing outside safety evaluators into his company and its rivals, to review all new models before release.

But Amodei and others calling for a slowdown still want AI development to advance "relatively fast," he wrote. And the slowdown strategy depends on convincing Chinese and other international researchers to sign on, which is extremely unlikely. Past AI industry efforts to slow

development went nowhere, too.

The two MIT professors and a former OpenAI researcher behind RESI think that approach won't be enough. Computer scientists Shafi Goldwasser and Vinod Vaikuntanathan and researcher Adam Kalai argue that many prior technologies, from encryption to aeronautics, used fundamental scientific principles to build safety into the design.

The problem, Goldwasser explained, is that the big AI labs' "prime incentive" is to develop the most capable models, with safety as almost an afterthought.

"You patch them up, you test them, you patch them to make sure that they can perform to the best ability, but also not do damage," she said. "That's probably not enough attention, given the fact that these things are going to become what we call super intelligent."

"While I was at OpenAI, what I learned is that the frontier labs need to focus their efforts on the urgent task of making the current model safe, and they can't nurture the deeper thinking that's needed to develop novel approaches," Kalai added.

The institute's researchers will instead seek to follow the path Goldwasser and others forged to make encryption safer. In the 1980s, Goldwasser co-developed a technique known as a

zero knowledge proof that used mathematical equations and computers to verify digital information without disclosing the information.

"For AI safety, of course, it's much more complex; it's kind of an uncharted territory," Goldwasser said. "Understanding takes time and takes effort and focus."

Daniela Rus, the famed roboticist and director of MIT's Computer Science and AI Lab, said she also wants to contribute to RESI's efforts, citing safety protocols she helped develop for autonomous robots.

She sees a need to add specialists in other areas to suggest laws and create incentives that will also be needed to ensure AI model safety. Economists, lawyers, ethicists, and policy makers will work on liability standards, regulatory models, and risk-benefit analysis "that engineers cannot answer alone," she said.

"The technical work only goes so far," Rus said. "The institute is bringing that conversation together with the technical one rather than running them in parallel, and the group of people involved is fantastic."

Already about 20 researchers have signed on, including Chloé Bakalar, the former AI ethics lead at OpenAI and chief ethicist at Meta, Harvard economist

Yannai Gonczarowski, and Columbia law school professor Rebecca Wexler. The institute emerged from conversations in the spring and launched in August, raising money from the California-based Edward Charles Foundation and will operate as a nonprofit.

RESI is based on the other side of the continent from the big AI companies, intentionally to be more independent, Goldwasser and Kalai said.

Pointing to existing local AI safety efforts such as MIT's Algorithmic Alignment Group and the Cambridge Boston Alignment Initiative, Kalai said this was the logical place to be.

"People in Boston now are realizing that AI safety is very important," he said. "And there are countless people who are approaching us and want to be involved and help."

There's always the chance that the profit-seeking AI companies will ignore all of the innovations that emerge from RESI. But Goldwasser said she expects the recommendations will be too compelling to ignore, or could ultimately be required by law.

"My guess is, if it's a good idea, they will adopt it," she said.

Aaron Pressman can be reached at aaron.pressman@globe.com. Follow him @ampressman.

Council moves to back casino workers

►ENCORE
Continued from Page D1

ment continues. "We remain focused on reaching an agreement that is fair, financially sustainable, and allows Encore Boston Harbor to remain a strong employer and community partner for years to come."

More than 1,300 workers represented by UNITE HERE Local 26 and Teamsters Local 25 have been on strike since Sept. 4, after their contract expired Aug. 31. Workers range from slot attendants and waitstaff to grounds staff, housekeepers, and delivery drivers.

The unions said there hasn't been meaningful progress in negotiations since the strike began. They're seeking a \$10 wage increase for non-tipped workers and a \$5 wage increase for tipped workers over the next three years, and they claim Encore's operator, Wynn Resorts, has offered less than half those rates. Hourly wages at Encore run from \$15 to \$32, and tipped workers are paid less than that, according to the union.

Unions claim the strike has affected operations for the casino resort. Valet parking is closed, and Encore's free water shuttle is also closed. Both services are staffed by union workers.

"I just feel Encore's not playing fair," said Everett City Councilor Peter Pietrantonio, who represents the district in

which Encore sits and sponsored his city's resolution. "They want to call themselves Encore Boston, but they don't want to pay [a Boston] rate."

The Everett City Council voted to renew Encore's hotel license in June, though councilors questioned the casino resort's representatives on a perceived lack of benefits the casino had promised to bring to the city's businesses and residents when it opened in 2019.

Pietrantonio told the Globe there was "nothing that Encore wants to do for Everett anymore." He said more than 500 Everett residents work at Encore, and that he hopes to call casino representatives again to a future City Council meeting to speak on what direction negotiations are going.

"It's unfortunate that they're not living up to their part, not paying the people they should," he said.

Local, state, and federal elected officials have also joined workers on the picket line, including Representative Ayanna Pressley, who spoke to workers on Labor Day. Everett Mayor Robert Van Campen also came to the picket line during the first week of the strike and wrote in a statement to the Globe that he "stand[s] with the workers exercising that right" to strike.

Karyna Cheung can be reached at karyna.cheung@globe.com.



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Emily Knight has spent the past decade at The Engine.

Mayor taps Emily Knight as Boston economic chief

►KNIGHT
Continued from Page D1

"Real estate and economic development are so deeply connected that building those relationships is absolutely a priority for me," Knight said.

C.A. Webb, who, in her previous role as president of the Kendall Square Association, got to know Knight, praised her ability to build relationships.

"Emily's a person with deep credibility across the innovation community," Webb said. "She's smart. She's personable. She

cares. She listens. I think she is someone who will very rapidly earn the trust of people who don't yet know her."

Prior to The Engine, Knight served as head of operations at Workbar coworking spaces in Boston, and held management roles at food service giant Sodexo. She is a graduate of Cornell University's School of Hotel Administration.

Shirley Leung is a Business columnist. She can be reached at shirley.leung@globe.com.

Revere to pay \$16.5m over Wonderland site

►SETTLEMENT
Continued from Page D1

died of cancer in January 2024.

The final resolution was filed with the court on Tuesday, and the trial was canceled. The settlement includes around \$500,000 for a separate issue involving unresolved parking fees for the site, which had been used as a parking lot.

Revere Mayor Patrick Keefe Jr. was on the City Council at the time of the original taking and said city officials withheld those disputed parking fees, limiting the actual payment to \$29 million to CBW.

Keefe said the final bill to the city — \$29 million plus \$16.5 million — is still well within the realm of what council members anticipated paying at the time.

"This is a win for Revere taxpayers," Keefe said. "Ultimately, you want to walk away with zero [in new payments] but when the delta is anywhere between \$10 million and \$70 million or \$80 million, you're happy when it's closer to the \$10 million range."

If the trial proceeded, CBW's lawyers would have had to per-

suade jurors that the city should pay even more for its new high school, whose price tag is already nearly \$500 million.

However, Keefe said the city has already found around \$24 million in savings in the high school project, so the final price tag shouldn't go up. The city, he said, will need to issue new bonds to pay for the settlement. He noted that the trial could have lasted three weeks.

"We felt very strong in our case but you never know what's going to happen with a jury," Keefe said.

At the time the lawsuit was filed, CBW had argued the Wonderland site could have been worth as much as four times what the city paid. The nearby 50-acre NECCO factory site, for example, sold for \$355 million three years earlier.

"CBW of course would have preferred a larger amount," Peter Flynn, a lawyer who represents the former landowners, said of the \$16.5 million settlement. "But we are certainly aware of the public purpose nature of the [high school] project and how jurors might react to

that."

Flynn said the looming trial helped motivate both sides to strike a deal that valued the property at nearly \$46 million, combining the city's original payment plus the new settlement.

"In the end, once we knew we were going to get somewhere with it, the city of Revere and CBW starting working together pretty well," Flynn said. "In the last few weeks, we've been pretty unified in just trying to get this done and behind us."

The legal issues might not be over yet for CBW: In July, the state Appeals Court ruled in favor of E. Mark Noonan, a lender that had sued CBW, arguing he is owed money for the property. That case is now before the Supreme Judicial Court.

O'Donnell and Vornado were also business partners at the nearby Suffolk Downs horse track-turned-simulcasting center. The partners had invested in the Wonderland property — the dog track closed following a 2008 state ballot question outlawing greyhound races — as

they unsuccessfully chased Greater Boston's sole resort casino license. However, the Massachusetts Gaming Commission ended up picking Wynn's Everett proposal over a Suffolk Downs casino plan.

O'Donnell and Vornado started marketing the Wonderland site, across the street from the Blue Line's Wonderland terminal, after losing the casino vote in 2014. In 2019, after tearing down the old dog track grandstand, CBW tried pitching it for a mixed-use development with offices, shops, and apartments — akin to Assembly Row in Somerville — right before the pandemic hit.

In 2025, the city held a ground-breaking at the property for its new high school, and construction remains ongoing, with a goal of finishing two years from now. Keefe said the project is on track to be done by the end of 2028, with students expected to start attending classes there in early 2029.

Jon Chesto can be reached at jon.chesto@globe.com. Follow him @jonchesto.

TALKING POINTS

PAY

FULL-TIME AMAZON EMPLOYEES IN OPERATIONS GET PAY BUMP FOR STARTING HOURLY WAGE



Online behemoth Amazon said it’s increasing the minimum starting hourly wage for its US full-time core operations employees to \$20 ahead of the crucial holiday shopping season. With the \$1-per-hour increase across the board for these types of workers who do jobs like pack and ship orders, the average pay for these employees will reach nearly \$24 per hour, the company said Wednesday. The retailer said the average total compensation will be more than \$32 an hour including the value of its benefits package. The pay increase is effective starting Sept. 27, the retailer said. Amazon also said Wednesday that employees will receive new benefits like a 10 percent discount on eligible fresh groceries and everyday essentials at Amazon.com and Whole Foods Market online as well as 20 percent off at Whole Foods physical stores. The discount can be combined with existing Prime member discounts, the retailer said. The discount will be available to every Amazon employee in the US starting Oct. 1, the company said.

— ASSOCIATED PRESS



COMPENSATION

EVEN AS GENDER PAY GAP NARROWS, EQUALITY TO TAKE 120 YEARS ORGANIZATION SAYS

Global gender parity remains more than a lifetime away for women even though the gap with men is now smaller than ever, according to the World Economic Forum. The Geneva-based organization’s annual report on the matter, released on Wednesday, found that current progress means it will still take 120 years to reach full equality. That’s a marked improvement, and up from 170 years measured a decade ago, but it still means that no-one alive today is likely to experience it. The WEF’s report combines indexes of political empowerment, economic participation and opportunity, health and survival, and educational attainment to assess gender disparity across the world. The overall gap across 145 economies has narrowed to 69.4 percent, the best result recorded in two decades of such reports. “Gender parity is achievable — economies at every income level have made progress, so the barrier is not a lack of resources,” said Saadia Zahidi, managing director at the WEF. “To accelerate, governments and employers need to learn from the policies that work and apply them faster.”

— BLOOMBERG NEWS

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

OPENAI MULLS NEW FINANCING AT A \$1.5T VALUATION



OpenAI is considering a new funding round that would value the giant artificial intelligence startup at about \$1.5 trillion in advance of its planned initial public offering, according to people familiar with the matter. If successful, it would roughly double OpenAI’s most recent private valuation of \$730 billion, crowning the ChatGPT maker as the world’s most valuable privately held company. The people familiar with the discussions, who requested anonymity to share details of the potential financing, stressed that no decisions had been made and that plans may change. Investors recently approached OpenAI with a proposal to invest in the startup at a \$1.2 trillion valuation, according to the people. But OpenAI believes it should be given a value of at least \$1.5 trillion based on increased customer traction with its coding tool Codex and its latest AI models, GPT-6 Astra and GPT-5.6 Sol, according to the people. OpenAI generated more than \$40 billion in annualized revenue last month, roughly double its sales figure at the end of last year.

— NEW YORK TIMES

AVIATION

UNITED, AMERICAN SAY FUEL COST SURGE MAY MEAN CAPACITY CUTS



United Airlines Holdings Inc. and American Airlines Group Inc. said they may need to cut more capacity in the fourth quarter, while Southwest Airlines Co. sees room to hike fares, as the aviation industry continues to contend with high fuel prices. “If fuel prices remain as high as they are right now, I think that that’s going to require some adjustments in terms of our capacity planning as we take a look out into the future,” American chief executive Robert Isom said at a Morgan Stanley conference in California on Wednesday. Speaking after Isom at the same event, United chief financial officer Mike Leskinen said that if fuel remains high, the company will “make some adjustments into the first quarter and beyond into 2027.” “We are not flying to maximize market share, we’re flying to maximize profitability and free cash generation, so we’ll make those adjustments,” Leskinen said. Speaking later, Southwest chief financial officer Tom Doxey said the airline sees “room to go” on fare increases, as the industry grapples with higher fuel costs amid the US-Iran war. Further capacity cuts are likely if fuel prices remain high, Doxey added.

— BLOOMBERG NEWS

ENTERTAINMENT

EMMY AWARDS RATINGS DOWN NEARLY 10% FROM LAST YEAR



Ratings for the Emmy Awards were down nearly 10 percent from last year, with the viewer numbers dipping again after a couple of years of growth. About 6.7 million viewers tuned in to watch the 78th primetime Emmy Awards on NBC, according to data released Tuesday by the network. “Widow’s Bay” from Apple TV was Monday night’s biggest winner by far on the telecast hosted by “Law & Order: Special Victims Unit” star Mariska Hargitay (below), setting a record for a comedy with 14 Emmys. “The Pitt” won best drama for the second straight year. The show aired against the stiff competition of the first Monday Night Football game of the year between the Kansas City Chiefs and Denver Broncos on ESPN. The Emmys telecast brought in an estimated 6.87 million viewers on ABC in 2024, and 7.42 million on CBS last year. This year’s show was far higher than the all-time low of 4.3 million from the Fox telecast of January 2024, which was delayed by months because of Hollywood’s writers and actors strikes. The telecast rotates annually between the four broadcast networks. The Emmys always lag well behind similar awards shows, bringing less than half the viewers of the Oscars or Grammys and significantly fewer than the Golden Globes.

— ASSOCIATED PRESS

LEGAL

FOUNDER OF FIRM SENTENCED TO 11 YEARS FOR PONZI SCHEME THAT SCAMMED TRAVIS KELCE, MANY OTHERS



The creator of a Texas-based investment company has been sentenced to 11 years in federal prison for his role in a Ponzi scheme that prosecutors say bilked 64 victims, including Kansas City Chiefs tight end Travis Kelce (below left). US District Judge Zachary Bluestone sentenced Siddharth Jawahar, 38, on Tuesday and ordered him to pay \$31.35 million in restitution to victims. Jawahar’s attorney did not respond to a voicemail requesting comment. The US Attorney’s Office for the Eastern District of Missouri said between July 2016 and December 2023, Jawahar took in more than \$35 million from investors in his company, Swiftarc Capital LLC, but only invested about \$10 million of that amount. Instead, prosecutors said, he used money from new investors to repay older investors and to fund an extravagant lifestyle including luxury apartments in New York City and Austin, Texas, private jet travel and expensive outings. St. Louis news station KMOV-TV reported that prosecutors said in court that Kelce was among the victims, but they did not elaborate. A 2021 Forbes article said Kelce invested in a fund established by Jawahar’s company Swiftarc. Robert Patrick, a spokesperson with the US Attorney’s Office for the Eastern District of Missouri, said there were 64 victims total, but declined to answer questions about Kelce’s connection to the case. Kelce’s spokespeople did not respond to emails requesting comment. Jawahar was indicted by a grand jury in 2023 and pleaded guilty in January to three counts of wire fraud. Jawahar is from India and was living in the US without legal status since 2005, according to court documents. Prosecutors say that after his indictment, Jawahar tried to coach a victim into giving a favorable statement to the FBI, that he lied about his immigration status and tried to get a relative to remotely wipe his iPhone in order to hide evidence.

— ASSOCIATED PRESS

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Avon debt collector is barred from operating in Mass.

Over 6,000 consumers given \$52m in relief

By Nick Stoico

GLOBE STAFF

An Avon debt collector accused of seizing vehicles to coerce payment has been barred from collecting debts in the state under a settlement providing \$52 million in relief to more than 6,000 consumers, Attorney General Andrea Campbell’s office said this week.

The state’s settlement with Judgement Acquisitions Unlimited, Champion Funding, and their owner, Andrew Metcalf, resolves allegations that they engaged in “unfair and deceptive debt collection practices,” Campbell’s office said in a statement.

Under the settlement, Metcalf and his companies are prohibited from buying, selling, transferring, assigning, or collecting debts allegedly owed by consumers in Massachusetts, according to Campbell’s office.

They are also permanently barred from seeking a debt collector license in the state and from “engaging in any collection activity from or within” the state, the statement said.

According to the settlement, Metcalf and his companies owned more than 7,300 debts with a total balance of about \$58.9 million. More than 6,400 of those debts were owed by people in Massachusetts, totaling about \$52.8 million.

“As Massachusetts residents

continue to face rising costs, they should not be subject to aggressive and unlawful debt collection practices like those Andrew Metcalf allegedly engaged in,” Campbell said in the statement.

An attorney representing Metcalf and his companies could not immediately be reached for comment. The settlement says the defendants deny the allegations.

Campbell’s office alleged the companies used aggressive collection methods, including seizing cars to pressure consumers into making payments. In some cases, the cars were allegedly worth so little that they were legally exempt from seizure and were the person’s only way to get to work.

The state also alleged Metcalf and his companies seized vehicles that belonged to people other than the debtor and, in some cases, continued to demand payment rather than return the cars, according to the complaint.

Campbell’s office sued in 2024 and subsequently won two preliminary injunctions restricting the companies’ collection business in Massachusetts.

Under the settlement, Metcalf and his companies also face a suspended \$650,000 penalty that could become payable if they violate the settlement or if the court determines their financial disclosures were not truthful, Campbell’s office said.

Nick Stoico can be reached at nick.stoico@globe.com.



JENNY KANE/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Most credit card holders can expect the rates they pay to rise within the next couple of billing cycles.

How the Fed’s interest rate hike affects credit

Borrowing costs will rise in next few billing cycles

By Tara Siegel Bernard

NEW YORK TIMES

The Federal Reserve raised its benchmark interest rate by a quarter of a percentage point Wednesday, though broader market forces have already elevated borrowing costs on mortgages and other consumer loans.

It’s the first time in more than three years that the Fed raised rates. Many consumer products, including credit cards, personal loans, and small-business loans, are pegged to the prime rate, which tracks the Fed’s actions and serves as a baseline to set rates.

That means most credit card holders can expect the rates they pay to rise, largely in line with the Fed’s move, within the next couple of billing cycles.

“While the near-term impact on minimum monthly credit card payments may be relatively small, higher borrowing costs can add up over time, particularly for consumers carrying larger balances or making only minimum payments,” said Michele Raneri, vice president and head of US research and consulting at TransUnion, one of the three big credit reporting companies. “Reducing revolving debt remains one of the most effective ways to limit the impact of rising rates.”

But that can be challenging for the many Americans who are leaning on credit cards because they are struggling to cover their monthly costs amid persistent inflation.

“The high cost of living is the biggest stressor on household budgets,” said Ted Rossman, a principal consumer finance analyst at Money Management International, a nonprofit credit counseling firm in Texas.

Not all loan rates are directly linked to the Fed’s moves, though they’re still influenced by them. Rates on 30-year, fixed-rate mortgages, for example, generally track with the yield on the 10-year Treasury bond, which rose Tuesday to 5.04 percent, its highest level in nearly 20 years, before retreating to around 5 percent.

That has pushed mortgage rates to their highest levels in more than a year: 30-year fixed-rate loans averaged 6.76 percent as of Thursday, according to Freddie Mac, up from 6.71 percent last week and 6.35 percent a year ago. When rates are elevated, shopping around for loans becomes even more critical.

The 10-year yields have been climbing because of investor concerns about mounting government debt levels, the US-led war in Iran, and its effect on oil prices and inflation, as well as the heavy borrowing and spending on artificial intelligence infrastructure.

Vineyard Wind, GE Vernova settle legal battle

Reach ‘amicable’ agreement over contract dispute

By Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF

Vineyard Wind and turbine maker GE Vernova have settled their legal battle over the \$4.5 billion offshore wind project south of Martha's Vineyard.

The two companies said Wednesday that they had reached an “amicable settlement” resolving all outstanding litigation. GE Vernova said it had withdrawn its plans to terminate its contracts with Vineyard Wind, and the companies agreed to dismiss all pending legal claims.

Terms of the settlement are confidential, the companies said. The agreement ends a fight that spilled into Suffolk Superior Court



RANDI BAIRD/NEW YORK TIMES

The project generated 4,000 jobs, according to the two companies.

in April, shortly after construction wrapped on the 62-turbine, 800-megawatt wind farm.

GE Vernova notified Vineyard Wind in February that it planned

to terminate their contracts for turbine construction and maintenance, citing more than \$300 million in unpaid bills, court records show.

Vineyard Wind sued to stop GE Vernova from leaving the project, arguing it had breached its contracts and that losing the turbine supplier could cause “irreparable harm” to the wind farm.

In April, a Suffolk Superior Court judge barred GE Vernova's subsidiary from leaving the project and later rejected GE's bid to send the dispute to arbitration, records show.

Vineyard Wind had argued that GE's proprietary technology and expertise made its continued involvement essential.

The dispute also centered on delays stemming from the failure of a turbine blade in July 2024, which sent debris falling into the ocean, later washing up on Nantucket beaches.

Vineyard Wind alleged in its suit that GE Vernova owed it more than \$850 million because of defects in the blade and other costs,

more than offsetting GE Vernova's claim for unpaid bills.

The companies did not disclose on Wednesday whether any money changed hands as part of the settlement or provide details about GE Vernova's continued role in maintaining the project.

Vineyard Wind has been generating power since 2024, and before a Trump administration executive order halted the project in December, it had sold enough electricity to power roughly 50,000 homes, The New Bedford Light reported.

Vineyard Wind and GE Vernova said that all turbines at the farm are now capable of producing power, enough to serve more than 400,000 homes and businesses. They said the project has generated nearly 4,000 jobs and \$1.94 billion in economic output.

Nick Stoico can be reached at nick.stoico@globe.com.

With quarter of staff gone, IRS delaying release of tax gap

Agency says it’s updating method used to calculate income that is not reported

By Andrew Duehren
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration has held up the publication of an annual IRS estimate of unpaid taxes, a delay that could mask the fiscal cost of the steep decline in the agency's ability to audit the rich.

The IRS has long published an estimate of the tax gap, the amount of tax owed under existing law that goes uncollected each year. The agency began releasing an estimate of the tax gap annually during the Biden administration, but under President Trump, it has yet to put out an update. The current leader of the IRS, Frank Bisignano, has cast doubt on the metric and indicated that he wants to focus instead on what he called the “addressable tax gap.”

The shift comes after the Trump administration pushed out roughly a quarter of the IRS workforce and cut the agency's budget, weakening the government's ability to conduct time-intensive audits. An inspector general report last month found that revenue collected from audits dropped by more than a third last fiscal year, a sign that the tax gap could be growing under Trump.

In its most recent projection, released in October 2024, the IRS estimated that roughly \$700 billion in owed taxes went uncollected in 2022, though the agency said it expected that roughly \$90 billion of that would eventually be paid. The next estimate, for 2023, was scheduled for publication last fall but has not been released.

The absence of an updated tax gap estimate is part of a pattern across the Trump administration, which has either stopped collecting or sought to change the measurement of federal data that scientists and other researchers have long relied on for a rigorous, unvarnished understanding of the country. The Pentagon declined to provide information to the nonpartisan Congressional Budget Office about the cost of the war in Iran, and last year the president fired the head of the Bureau of Labor Statistics, which produces the monthly job numbers, baselessly calling the labor market data “rigged.”

An IRS spokesperson said the agency was updating the methodologies used to calculate the tax gap and would release the figure when it was

ready. Bisignano, in a statement, said revenue from tax enforcement was increasing this year and did not depend on the number of auditors.

“The IRS is working smarter by using better data, advanced analytics, and technology like AI to address noncompliance more precisely, reduce false positives, and focus resources where they have the greatest impact,” Bisignano said in a statement. “The tax gap estimates are an important part of that work, but it is not a measure of current enforcement.”

In an email to IRS staff Tuesday, Bisignano said Vincent LaPadula, who joined the IRS this summer from JPMorgan Chase & Co., would lead the agency's work on the tax gap.

Since it covers 2023, the delayed report would not yet capture any change in tax compliance resulting from the Trump administration's push to downsize the IRS. But the absence of the data could make it more difficult to assess whether more taxes were going uncollected after Trump took office.

“Without a metric of the tax gap that is telling us in real time about trends in compliance and how they're changing, I worry that it's hard for policymakers to see the full swath of the damage that's been done by the gutting of the agency,” said Natasha Sarin, a Treasury official during the Biden administration who has written extensively about the tax gap. “And, in fact, I worry that's the point.”

Beyond illustrating the extent and sources of tax noncompliance, the tax gap has been a figure often cited to argue for giving more resources to the IRS. In 2021, Charles Rettig, Trump's first-term pick to lead the IRS, speculated that the tax gap could be as much as \$1 trillion a year, a figure much larger than the IRS estimate at the time, as he called for a bigger budget for the agency.

For a time, there was bipartisan interest in giving the IRS more resources to narrow the tax gap, since doing so generates more tax revenue for the government without having to raise taxes. That changed after Democrats approved an additional \$80 billion for the IRS in 2022. Republicans renewed their attacks on the agency and eventually clawed back much of the extra money. GOP officials, cheered on by



STEFANI REYNOLDS/NEW YORK TIMES

The inspector general reported last month that revenue from audits dropped by more than a third last fiscal year.

business groups, also began to question the reliability of the agency's tax gap estimates.

“Republicans didn't like that it really points the finger at the wealthy as being the problem,” said Barry Johnson, who previously oversaw the tax gap report as the chief data and analytics officer at the IRS.

The tax gap encompasses several types of unpaid taxes. It includes taxes that are simply late in being paid, as well as taxes that are uncollected as a result of people not filing a tax return. But most of the gap comes from people who file a tax return but do not report all of their income to the IRS, intentionally or not.

The agency has consistently found that income independently reported to the IRS, like wages, is rarely underreported, while income without third-party verification, like business profits, often goes unreported. Overall, 85 percent of owed taxes were paid voluntarily and on time in 2022, the IRS said.

Still, the tax gap is somewhat imprecise, since IRS analysts are estimating taxes owed on income that is not revealed to the agency. To do so, the IRS conducts a statistical sample of intensive audits, and then extrapolates the rates of noncompliance it finds to the taxpayer population more broadly.

Previously, the agency released a new tax gap estimate every few years, but during the Biden administration it started providing an annual update, responding to requests from lawmakers of both parties for more regular data.

Pooling together enough audit results takes time, though, and so the IRS relies on the results from older samples to project noncompliance for a given year — and then updates the numbers as more recent data becomes available.

For example, the 2022 estimate of the tax gap is based on noncompliance rates observed in tax filings from 2014 through 2016. Alan Plumley, a retired IRS analyst who worked on the tax gap, said that methodology meant that an annual headline figure was not particularly meaningful.

“Doing random audits has become a luxury where in the past they had been viewed as a necessity,” he said. “If people realized how soft the tax gap estimates are, they would realize they shouldn't be putting a lot of weight on the estimated total.”

In appearances before Congress in the spring, Bisignano, the first CEO of the IRS, suggested that he was skeptical of the methodology behind the tax gap, saying that he wanted to focus on the subset of unpaid taxes that the IRS could realistically collect.

“What I've seen is nobody's ever worked on the tax gap,” Bisignano, who is also the commissioner of the Social Security Administration, said in April. “And we need to decide what is the addressable tax gap and we need to go get it.”

Former IRS officials said that focusing limited resources on easier-to-collect taxes made sense and reflected current practice, since closing the tax gap entirely would be an enormous undertaking. Still, if the IRS adopted a new standard for publicly reporting the tax gap, they said, it should also continue publishing estimates using the previous methodology, so that researchers can see trends.

And Bisignano has not yet defined what he considers “addressable,” a key point given that what is achievable for the IRS depends on the budget and tax laws approved by Congress.

“The devil is in the details of what you're describing as ‘addressable’ versus not,” said Daniel Werfel, who was tapped by President Biden to lead the IRS and stepped down in 2025.

Medicare to expand pilot that pays for wearable tech

By Mario Aguilar
STAT

A Medicare experiment in paying for technology to help people manage chronic conditions has just barely gotten underway, and already, officials are moving to expand it.

Announced last year, the ACCESS model will pay approved companies to manage the chronic conditions, including diabetes, high blood pressure, chronic musculoskeletal pain, and depression. The model introduces outcome-aligned payments, in which providers are paid more if their patients' conditions improve.

Regulators on Tuesday announced that they would expand the number of chronic conditions that will be eligible for the ACCESS model to include substance use disorder, heart failure, chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, and longer-term support for musculoskeletal conditions. The new condition tracks will start in spring 2027.

Medicare on Tuesday morning, for the first time, published a directory of health care providers who can take patients under the model. So far 39 providers have been admitted to the model.

ACCESS, which stands for Advancing Chronic Care with Effective, Scalable Solutions, represents one of the Trump administration's most prominent efforts to boost the adoption of digital technology, which officials hope can help lower health care costs. Payment amounts for ACCESS providers were set low, an effort to encourage innovation that reduces reliance on clinicians.

The program was launched as a 10-year experiment by the Medicare Innovation Center, which is allowed to experiment with new care delivery models and later make them permanent if they deliver better outcomes without increasing costs or maintain outcomes at lower costs.

“If you worry about affordability in health care, AI can help us,” said Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services Administrator Dr. Mehmet Oz, during a Tuesday event on ACCESS.

The ACCESS model officially launched in July, but the agency delayed launching a directory of providers while they waited for everyone to be ready. Many companies had to enroll in Medicare for the first time to participate in ACCESS, and the model requires technical development so that companies can enroll patients and share data back with Medicare.

The companies enrolled in the model include Boston-based wearable-maker Whoop, AliveCor, which develops devices and software for monitoring heart health, Welldoc, a developer of tools for managing diabetes, companies that use AI chatbots for triage, like Doctronic and Counsel Health (which has offices in both New York City and Boston), and mental health technology developers including Limbic. The companies represent just a subset of more than 150 that had been provisionally accepted to the model earlier this year.

Some of the most prominent health tech companies targeting chronic disease, including Omada, Sword Health, and Hinge Health, all chose not to enroll in the program, saying that the model's payment amounts don't support their clinician-heavy models. The model's maximum yearly payments range from \$180 per patient for behavioral health conditions to \$420 for cardiovascular, kidney, or metabolic conditions.

There has been concern that ACCESS organizations will fragment care if there is insufficient communication with patients' primary care providers. The model requires ACCESS providers to try to contact beneficiary's primary care providers, and offers small payments for care coordination by providers.

Retail sales in US rise a better-than-expected 1.2 percent in August

By Anne D'Innocenzio
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — Consumers may be griping about higher prices at the pump and elsewhere, but they keep spending, helping to power the economy, according to the latest government snapshot.

Retail sales rebounded at a better-than-expected 1.2 percent increase last month after recording a revised 0.5 percent dip in July, according to Commerce Department data released Wednesday. Economists were anticipating a 0.7 percent gain for the month, according to FactSet.

The decline in July was notable because there had been few signs of fatigue from US consumers. Americans spent heavily during the World Cup

and Amazon Prime Day sales this summer. That followed solid retail sales in April and May as Americans dipped into their government tax refunds.

Even excluding business at gas stations, retail sales rose 1.1 percent in August, underscoring the resilience of the American consumer. The government figures aren't adjusted for inflation. The roar back in spending is happening even as consumer confidence took another hit in July, according to the latest reading by the Conference Board.

Much of the strength in retail last month reflected a bounce back in nonstore sales, which declined sharply in July, according to economists. That was “seasonal noise” driven by

shifts in the timing of Amazon's Prime Day shopping event, which also coincides with heavy promotions from other major online retailers, according to Michael Pearce, chief US economist at Oxford Economics. Rising gas prices also propped up gasoline station sales, he said.

But even accounting for these factors, gains in most spending categories were “decent,” led by discretionary sectors such as food services, electronics, and sports and recreation, Pearce wrote.

“American consumers are still opening their wallets and buying,” Heather Long, chief economist at Navy Federal Credit Union, wrote in a report published Wednesday. “August retail sales showed a big bounce back

after a weak July.”

The so-called control group — which excludes food services, autos, building materials, and gas station sales and is used to calculate economic growth — rose a strong 1.4 percent last month from the prior month.

The Labor Department reported Friday that consumer prices rose 3.4 percent last month from a year earlier, and they're up 0.4 percent from July, quadrupling the 0.1 percent registered in the previous month.

Still, Americans have grown more selective about what they buy, according to retailers who reported their quarterly financial results in the past few weeks, but some are using a portion of their tariff refunds from the government to lower prices.



UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD PUZZLE

IN THE WRONG MUSIC CLASS BY ERIK AGARD | EDITED BY DAVID STEINBERG

ACROSS

1 "Yummy!"

4 Spoiled kid

8 Ump's relative

11 Big-billed tropical bird

15 Coolness, nowadays

16 Body part with a drum

17 God whose victory is celebrated during Holi

18 Early scene in a rom-com

20 Owl sounds

22 Collection of numbers to crunch

23 Nickname for Rihanna

25 Boardroom session: Abbr.

27 Unwraps

28 Stock launch, for short

29 Oracle

30 "Bang for your buck" stat

31 Ed Sheeran song that's not [letters 7-9 in this answer]

34 Camper's weather protection

38 Jimmy Buffett song that's not [letters 4-6]

39 Potent poker pair

40 Righteous Brothers song that's not [letters 8-10]

42 Chamomile, e.g.

43 Earth, Wind & Fire song that's not [letters 4-8]

DOWN

1 VMAs channel

2 Me, in French

3 Portobello part

4 "POW!" relative

5 Felt remorse over

6 Geometric calculation

7 Body image?

8 Reduce, ____, recycle

9 Devoured

10 Is worried

12 "The ____ of Cooking" (2025 book by a Korean-born chef)

13 "It's ____-brainer!"

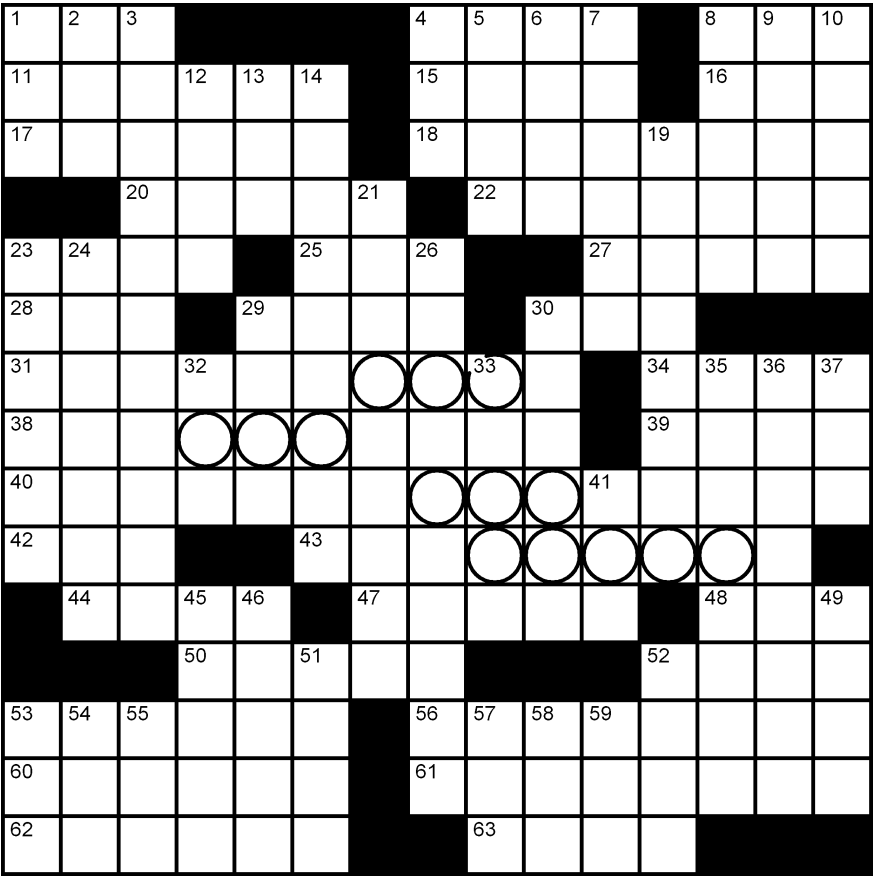
14 Essence of a mace-related spice

19 The first letter of Aaron, but not the second

21 Severe quality

23 Woodworking technique that goes parallel to the grain

24 Some Apple devices



- 26 K-6 midpoint

29 Bra brand

30 Followed an ABAB scheme, e.g.

32 Typo of a common article

33 "Star Wars" queen Amidala

35 Followers
- 36 Rust-colored birds of prey

37 Subj. in which Freud is studied

41 Aliens: Abbr.

45 Revise

46 Opposite of sped-up

49 El ____, Texas

51 Was aware
- 52 "Planet of the ____"

53 Spins records

54 "Neat!"

55 Aunt, in Spanish

57 Doubly hyphenated ID

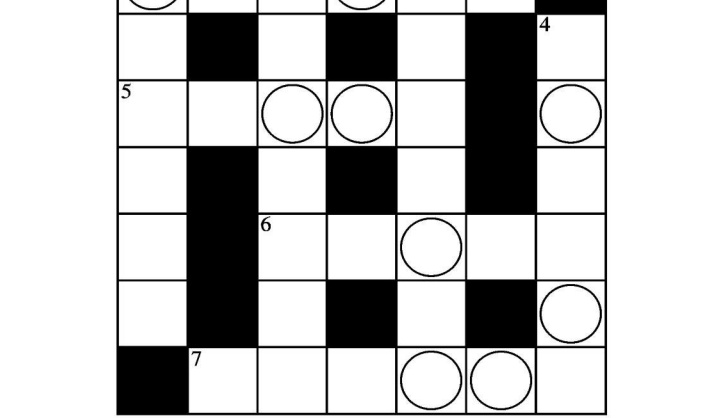
58 Tax prep pro

59 Word before "history" or "gallery"



JUMBLE CROSSWORDS™

by David L. Hoyt 9-17-26



CLUE

1. Pound, thrash

5. Command

6. Further along

7. Give

ACROSS

ANSWER

MPUEML

EDRRO

HAAED

BWSTEO

CLUE

1. Business gain

2. Act as a go-between

3. ____ money

4. Follow closely

DOWN

ANSWER

RTFPOI

DTAEMIE

RAETMS

DWSOHA

CLUE: The first ____ store opened in Atlanta, Georgia, in 1979.

BONUS

How to play

Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

ANSWERS: 1A-Furnmel 5A-Order 6A-Ahead 7A-Bestow 1D-Prof 1H-4th 1J-Earnest 4D-B-Homew Depot

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Send comments to DLHoyt@HoytInteractiveMedia.com

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New England

TODAY: A shower or thunderstorm around in inland areas, higher chance for thunderstorms in western areas.

TOMORROW: Mostly sunny, less humid and pleasant throughout New England.

EXTENDED: Increasing clouds and cool Saturday. Cloudy with periods of rain likely on Sunday.

Forecasts and graphics provided by **AccuWeather, Inc.** ©2026

Temperatures are today's highs and tonight's lows

City	Today	Tomorrow	Extended
Presque Isle	67/49		
Millinocket	69/56		
Bangor	71/59		
Bar Harbor	66/60		
Portland	70/61		
Portsmouth	73/65		
Nashua	76/65		
Boston	76/67		
New Bedford	76/67		
Provincetown	75/67		
Hyannis	76/68		
Nantucket	74/66		
Oak Bluffs	75/68		
Newport	74/67		
Bridgeport	78/70		
Hartford	78/68		
Springfield	76/67		
Pittsfield	74/62		
Worcester	75/64		
Providence	78/67		
Manchester	76/65		
Brattleboro	75/63		
Rutland	73/58		
Montpelier	73/57		
Burlington	74/58		
Lebanon	73/62		
MT. Washington	54/40		
Berlin	74/56		
Newport	72/57		
Augusta	72/61		

Forecast high and low temperatures and conditions

● Travel delays possible. **C** Clouds. **F** Fog. **H** Haze. **I** Ice. **Pc** Partly Cloudy. **R** Rain. **Sh** Showers. **S** Sun. **Sn** Snow. **Fl** Flurries. **T** Thunderstorms. **W** Windy

Today		Tomorrow		Today		Tomorrow		Today		Tomorrow		Today		Tomorrow	
Atlanta	92/72 S 94/74 T			Los Angeles	80/64 Pc 82/66 Pc			Seattle	76/52 S 70/52 Pc			Jerusalem	89/72 S 80/67 Sh		
Atlantic City	82/69 Pc 83/60 Pc			● Miami	88/77 T 88/77 T			● Washington	89/72 T 87/65 Pc			London	69/50 R 67/60 Pc		
Charlotte	92/70 S 90/72 T			New Orleans	92/74 S 91/73 T			Beijing	90/67 Pc 85/63 T			Moscow	71/54 Pc 65/47 Sh		
Chicago	76/65 R 73/66 Pc			New York City	81/69 Pc 81/60 Pc			● Cancun	91/74 Sh 91/73 R			Paris	73/54 Pc 72/54 C		
Dallas	98/79 S 99/78 S			Philadelphia	86/72 Pc 85/65 Pc			● Mexico City	77/55 R 76/56 Sh			Rome	84/68 Pc 82/64 Sh		
● Denver	81/59 T 83/56 T			Phoenix	94/81 Pc 102/81 S			● Montreal	71/54 Sh 69/42 S			● San Juan	90/79 T 91/79 T		
Detroit	74/59 T 75/58 S			● Salt Lake City	83/65 T 76/56 T			● Toronto	74/56 T 71/54 Pc			● Stockholm	60/50 Sh 60/49 Sh		
● Fort Myers	89/73 T 89/73 T			San Francisco	73/58 Pc 73/58 Pc			Vancouver	69/51 S 68/52 Pc			Tokyo	76/67 R 76/70 T		

HAPPY BIRTHDAY for Thursday, Sept. 17, 2026: You're decisive, progressive, and forceful. You will let nothing stand in your way. This is a year of completion and endings. Take inventory of your life. Let go of the people, places, and things that hold you back. Do some internal and external housecleaning. Focus on being compassionate and loving.

ARIES (*March 21-April 19*)
Today is full of playful opportunities! It's a great day to travel. It's also a wonderful day for learning and studying. Anything related to important papers, universities, and higher education will flourish. This is a good time to sort through the details of a vacation itinerary. Tonight: Do something different.

TAURUS (*April 20-May 20*)
Financial discussions, especially related to home, family, or real estate will go well today. This is a wonderful day to get a loan or mortgage or to explore new aspects of dealing with shared property or anything jointly owned. You're in the zone! Tonight: Check your finances.

GEMINI (*May 21-June 20*)

This is an excellent time for important discussions with partners, spouses, and close friends. You'll be generous, fair-minded, and upbeat. But at the same time, you'll be realistic and grounded. Plans made today will have a good chance for success tomorrow. Tonight: Listen to someone.

CANCER (*June 21-July 22*)
Today promises success and productivity for you. Work hard. Not only will you impress people in authority, you can do something to boost your income now or in the future. Work-related travel might occur for some of you. Go after what you want! Tonight: Work.

LEO (*July 23-Aug. 22*)
It's a lucky day for you! The Moon is in your "home" dancing beautifully with Jupiter in your sign, and also with stern Saturn. This favors all kinds of ventures, including business, publishing, higher education, medicine, and the law, as well as doing what is important to you. Sweet! Tonight: Play!

VIRGO (*Aug. 23-Sept. 22*)
Relax at home if you can today. You might find it rewarding to explore personal issues, as well as your spiritual life. You will feel content. A serious discussion

with an older family member about debt and shared property might take place. (It's all good.)
Tonight: Relax.

LIBRA (Sept. 23-Oct. 22)
Your communication skills are great today (which is nothing new). Short trips, visits with siblings, relatives, and neighbors, plus a chance to learn or teach will please you. Activities with groups and friends will delight. Serious discussion with a partner or spouse will be productive. Tonight: Listen and learn.

SCORPIO (Oct. 23-Nov. 21)
This is a good money day for you. For example, it's a good day to ask for a raise or a promotion. You'll impress co-workers and bosses. Not only are you hard-working and productive right now, today you're also diplomatic and charming. Go for the gold! Tonight: Maintain your possessions.

SAGITTARIUS (Nov. 22-Dec. 21)
You are blessed today because the Moon is in your sign dancing beautifully with both Jupiter and Saturn, which gives you a wonderful sense of balance when dealing with both work and play. Explore opportunities to travel. Likewise, explore opportunities in publishing, the media, medicine, and the

law. Tonight: You're in charge.

CAPRICORN (*Dec. 22-Jan. 19*) Remember to be patient with partners and close friends while fiery Mars is opposite your sign. Travel opportunities and a chance to explore avenues in publishing, medicine, and the law are favorable. Likewise, relations with friends and groups are cozy. Negotiations will favor you today. Tonight: Enjoy solitude.

AQUARIUS (*Jan. 20-Feb. 18*) Your communication skills are great today, which is why you'll enjoy schmoozing with friends and groups. Likewise, talking to members of the general public will also be successful. You have a nice balance between optimism and grounded commonsense today. Tonight: Be friendly.

PISCES (*Feb. 19-March 20*) Today you're high-viz, which means people notice you more than usual. But this is good news, because you make a fabulous impression on co-workers as well as anyone who holds the purse strings. Travel and a chance to meet someone different will appeal. Tonight: Be kind and modest.

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			6	2	3			8
		9				7	3	
						2		
	7		4		8	9		
	3						4	
		8	3		5		7	
		6						
	9	1				3		
7			8	6	4			

Fill in the grid so that every row, every column, and every 3X3 box contains the digits 1 through 9. Puzzle difficulty levels: Easy on Monday and Tuesday, more difficult on Wednesday and Thursday, most difficult on Friday and Saturday. Tips and computer program at www.sudoku.com.

BY FRANK STEWART
h dealer — N-S vulnerable

South dealer — N-S vulnerable

North

♠	J 10 9 5
♥	Q J 3
♦	A J 7 3
♣	Q 3

East

♠	7 4 2
♥	9 8 6 2
♦	K 10
♣	J 10 5 4

South
 ♠ A K Q 6 3
 ♥ A 10 5
 ♦ Q 5
 ♣ 9 6 2

South	West	North	East
1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠	Pass
4 ♠	All Pass		

Opening lead — ♣ K

I was in the club lounge with my friend the English professor when a player came to him with a puzzler.

“Prof, what’s the only English word ending in ‘mt’?”

“Reminds me of a deal from my game today,” the prof mused. He wrote down today’s layout.

“My partner played at four spades. West took the K-A of clubs and led a trump. Partner drew trumps and led dummy’s queen of hearts to finesse, and West took the king and returned a heart. Partner won and let the queen of diamonds ride, and East’s king won. Down one.”

After West showed a singleton spade and the A-K of clubs, East had at least one king, else West would have acted over one spade. South should take only the jack of trumps and lead a low diamond from dummy. When East takes the king, South can pitch two hearts from his hand on the A-J of diamonds. If West had the king of diamonds, South could expect the heart finesse to win.

“My partner was supposedly a good dealer,” the prof told us. “I never dreamt he would go down.”

DAILY QUESTION You hold: ♠ A K Q 6 3 ♥ A 10 5 ♦ Q 5 ♣ 9 6 2. Your partner opens one diamond, you respond one spade, he bids two clubs and you try a “fourth-suit” two hearts. Partner then bids three diamonds. What do you say?

ANSWER: Partner suggests six diamonds, four clubs and extra strength. With a minimum 6-4 hand, most players would have rebid two diamonds. He may hold 4, 7 6, A K J 9 6 3, A K 7 5. Bid four diamonds if you're sure it's forcing, or bid six diamonds.



BIZARRO by Wayno & Piraro

**MOTHER GOOSE & GRIMM** by Mike Peters**ADAM@HOME** by Rob Harrell**ROSE IS ROSE** by Pat Brady & Don Wimmer

Today's Crossword Solution

[illegible]

Today's Sudoku Solution

7	5	3	8	6	4	1	2	9
8	9	1	7	5	2	3	6	4
4	2	6	1	3	9	5	8	7
1	4	8	3	9	5	6	7	2
9	3	5	2	7	6	8	4	1
6	7	2	4	1	8	9	5	3
3	6	4	9	8	7	2	1	5
2	8	9	5	4	1	7	3	6
5	1	7	6	2	3	4	9	8